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EC faces three setbacks in one day

With plea in SC, Congress protests and postponement of CEC's UP programme

RAJESH KUMAR
■ New Delhi

Amid the raging controversy surrounding the Election Commission, three developments marked Friday.

A plea was filed in the Supreme Court challenging decisions, guidelines, and software changes allegedly made by Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar without the concurrence of the two Election Commissioners, saying such actions violate the statutory requirement of collective decision-making. Congress held nationwide protests demanding his removal. The Election Commission postponed the CEC's outreach programme in UP, leading to speculation. The poll-body, however, said logistical issues were the reason.

Besides challenging the decisions allegedly taken

Indian Youth Congress (IYC) members stage a protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, demanding his resignation and citing a media report that two Election Commissioners raised objections the various poll panel decisions in New Delhi on Friday

without the required concurrence, the plea filed by advocate Shailendra Mani

Tripathi through advocate Chand Qureshi sought a direction declaring such decisions unconstitutional, beyond the powers of the CEC and void if they were taken without the

full Election Commission's concurrence or contrary to the majority view of the poll panel. The petitioner has sought initiation of criminal proceedings against the CEC and other officials under provisions relating to breach of official duty.

"Divested of any statutory or constitutional immunity, the Chief Election Commissioner remains directly accountable under the law — subject to police investigation, evidence gathering, and regular trial proceedings as an ordinary accused," the plea read.

The plea was filed days after a report revealed that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had recorded written objections to several decisions allegedly taken in the name of the three-member Election Commission (EC).

CONTINUED ON >> P4

UP-made BrahMos keeping Pakistan awake: Amit Shah

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ Noida

Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah on Friday said BrahMos missiles manufactured in a transformed Uttar Pradesh were giving Pakistan "sleepless nights." At the same time, AK-203 assault rifles produced in Amethi had become a weapon against Naxalites and terrorists.

Shah spoke at the opening of the fourth Uttar Pradesh International Trade Show at the India Expo Centre and Mart in Greater Noida, joined by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath. The five-day event, held from September 25 to 29 with the theme "Ultimate Sourcing Begins Here," aims to link the State's manufacturers, MSMEs, artisans, and exporters with buyers from India and abroad.

Organisers expect over 2,400 exhibitors, around 1.5

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath presents a memento to Union Home Minister Amit Shah during the inauguration of the 4th Uttar Pradesh International Trade Show (UPITS), in Greater Noida. Uttar Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister Brajesh Pathak is also seen

lakh business visitors, more than 4.5 lakh general visitors, and over 550 international buyers from about 85 to 90 countries. Austria, Japan, Russia, Singapore, Belarus, and Vietnam are partner nations. Shah said that Uttar Pradesh's industrial landscape

has changed significantly, with investments coming into all six nodes of the Defence Industrial Corridor—Jhansi, Chitrakoot, Lucknow, Agra, Aligarh, and Kanpur. He said this growth shows both state and national progress.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

The ByStander

ESMESH

J&K Statehood: Omar reminds PM Modi of promise

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Friday reignited the 'Statehood' debate by sending a terse reminder to Prime Minister Narendra Modi from the floor of the Jammu and Kashmir Legislative Assembly after moving a resolution seeking the complete restoration of Statehood to Jammu and Kashmir, saying a commitment described as *Modi ka wada* should have been implemented.

"PM Modi earlier said that it was *Modi ka wada*, which means it was extraordinary from a normal promise. If it was *Modi ka wada*, then it should have been implemented as well," Omar said in the Assembly after tabling the resolution.

The Resolution read, "In addition to the resolutions passed by this House on 26 June 2000 and 6 November 2024, the House calls upon the Government of India for the immediate and urgent restoration of full Statehood to Jammu and Kashmir and

J&K Chief Minister Omar Abdullah raised slogans against BJP leaders in Srinagar

resolves that this resolution be forwarded to the Government of India." The NC-led Government,

headed by Farooq Abdullah, passed a resolution on June 26, 2000, calling for the restoration of greater autonomy as it existed before August 9, 1953.

On November 6, 2024, the house passed a resolution seeking the restoration of special status. Members occupying the treasury benches welcomed the tabling of the resolution with thumping of desks. However, the reference to the 2000 resolution triggered protests from BJP members.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

CBI nabs key accused targeting US nationals

FILE PHOTO

PIONEER IN SHORT

FREE RO WATER AT DELHI METRO STATIONS

A residents' body representing over 2,500 RWAs in Delhi urged the DMRC to install or restore RO-based drinking water coolers at all Metro stations, saying commuters, particularly senior citizens, women, children and persons with disabilities, are forced to buy bottled water. In a letter to the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) chairman and managing director on Friday, United Residents Joint Action (URJA) said drinking water coolers were either non-functional, missing or inaccessible at several stations. The organisation said commuters often have to purchase bottled water costing around ₹20, particularly during summer and while travelling through large interchange stations such as Kashmere Gate, Rajiv Chowk and Hauz Khas. URJA, which describes itself as an apex body of resident welfare associations in Delhi, requested the DMRC to install two to four RO and water-cooler units at each station.

Six booked, three detained in Mandar Hill assault

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Patna

A group of young men allegedly surrounded a woman at Mandar Hill, a historic tourist and pilgrimage site in Bihar's Banka district, grabbed her, abused her and struck her with a slipper.

At the same time, companions were shoved and held by their collars. One man is seen with a stick. The episode was filmed. The clip later spread online with a song overlay that appeared to glorify the conduct.

That footage, not a contemporaneous complaint from the victim, is what finally forced official action. The video, dated 3 September, only reached the Bousni police on 22 September at about 2:45 p.m. through the district social media cell on WhatsApp, sent to Station House Officer Pankaj Kumar

A woman was allegedly assaulted by a group of young men at Bihar's Mandar Hill

Jha. Within minutes, senior officers sent a team to the hill. By around 3 pm, police had matched the locations in the video to Mandar Hill and started questioning people in the area.

None at the scene could immediately identify the men or the woman. Jha filed a suo motu FIR against six unidentified youths, using the video as the main evidence. The FIR lists Sections 74, 75, 76, and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, along with Sections 66E and 67A of the Information Technology Act. Section 74 covers assault or criminal force against a woman with intent to outrage her modesty, punishable by one to five years

of the holy site, Joshi pointed out that even the traditional blowing of a conch shell is prohibited in the ecologically and spiritually sensitive shrine zone. Organising loud, high-decibel music events, he argued, reflects a grave neglect of India's spiritual, cultural, and environmental heritage.

Expressing deep concern over the commercialisation

in prison and a fine; Section 75 deals with sexual harassment, including unwelcome physical contact and sexually coloured remarks.

Section 76 is the most serious: assault or criminal force, or helping with it, with intent to disrobe a woman or force her to be naked, which carries three to seven years in prison and a fine. Section 3(5) makes all participants with a shared intention responsible, so police named six men as unknown accused before matching faces.

The IT sections focus on recording and sharing the video. Section 66E covers capturing or sending images that violate privacy, while Section 67A deals with publishing or sharing sexually explicit material online. After the FIR was filed, the identification process moved faster.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

AI suspends pilot after alcohol test at Zurich Airport

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

Air India has suspended a pilot after he failed a breathalyser test at Zurich Airport earlier this month, moments before he was scheduled to operate a flight to Delhi, in the latest incident raising concerns about strict compliance with aviation safety regulations.

The pilot was due to operate Air India flight AI151 from Zurich to Delhi on September 6 when airport personnel detected the smell of alcohol, officials said on Friday.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested the main suspect in a major cross-border financial crime. This operation is believed to have defrauded American citizens of over US\$7.21 million. The case, registered on 8 September 2026, involves an illegal syndicate based in Ahmedabad, Gujarat, active since 2024. Investigators describe a tightly organised network that used Voice-over-Internet-Protocol lines to reach victims in the United States.

The callers claimed to be representatives of the Federal Trade Commission, the US Attorney's Office, the Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency, and other federal organisations.

They informed the victims that their personal information had been used to gain access to illegal online content and that serious legal

repercussions would be imposed if they did not cooperate. Under this pressure, the victims were instructed to withdraw cash from their bank accounts, turn the money into gold, and then give the gold to courier contacts they had already arranged in the United States.

The losses, which amounted to more than seven million dollars, suggest a well-funded, ongoing operation rather than a series of separate incidents. After registering the case, CBI teams conducted coordinated searches at several places in Ahmedabad linked to the accused. Police seized electronic equipment containing the operation's digital records.

On 23 September 2026, authorities arrested the person who played a key role in setting up and running the illegal call centre. The investigation is still ongoing as officers continue to identify other syndicate members and trace the movement of funds.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

DJ noise nuisance spreads to Badrinath Dham

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

High decibel levels of DJs are already a nuisance and a serious health hazard in many parts of the country despite repeated appeals.

Now, the growing menace has even reached the holy shrine of Badrinath Dham. While concerns raised by commoners may not carry much weight, a strong statement by BJP veteran and former Union Minister Murli Manohar Joshi will surely force the authorities to act.

Flagging the issue, he has strongly condemned the permission granted for a DJ

music concert at Badrinath Dham, terming it a direct assault on the sanctity and cultural decorum of the

Organising loud, high-decibel music events reflects a grave neglect of India's spiritual, cultural, and environmental heritage

— MURLI MANOHAR JOSHI

sacred Himalayan shrine. In a sharply worded statement, the veteran leader highlighted that the ancient Dham was established by Adi Guru Shankaracharya Maharaj in the serene Himalayan surroundings specifically for peaceful devotion and divine hymns.

Expressing deep concern over the commercialisation

of the holy site, Joshi pointed out that even the traditional blowing of a conch shell is prohibited in the ecologically and spiritually sensitive shrine zone. Organising loud, high-decibel music events, he argued, reflects a grave neglect of India's spiritual, cultural, and environmental heritage.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

GOLDEN AIM

India's Suruchi Singh (left) and Kamaljeet celebrate after winning a gold medal in the 10-metre air pistol mixed team final at the Asian Games 2026 in Japan (Related Reports on P15)

Grief at Noida mortuary after bus fire kills nine, six victims identified

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Grieving families gathered at a post-mortem house in Sector 94 in Noida on Friday, struggling to identify loved ones killed a day ago when a sleeper bus caught fire on the Yamuna Expressway, with police identifying six of the nine deceased so far.

The bus, travelling from Kashmere Gate in Delhi to Mahoba in Uttar Pradesh, caught fire around 11.20 pm on Wednesday near the 33-km milestone of the expressway, killing nine passengers, according to officials.

At the Sector 94 post-mortem house, relatives waited anxiously as the charred condition of the bodies made identification difficult. Among those at the mortuary was Sarvagya, son of Rekha Bhardwaj, an injured passenger who survived the incident. Rekha had been travelling with her husband Devendra Sahay Bhardwaj, who died in the fire.

Sarvagya said his father, a



retired teacher from a university in Hissar, Haryana, and his mother were travelling to Mahoba to attend the last rites of his grandmother.

Another family, siblings Shivam and Nancy, spent hours at the mortuary after learning about the bus fire. They eventually identified the bodies of their mother and brother after considerable difficulty and were seen consoling each other while waiting for officials to allow them to complete the formalities.

In another case, Ayushi, the granddaughter of one of the deceased, identified the body with the help of an anklet that

had been gifted by her son, highlighting the difficulty faced by families in identifying the victims because of the extensive burns.

Police have identified six of the deceased as Shruti Rawat (31), a resident of Chhatrapur in Madhya Pradesh; Saroj Gupta (52) and Mayank Gupta (28), both residents of Mughalpuria Bazar in Rath, Hamirpur; Devendra Sahay Bhardwaj (60), a resident of Chandra Nagar village in Hissar, Haryana; Har Sharan Gupta (55), a resident of Balaji Palace in Rajendra Nagar under Orai police station in Jalaun district; and Usha Devi

(65), a resident of Main Road, Muskura, Hamirpur.

Police have arrested two drivers and a conductor in connection with the incident. The drivers have been identified as Pawan and Yogesh Dixit, both residents of Kanpur Dehat, while the conductor has been identified as Rohit, also a resident of Kanpur Dehat.

During interrogation, the accused told the police that they were travelling from Kashmere Gate to Mahoba on Wednesday night. The accused allegedly abandoned the vehicle and fled after it suddenly caught fire.

An FIR has been registered under BNS Sections 281 (rash driving), 125(b) (endangering life), 105 (culpable homicide), among others, police said.

Rajesh Mohan, a Public Transport Officer with the Gautam Buddh Nagar Regional Transport Office, told PTI that the bus, bearing registration number BR32PA8647, had accumulated fines totalling ₹1.75 lakh through 19 challans.

Capital plants 70 lakh saplings under Mission Green Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi has completed its target of planting 70 lakh saplings under "Mission Green Delhi," Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced on Friday, describing the achievement as the result of sustained efforts to expand the Capital's green cover, strengthen its ecosystem and work toward cleaner air.

The Chief Minister said the Mega Plantation Drive-2026 was launched on July 7 this year on the occasion of Van Mahotsav by Union Minister for Home and Cooperation Amit Shah. With support and guidance from the Central Government, the campaign was taken forward across Delhi under close monitoring by the Delhi Government.

Delhi's green agencies and various Government departments, along with local bodies, public institutions, non-Governmental organisations, schools, colleges, RWAs and citizens, actively participated in the campaign, which the Chief Minister said transformed "Mission Green Delhi" from a Government programme into a people's movement.

Special plantation drives were carried out in the Central Ridge, DDA Ridge and South Ridge areas, considered important to Delhi's ecology, with a total of 24,94,505 saplings planted across these Ridge areas.

The Chief Minister said strengthening natural green areas forms an important part of Delhi's long-term environmen-

Mega Plantation Drive Status 2026-27			
S.No.	Agency Name	Target	Achievement
1.	Department of Forests and Wildlife, GNCTD*	27,29,200	32,03,358
2.	Delhi Development Authority	23,48,109	20,11,321
3.	New Delhi Municipal Council	5,05,100	5,03,029
4.	Municipal Corporation of Delhi	5,00,000	3,42,216
5.	Education Department	3,50,000	3,56,086
6.	Public Works Department	3,05,000	2,36,370
7.	National Highways Authority of India	60,000	68,210
8.	BSES Roshni Power Limited	47,411	47,415
9.	Technical Education	41,000	14,118
10.	Integrator and Flood Control	35,000	8,175
11.	Central Public Works Department	30,000	24,934
12.	Dissemination of Higher Education, GNCTD	25,560	30,394
13.	DSIIDC	20,000	27,844
14.	Delhi Jal Board	20,000	34,006
15.	Delhi Parks and Gardens Society	15,400	17,653
16.	Delhi Cantonment Board	12,050	89,050
17.	Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board	9,000	9,126
18.	Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited (NDPL)	9,000	9,070
19.	Delhi Metro Rail Corporation	2,500	2,254
20.	Delhi Transport Corporation	2,000	2,021
21.	Religious Institutions	1,534	1,061
22.	Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited	1,000	1,000
Grand Total		70,73,285	71,12,429

*Inclusive of Free distribution of saplings - 7.79 lakhs

tal strategy, expected to support ecosystem restoration, biodiversity conservation and environmental improvement.

The Chief Minister said achieving the 70 lakh sapling target demonstrates that major environmental goals can be met when the Government and citizens work as partners, calling every sapling planted an investment in cleaner air, greater greenery and a healthier future for children.

She said the Government's efforts would not be limited to planting, but would give equal attention to protect-

M.P. POWER GENERATING COMPANY LIMITED
O/o Executive Director (Material Management)
ISO 9001:2015 Certified
Govt. OF M.P., Undertaking CIN - U- 40109MP2001SGC014882
BLOCK No.8, GROUND FLOOR, SHAKTI BHAVAN, VIDYUT NAGAR, RAMPUR, JABALPUR 482008 (M.P.)
Phone No. : 0761-2702700, E-Mail : cesnmpmpper@rediffmail.com, Website : www.mppgcl.gov.in
Date : 23.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT) NO. CE (MM) NIT-300
"Through E-tendering process only"
M.P. Power Generating Co Ltd. invites Electronic Tenders from reputed/established Manufacturers/ Authorized Dealers/Authorized Distributor/Suppliers/Contractor/Service Provider/Firm for the following items/Works for various Power Stations of MPPGCL:

S.N.	Tender ID	Tender Particulars	Estimated Tender Cost (Rs. in Lakh)	EMD (Rs. in Lakh)	Date and Time for closing of online submission	Date and Time for opening of e-tender
1.	2026 MPPGC 527631_1	Manufacture and supply of Ceramic Lined Multiple Port Outlet and Ceramic Lined Mill Discharge Valves Assy. with flap and flap cover of MDV for PH-III, SGTPS, Birsinghpur, PH-IV, STPS, Sami & PH-III, ATPS-Chachai	104	2.00	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards
2.	2026 MPPGC 527632_1	Manufacture & supply of M.S. Straight Pipe Carbon Steel Pipe, P.F. Straight Coal Pipe, Centre Feed Pipe and Coal Chute for PH-I/II, SSTPP-Dongalia, PH-IV, STPS-Sami.	225	2.25	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards
3.	2026 MPPGC 527642_1	Manufacture and Supply of Various Types of Conveyor Rollers for Coal Handling Plants of SSTPP-Dongalia, STPS-Sami, ATPS-Chachai And SGTPS-Birsinghpur	1018	10.18	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards
4.	2026 MPPGC 527644_1	Manufacture & Supply of Roller Journal Shafts for BHEL make XRP-883, 210 MW at PH-III, ATPS, Chachai	24	0.48	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards
5.	2026 MPPGC 527649_1	Manufacture and supply of Forged Steel Toothed Ring Hammer for Coal Handling Plant of CHP-I SSTPP MPPGCL, Dongalia	126	2.00	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards
6.	2026 MPPGC 535576_1	Manufacture and Supply of M.S. Straight Pipe, Carbon Steel Pipe, P.F. Straight Coal Pipe and Centre Feed Pipe for PH-III, SGTPS-Birsinghpur.	270	2.70	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards
7.	2026 MPPGC 535346_1	Procurement of Electric Resistance Welded/Submerged Arc Welded Steel Pipes for Various Thermal Power Stations of MPPGCL for Two Year Rate Contract	Annualized Estimated Value: 2767.64 Lakhs	29.49	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards
8.	2026 MPPGC 527629_1	Manufacture and supply of Ceramic Lined Orifice, Bends, Elbow, Two Way Splitter and Spool Piece for SSTPP-Dongalia, ATPS-Chachai and STPS-Sami	195	2.00	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards
9.	2026 MPPGC 527635_1	Manufacture and supply of Victaulic Type Couplings for PH-II, SGTPS-Birsinghpur & PH-IV, STPS-Sami, Outlet Ventury Assembly & MPO Outlet Spool/piece for PH-II, SGTPS-Birsinghpur, Air seal Ring Upper for PH-IV, STPS-Sami	140	2.00	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards
10.	2026 MPPGC 537552_1	Manufacture and supply of Ceramic Lined Orifice & Bends for SGTPS-Birsinghpur	245	2.45	14.10.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs.	16.10.2026 From 15:30 Hrs. onwards

These tenders are being invited through an e-tendering system. For viewing detailed NIT, downloading tender documents and participating in Electronic Tenders, for any clarifications and/or due date extension or corrigendum, please visit the website www.mptenders.gov.in regularly. Any clarifications and/ or due date extension or corrigendum shall be issued on the website www.mptenders.gov.in only.

M.P. Madhyam/128214/2026 // SAVE ELECTRICITY // CHIEF ENGINEER (MM)

PUBLIC NOTICE
Re: Plot No. 42/6, area measuring 200.00 sq. mtrs. Situated at Greater Noida, Distt- Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P., hereinafter referred to as "said property".
NOTICE is hereby given to general public that our client Mr. Rajat Goyal (hereinafter referred to as the "purchaser") is intending to purchase the said property from Mr. Adarsh Rashid (hereinafter referred to as the "seller") who owned the said property vide Transfer Deed dated 23.05.2024 executed by Mr. Dasha registered as Document No. 15316, Book No. I, Volume No. 44809, on Page No. 179-194, registered on dated 24.05.2024, SRO-Greater Noida. The Seller has further informed that the said property initially owned by Mr. Dasha vide Allotment letter cum demand letter dated 11.11.2009 and Lease Deed dated 15.03.2024. It has been also informed that Lease Deed dated 15.03.2024 executed by GNDA in favour of Mr. Dasha registered as Document No. 10737, Book No. I, Volume No. 44577, on Page No. 255-272, registered on dated 10.04.2024, SRO-Greater Noida and also forming part of chain documents, is herein after called the "said document" has been lost/misplaced and is not traceable. A FIR to this effect has also been lodged vide L.R. No. 658382/2025 dated 24.05.2026 with Okhla Industrial Area/E-Police Station.
(If the aforesaid original document (the said document) or any one of them is found or has been found by any person, the same may be returned and delivered to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below. Further, if any person, body, institution is having any claim and/or objection in respect of the said property, he/she may raise his/their objection/s, in writing, with documentary evidence, by Registered AD Post, to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below within 15 days of publication of this notice. Otherwise, after expiry of 15 days from the date of publication of this notice, no objection shall be acceptable.
General Public may also take note that any objection or transaction on any of the said document/s of the said document or any of the said document shall be illegal and not binding on our client. The person doing so shall be liable to be prosecuted under the law.
SHIVKANT ARORA, ADVOCATE FOR M/S INTELLECTIVE LAW OFFICES A-74, LOWER GROUND FLOOR, DEFENCE COLONY, NEW DELHI-110024

PUBLIC NOTICE
My Client Bank Dev W/o Rajender Kumar Darji R/o A-32B, Weavers Colony, Ashok Vihar, Phase-4, Delhi-82 have debarred & disowned her daughter Monika (A.No.7854 6083 3287) from all her movable & immovable properties due to her disreputable behavior & being out of control of my client. My client has also severed all her relations with her. If anybody deals with her in any manner, then he/she shall do so at his/her own risk, costs & consequences. My client shall not be liable and responsible for the same in any manner.
PRASHANT KUMAR (Advocate)
Ch.No.6, Civil Side, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi-54

PUBLIC NOTICE
The general public is hereby informed that my client Mr. Vijay Satija S/o Surinder Kumar R/o A-1/14, First Floor, R.P. Bagh, Delhi-110007 is purchasing Entire First Floor on Land measuring 100 sq. yds. with back side portion of Second Floor measuring 50 sq. yds along with Terrace Roof measuring 50 sq. yds of property bearing no. D-54AB (Tewari South), Vijay Nagar, Single Storey, Delhi-9 from Mr. Babir Kashap, if any person has any right / title / interest / claim of any nature whatsoever regarding the said property under purchase then the same be intimated to undersigned in writing within seven days from today.
ASHWANI KUMAR GUPTA (Advocate)
B-82, C.C. Colony, Delhi-110007

PUBLIC NOTICE
My client Sh. Raju, S/o Sh. Ranjeet Singh and Smt. Komal W/o Sh. Raju, both R/o H.No. RZ-56, Sayad Village, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110087, have severed all their relations with their daughter Radhika Bawal and have disowned and debarred her from their movable and immovable properties. Any person dealing with the said Radhika Bawal, shall do so at his/her own risk. My client and the other family members shall not be responsible or liable for any of her acts, deeds, debts transactions or liabilities.
(SANDIP KUMAR SHARMA) ADVOCATE
Enrol No. D/8969/2025

AXIS BANK
Retail Asset Centre: Axis House, Jaypee Green Wish Town, Tower-2, 2nd Floor, Sec-128, Noida Expressway, Noida-201301 | Corp. Off.: 'Axis House', Block-B, Bombay Dyeing Mills Compound, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400025 | Regd. Off.: Tishru, 3rd floor, opp. Samartheeswar Temple, Law garden, Ellsbridge, Ahmedabad-380006 | Also at: Axis Bank Ltd., P.F.Himalaya House, Camanaghat Place, New Delhi-110001

Publication of Notice regarding possession of property u/s 13(4) of SARFAESI Act 2002
Notice is hereby given under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with rule 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, a demand notice was issued on the dates mentioned against each account and stated hereafter calling upon them to repay the amount within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice. The Borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of power conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 9 of the said Act on the dates mentioned against each account. The Borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Axis Bank Ltd. for an amount and interest thereon. The borrowers attention is invited to provisions of Sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available to redeem the secured assets.
Name of Borrower/Guarantor/Address: 1. Mr. Pankaj Gulati S/o Mr. Yas Gulati AE-33, Ground Floor, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi 110088 Also At: Mr. Pankaj Gulati S/o Mr. Yas Gulati Pk Road Shop-451-452 Old Leggat Rail Market Delhi 110006 (Borrower) 2. Mrs. Priyanka Gulati W/o Mr. Pankaj Gulati AE-33, Ground Floor, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi 110088 (Co-borrower) 3. Mrs. Veena Gulati W/o Mr. Yas Gulati AE-33 Ground Floor, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi 110088 (Co-borrower) Description of Immovable Property : Residential Builtup Plot Bearing No. 33 in Block-ae, Situated in The Layout Plan: Shalimar Bagh Residential Scheme Presently Known As Shalimar Bagh, Delhi And Bounded As Under - East : Plot No. 34, West: Plot No. 32, North: Road 24 M/RW, South: Service Lane.

Date of Demand Notice:	Date of Possession	Amount Outstanding :
03.07.2026	25.09.2026	Rs. 4,91,92,636.67/- (Rupees Four Crore Ninety One Lakhs Ninety Two Thousand Six Hundred Thirty Six and Paise Sixty Seven Only)

Place: Noida, Date: 25.09.2026
-SD/- Authorized Officer, Axis Bank Ltd.

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given to the general public that Shri Sunil Kumar Soni desires to sell the property bearing No. J-5/110, Rajouri Garden, New Delhi - 110027, admeasuring 160 sq. yds. ("said property").
The title of the said property originates from the Sale Deed executed by D.L.F. Housing & Construction Ltd. in favour of Shri S.P. Soni, whereby the property bearing Plot No. J-5/110, Block J-5, Rajouri Garden, Delhi, admeasuring 160 sq. yds., was conveyed to the purchaser. The said Sale Deed records the property as being free from liens, attachments, injunctions, charges, encumbrances, demands and disputes.
Subsequently, Mrs. Neelam Mitter and Mrs. Renuka, being the legal heirs/relatives, executed a registered Relinquishment Deed dated 28.01.2011, registered as Document No. 2106, in favour of Shri Sunil Kumar Soni, relinquishing their respective rights, title and interest in the said property. The said deed records Shri Sunil Kumar Soni as the sole and absolute owner of the property.
As per the title documents available with the owner, there is no known subsisting dispute, claim, lien, charge, encumbrance or other third-party interest in respect of the said property. However, any person including any legal heir, successor, claimant, co-owner or any other person having or claiming any right, title, interest, share, lien, charge, encumbrance or objection of whatsoever nature in respect of the said property is hereby called upon to intimate/raise such claim or objection in writing, along with supporting documents, within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. Any such claim/objection may be addressed to:
Pooja Vohra (Advocate)
M.: 8377915515, E-mail: poojavohra.adv@gmail.com
Ch.-67, Civil Wing, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi - 110054

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	03263126	OVERHEAD DOUBLE ACTING CONCEALED DOOR CLOSER	8129 NOS	14-10-26
02	122600310	EARTHING CABLE FOR WHEEL SET	6364 NOS	19-10-26
03	09262017	CONSTANT CONTACT SIDE BEARER	3511 NOS	19-10-26
04	14260924	SILICON RUBBER COMPOUND	17380 NOS	21-10-26
05	07265097	SS UNDERSLING WATER TANK	6 NOS	24-10-26
06	09262114	LOCK	30646 NOS	26-10-26
07	06265036A	RHS 40 X 80 X 4.00 MM CONFORMING	120000 KGS	27-10-26
08	07265073	SUPPLY AND FITMENT OF UPHOLSTERY	1024 NOS	27-10-26
09	07269054	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PROCUREMENT OF PRESTRESSED CONCRETE SLEEPERS	200 SET	10-11-26

NOTE -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No. 45/2026-2027 Dated : 25.09.2026

3353/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

MISSING DOCUMENT
M/s. Vaisht Info Systems Private Limited has approached ICICI Bank Ltd., Ghaziabad, U.P. (Bank) to avail a Loan against mortgage of Industrial Plot No. 18, (780 sq. mtrs.), Block-C, Sector-03, Noida, Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P. and represented that it is the absolute owner of the said property by virtue of Transfer Deed dated 22.02.2019 (Doc. no. 1028) executed by Mr. Ashok Wadhawan. It has further represented that the Lease Deed dated 15.04.1980 (Doc. no. 118/119), Allotment Letter dated 29.12.1977 & Possession Certificate have misplaced/lost and Complaint for its loss has been lodged with PS, Sector-39, Noida vide General Diary No. 36/26.12.2011. If anybody, person, body corporate has any right, lien or claim whatsoever on the said property on the basis of lost document/s or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 07 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim or objection shall be entertained thereafter and Bank shall proceed to advance the loan on mortgaging of the said property.
Amit Kumar, Advocate Narang & Associates D-28, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi-110014.

भारतीय विमानपत्तन प्राधिकरण
AIRPORTS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(Schedule-'A' Mini Ratna Category-1 Public Sector Enterprise)
Rajiv Gandhi Bhawan, Safdarjung Airport, New Delhi-110003

ENGAGEMENT OF SHORT SERVICE COMMISSION OFFICERS, RETIRED FROM INDIAN ARMED FORCES, AS CONSULTANT IN AAI ON CONTRACT BASIS
(Advt. No. 14/2026/CHQ/SSCOs)

- Airports Authority of India (AAI) invites applications for engagement of Retired Short Service Commission Officers of Indian Armed Forces as Consultant in AAI to support Air Traffic Services Unit at various Joint User Defence Airfields/Airports for a period of one year on contract basis.
- For detailed Location-wise positions, Upper Age Limit, Educational and Professional Qualifications and Required Experience, Application Format and for other details, please refer to the detailed Advertisement under Advt. No.14/2026/CHQ/SSCOs, available at Career Section of AAI Website at www.aai.aero→Career→Recruitment Dashboard.
- Any corrigendum/addendum and further information shall be published on the referred website only.
- Applications can be sent from **17.09.2026** and the last date of receipt of application will be **11.10.2026**.
CBC 03111/11/0008/2627 N-03/2026-27(CC)

PUBLIC NOTICE
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Pooja Vohra (Advocate)
M.: 8377915515, E-mail: poojavohra.adv@gmail.com
Ch.-67, Civil Wing, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi - 110054

CHANGE OF NAME
I, Divya, W/o- JC-708245X
Nb/Sub (NT) S Siva Kesava Rao Borra, Unit- Army Hospital R & R, Delhi Cantt-110010, have changed my name from Divya to Borra Divya, vide affidavit dated 25/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Sharda Devi, Mother of JC-747520N
NbSub Manoj Kumar, R/o- Vill- Ikonda, PO- Bhavanipur, Dist- Amroha, U.P.- 244221, have changed my name from Sharda Devi to Sharda, vide affidavit dated 25/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Ram Chander Jakhar, Father of No.3206974F
Hav Jaiver, R/o- Vill- Khariya Bass, PO- Sankhu Fort, Rajasthan - 331303, declare that in my Son's service record my name is wrongly recorded as Ramchandra Jakhar, whereas my correct name is Ram Chander Jakhar, which may be amended accordingly.

I, Kaluram, Father of No.15725062K
Hav Yadav Vishal Kaluram, R/o- Vill- Malshiras, Teh- Purandar, Dist- Pune, Maharashtra- 412104, have changed my name from Kaluram to Lata Kaluram Yadav, vide affidavit dated 25/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Anita Devi W/o Mukesh Kumar R/o Vill- Jarwa, Distt Mahendragarh, Haryana,
hereby inform the general public regarding my property ID No. 7GVF3BE5, Adarsh Colony, Mahendragarh, Haryana- 123029 for my Sale Deed No. 689 (dated 23/05/2010), the approval letter, and the map issued by the MC (Map No. 1(15), dated 07/05/2012) are in a laminated condition.

I, Bandana Maurya W/o No.650518M
Sep Shobh Nath Maurya, R/o- Vill- Mahsin, PO- Rashouipur, Dist- Basti, U.P.- 272002, have changed my name from Bandana Maurya to Kumari Bandana, vide affidavit dated 25/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, hitherto known as Savita Rani W/o- Udhm Singh, R/o- WZ- 1329 A, 2nd Floor, Nangal Raya, South West Delhi, Delhi - 110046,
have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Sabita Rani.

I, Somvati, Mother of No.18004559K
Nk Ashwani Kumar, R/o- Vill- Manpur, PO- Naugava Santosh, P.S & Teh- Bisalpur & Bilsanda, Dist- Pilibhit, U.P.- 262201, have changed my name from Somvati to Sovrani, vide affidavit dated 25/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Pradeep Kumar Yadav S/o- Rohtash, R/o- Vill- Janjarlawas, PO/Teh-Dist- Mahendragarh, Haryana,
declare that name of mine & my wife has been wrongly written as Pradeep Yadav & Sunita in my minor son namely Aman Yadav aged 14 years in his School Records. The actual name of mine & my wife is Pradeep Kumar Yadav & Sunita Yadav respectively which may be amended accordingly.

I, Sunny Tanwar S/o Jatan Singh R/o House No. 30, Gujar Mohalla, Village Chandan Hala, Chandan Hala, PO. Chandanhoola, Dist. - South Delhi. Delhi-110074
have changed the name of my minor son Abhinav Tanwar aged 13 years and he shall hereafter be known as **ARNAV TANWAR**. It is certified that I have complied with other legal requirement in this connection.

I, Anita Singh W/o Sukhdesh Singh R/o L-183, Jalvayu Vihar, Sector-25, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P.-201301
declare that My Correct name is Anita Singh as per Aadhar Card No. 274725505947. My Correct name is Anita Chaudhary & Anita Singh are same person.

I was crying in pain: 17-year-old recounts gang rape horror

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

“I was crying in pain” — a 17-year-old girl told police as she recounted the ordeal she went through inside southeast Delhi’s Astha Kunj Park, where three men allegedly separated the girl from her friend, snatched their phones and took her to an isolated part of the park before raping her at knifepoint.

The survivor’s first statement to the police forms a crucial part of the ongoing investigation into the alleged gangrape that took place on September 21 evening.

According to her statement, the girl and her 17-year-old male friend went to the park after offering prayers at Kalkaji Mandir and sat on a bench eating chips when three men approached them.

“Why have you come here at this time? It is not allowed to come here,” the men allegedly asked the two before separating them and taking them towards different sides of the park.

When the frightened girl asked not to separate her and told them to talk to her mother if they wanted, one of the



accused said, “Asif bhai gun nikal (Take out the gun, Asif)”.

The accused allegedly took away their mobile phone and led the girl towards an isolated stretch, where she said the men threatened her with knives. According to her statement, Asif allegedly removed her clothes, placed her on a red bench and asked another accused, identified as Hemu, to stand guard.

“He kept a knife on my neck while raping me. I was crying; I was feeling a lot of pain,” she said, while recounting the ordeal she had to go through with Asif raping her while holding a knife to her neck.

She further alleged that Hemu then took her to

another bench and sexually assaulted her while threatening her with a knife.

The third accused, identified by the survivor as Deepu, allegedly sexually assaulted her thereafter, also while holding a knife to her neck, according to the statement.

The survivor also claimed that Asif used a condom during the assault while the other two discharged on the side.

After the alleged assault, they gave her the clothes except the undergarments and told her to put on her clothes quickly. They threatened to kill her and her friend if they told anyone about the incident.

The accused allegedly

returned their mobile phones and took the girl and her friend out of the park.

The girl then told her friend what had happened, following which he called the police control room. Police records show that a PCR call was received around 8.45 pm, after which a police team reached the survivor and her friend near Gate No. 7 of Astha Kunj Park.

The survivor subsequently guided the forensic science team to the spot where she alleged that the assault took place. The FSL and district mobile crime team examined the area and collected biological and other evidence, including condoms found near the alleged crime spot, for forensic examination and DNA testing, officials said.

The case has since seen multiple arrests, with one of the accused, Asif, being injured in an exchange of fire with police. The incident has also raised concerns over security arrangements at the sprawling 142-acre park, including poorly lit stretches, broken portions of the boundary wall and multiple access points that visitors and vendors say remain difficult to monitor after dark.

LSR tightens security; patrolling stepped up

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Lady Shri Ram College for Women (LSR) on Friday reviewed security around the campus, with enhanced patrolling and other safety measures being implemented in the area following the alleged rape of a minor at the nearby Aastha Kunj Park.

The LSR Students’ Union said it is receiving regular updates on increased patrolling around the college, including in the National Park and Vikram Vihar. This includes patrolling by the Delhi Police’s Pink Squad.

On Thursday, the college said a WhatsApp group comprising the LSR administration, students’ union and senior police personnel was created to facilitate timely action and enable students to report incidents and concerns.

The presence of police personnel has been ensured at the Pink Booth near the college and at its back gate, while work is underway to improve street lighting on the road behind the college, the students’ union said.

Security is being fortified at specific locations around the college that the stu-



dents identified as unsafe or requiring attention, it said.

These were “important steps”, the students’ union said, stressing that the process would continue, with efforts focused on checking whether the measures were visible and effective on the ground.

It urged students to continue sharing their experiences and feedback on what has improved, what remains unchanged and what requires further attention.

The measures followed the alleged rape of a 17-year-old girl inside Aastha Kunj Park near Kalkaji Mandir on Monday. The incident, which occurred around 2 kilometres from the college, had triggered concerns among students, particularly over their safety while travelling to and from the campus in the evenings.

Several LSR students participated in a solidarity march on Wednesday demanding better security

infrastructure and highlighting safety concerns they said had existed even before the unfortunate incident.

The college administration, students’ union and senior Delhi Police officials had also held an open dialogue with students on the issue.

LSR resumed offline classes on Thursday after cancelling them on Tuesday and shifting the classes online on Wednesday amid safety concerns.

30 rescued after fire breaks out at Haldiram outlet in Model Town



The damaged exterior of a multi-storey building housing a Haldiram outlet after a fire broke out on its upper floors in the Model Town area of northwest Delhi on Friday. Around 30 people were safely evacuated by police and rescue personnel, no casualties were reported



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Around 30 people were rescued after a fire broke out in a three-storey building housing a Haldiram outlet and adjoining structures in northwest Delhi’s Model Town area on Friday.

The fire broke out around 2 pm, following which Head Constable Pawan, the beat officer of Model Town police station, became the first responder and alerted senior officers, police said.

Thick smoke billowed from the building, which has a basement, ground floor, and three upper floors.

The Delhi Fire Service received a call about the blaze at around 2.40 pm and initially rushed four fire tenders to the spot.

As the fire intensified, the DFS deployed 23 units, including a hydraulic platform, officials said.

The police team evacuated occupants of the affected building as well as those in adjoining buildings, safely rescuing a total of 30 people, police said.

“The building has a basement, ground floor, and three floors. On the ground and first floor there is Haldiram, and on the second and third floor there is one more restaurant. The fire spread to all floors. We have searched the entire building, and no one was trapped inside,” a DFS officer said.

The blaze, suspected to have been caused by a short circuit, broke out in a multi-storey building housing the

Haldiram outlet and other establishments.

“The fire was classified as a medium fire at 3.30 pm and was brought under control around 4 pm,” he said.

Speaking to reporters, Md Sajid, assistant Bank manager of a private bank, said, “As soon as the short circuit happened, the guard informed us that fire had broken out and we should evacuate the building. The fire started from the ground floor and engulfed the whole building. We used a fire extinguisher in our office to try to extinguish the fire as much as we could on an individual level.”

No injury or casualty was reported due to the timely police response and prompt evacuation, they said.

Shah to inaugurate Barapullah Phase-3 on September 29

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Home Minister Amit Shah is likely to inaugurate four major road infrastructure projects on September 29, including the Barapullah Phase-3 elevated corridor, Delhi Public Works Department Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Friday.

Singh said Shah will also lay down the foundation stone for two new flyovers — Modi Mill to Kalkaji and Savitri Cinema half flyover — on September 29.

“The Mukarba Chowk underpass, which has been completed, will also be inaugurated on the same day by the home minister. The projects altogether will be a major step towards resolving the traffic congestion problems in the city,” Singh said.

The Barapullah-Phase 3 corridor, which is the biggest of the four projects, aims to provide seamless connectivity between East and South



Delhi, linking Mayur Vihar Phase-1 and AIIMS via signal-free carriageways. The new flyover will merge with the existing Barapullah flyover at Sarai Kale Khan, completing a stretch of around 9 km.

Originally approved in 2014 and initiated in 2015, the project was initially scheduled for completion in 2017. However, it faced multiple delays and significant cost

overruns, and the revised project cost is now approximately Rs 1,635 crore.

In South Delhi, the PWD is extending the Modi Mill flyover to the Kalkaji Temple flyover and constructing additional half-flyovers at key intersections to create a 7.2-km signal-free corridor to the IIT Gate. It will have three lanes in both directions, enabling smoother and unin-

terrupted traffic flow.

The third project is the construction of a half-flyover beside the existing Savitri Cinema, a 435-metre, three-lane single carriageway. Initially approved by the UTTIPEC in 2017, the project has faced delays due to a lack of financial and administrative approvals from the Government.

This flyover is expected to ease traffic congestion for

commuters going towards Nehru Place, Okhla, and other areas, as the PWD has planned to expand the existing single carriageway into a dual carriageway.

Both the Modi Mill and Savitri Cinema flyovers are being constructed at an estimated cost of Rs 371.75 crore.

“Once operational, the flyovers will provide signal-free movement, improve traffic speeds, and eliminate congestion at key junctions, particularly at Captain Gaur Marg-Outer Ring Road and Outer Ring Road-GK-II Road,” a Government official said.

The fourth project is the Mukarba Chowk underpass in North Delhi, which is complete. It comprises three underpasses near Gate Number 3 of Haiderpur Badli Mor Metro station and falls under the Shalimar Bagh assembly constituency.

The Outer Ring Road project stalled in 2022 due to the COVID pandemic and has now been completed.

Two DU students held for stalking, harassing Hindu College students; SUV seized



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Two DU students were arrested on Friday in connection with the alleged harassment of two Hindu College students in northwest Delhi’s Mukherjee Nagar. At the same time, police also seized a sports utility vehicle (SUV) used by them, an official said.

Accused Abhinav and Abhimanyu are students of Delhi University (DU), he added.

According to the complainant, she and her friend were walking in the Mukherjee Nagar area on Wednesday evening when a white car approached them and the men inside allegedly made comments.

When the women objected, the men allegedly abused them and started following them.

The complainant has alleged that when she and her friend stopped to film the incident, the car also stopped and the men attempted to pull them into the vehicle.

The accused fled when

the complainant’s friend started filming the car.

Based on the complaint, an FIR was registered at the Mukherjee Nagar police station under sections 78 (stalking), 79 (word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman) and 3(5) (common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Northwest) Akansha Yadav said police launched an investigation based on the complaint and traced the vehicle used in the incident.

Police identified the accused driver as Naman, a DU student, and said two to three persons were accompanying him at the time of the incident.

“Abhinav has been arrested from Laxmi Nagar and Abhimanyu from Gurugram, while efforts are underway to nab the others,” a senior police officer said.

Police are also looking into the student’s allegation that she and her friend approached multiple police stations before registering the complaint.

A DAY TO GATHER AROUND A LOVE THAT NEVER RESTS.



For Amma, listening does not end when the words do. Someone’s pain becomes her own. And quietly, an answer begins to take shape.

We gather again to be near her. To give her care more hands. And to take the comfort we find here, and give it away.

Distinguished Guests



SHRI C. P. RADHAKRISHNAN
Hon. Vice-President of Bharat



SHRI AMIT SHAH
Hon. Minister of Home Affairs of Bharat

Vishwa Seva Dinam
World Service Day
3 Years of Pure Love & Light
September 26-27, 2026
Amritapuri
sevadynam.org

CM Yogi calls on invited countries to invest in UP

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Noida

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Friday held a round-table meeting with representatives of the Uttar Pradesh International Trade Show's partner countries and invited them to explore investment opportunities in sectors, including mobile manufacturing, defence, and medical devices.

Representatives of Singapore, Vietnam, Russia, Belarus, Japan and Austria participated in the discussions on investment and business opportunities in the State,



Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath with representatives from various countries at the International Trade Show on Friday

according to a Uttar Pradesh Government statement. “Uttar Pradesh, besides being India’s most populous

state, has a large market, a young workforce, fertile land and adequate water resources, offering considerable scope for businesses from partner countries,” Adityanath said, according to the statement. During his interaction with the Vietnamese delegation, the CM invited companies from the country to invest in the Yamuna Expressway Authority area and said the state’s upcoming Noida airport would further strengthen connectivity.

He also proposed direct air services from Lucknow, Varanasi and Noida to Hanoi and other major Vietnamese

cities, saying this would promote trade and tourism between the two countries, the statement said. In his meeting with the Russian delegation, Adityanath invited Russian defence companies to set up units in Kanpur, pointing to the BrahMos manufacturing facility in Lucknow and production of AK-203 rifles in Uttar Pradesh. He also highlighted opportunities in pharmaceuticals and medical devices, including the medical device park near Noida airport and the proposed pharma and bulk drug parks in Bundelkhand and Lalitpur, respectively.

The chief minister also invited Belarusian companies specialising in advanced and heavy machinery, particularly tractor manufacturers, to establish assembly units in Uttar Pradesh. He suggested linking Belarusian wood technology with the wood-processing clusters of Saharanpur and Bijnor under the state’s One District One Product (ODOPI) programme, the statement said. Adityanath also held discussions with Japanese Ambassador Ono Keichi and JETRO India Chief Director General Daisaku Yukita on strengthening economic, cultural and investment ties between Uttar Pradesh and

Japan. The two sides also discussed deepening ties between Sarnath and Japan’s Nara Prefecture based on their shared Buddhist heritage. With the Singapore delegation, led by High Commissioner Simon Wong Wie Kuen, the chief minister discussed investment and economic cooperation, including progress on the proposed Singapore City project.

The Singapore Government said it is interested in taking the project forward and strengthening bilateral cooperation in various sectors. After the meeting, Adityanath joined representatives of partner countries for a group photograph.

PM Modi joins youth at *bhajan* event in Delhi



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday took part in *bhajan* clubbing, a modern trend where youngsters gather in concert-like settings to sing, clap and dance to Hindu devotional songs.

Modi attended the event on the 110th birthday anniversary of Sangh Parivar ideologue Deendayal Upadhyay at a park opposite the BJP headquarters here.

Seated on front row, Modi was seen clapping and playing a tambourine-like instrument to a Bhajan dedicated to Lord Ram.

Most of the audience, and singers, were youngsters, who could be seen clapping to the tunes.

Bhajan clubbing is a modern, cultural trend where youngsters gather in high-energy, concert-style settings for the performance of traditional devotional songs.

The attendees, including many representing the Gen Z, chant, sing along, clap and dance to traditional spiritual lyrics set to modern, high-energy acoustic or electronic rhythms.

Held in a club-like atmosphere minus the alcohol, Bhajan clubbing is catching on in many Indian cities and abroad.

₹469-cr investment gets ground for implementation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Noida

A significant step was taken to translate industrial investment into on-ground projects in the state at the inauguration of the Uttar Pradesh International Trade Show 2026.

Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah, along with the inauguration of UPITS, presented letters of allotment to representatives of five companies investing in the Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) region.

He also interacted with investors and discussed industrial and investment opportunities in the state.

A total area of 71,190 square metres has been allotted for these five projects. The companies have proposed a total investment of ₹469 crore in these projects, with 4,625 employment opportunities.

Among the companies receiving allotments, C&R Textiles Private Limited has



been allotted an area of 16,000 square metres.

The company has proposed an investment of ₹104 crore, with 2,000 employment opportunities expected to be created. Managing Director

Chhatrapati Ranjit Rai received the letter of allotment on the company’s behalf.

Perfectpack Limited has been allotted 16,200 square metres. The company has proposed an investment of

₹125 crore, creating 700 employment opportunities.

Chairman and Managing Director Sanjay Raigarhia was present on behalf of the company.

SABS Exports International

Private Limited has been allotted 16,180 square metre land. The company has proposed an investment of Rs 87 crore, with 475 employment opportunities. Company Director Chetan Sabharwal received the letter of allotment. Simplast India Private Limited has been allotted 12,000 square metres.

The company has proposed an investment of ₹78 crore and 300 employment opportunities. Company Director Gaurav Chugh received the letter of allotment.

Similarly, Sahu Exports Private Limited has been allotted 10,810 square metre land. The company has proposed an investment of ₹75 crore and 1,150 employment opportunities. Company Director Sanjeev Sahu received the land allotment letter. Along with presenting the letters of allotment, Shah also interacted with investors.

Discussions focused on expanding industries in Uttar Pradesh, investment opportunities, and accelerating business activities.

Vice President remembers Arun Jaitley at DU event

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Vice President CP Radhakrishnan on Friday remembered former Union minister Arun Jaitley as an outstanding leader with deep knowledge and exceptional debating skills, saying his strong belief in democracy enabled him to engage with different viewpoints.

Addressing the third edition of the “Shri Arun Jaitley Memorial Debate” at Delhi University’s Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC), Radhakrishnan said Jaitley never hesitated to debate issues or listen to views different from his own.

“Arun Jaitley always liked debates because his belief in democracy was so strong that he never hesitated to debate anything or listen to the views of others. That is his great-



ness,” he said. Radhakrishnan said Jaitley was a great leader known for his debating abilities and had studied at SRCC for three years. “In his name and in his memory, this debate has been held,” he said.

The Vice President also congratulated SRCC on completing 100 years, describing its journey as a long and fruitful one. He said the college would continue to develop in the coming years and assured it of his support.

EC faces three setbacks in one day

The petitioner has relied on the provisions of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023, particularly Section 18, which provides for decision-making by the EC and says that where there is a difference of opinion, the view of the majority prevails. The plea alleged that several decisions connected with the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls were taken or implemented despite objections from the other two commissioners.

One of the main issues raised is the alteration of Form 6, used by people seeking voter registration. The petition alleged that the election panel introduced a requirement for ancestral details and linkage with the previous SIR through its software, without the statutory amendment required under the electoral rules. “Issue a writ of mandamus or any other appropriate writ, order, or direction declaring all decisions, guidelines, directives, and software modifications initiated, approved, or implemented under Gyanesh Kumar without full commission concurrence or contrary to the majority opinion of the Election Commissioners as unconstitutional, ultra vires, and void ab initio,” the plea said.

In West Bengal, the petitioner claimed that more than 16.10 lakh appeals were filed in the name of the EC against voters whose names judicial officers had restored. According to the plea, the two Election Commissioners objected to the order, then sought its withdrawal and questioned its validity under Section 18 of the 2023 Act.

Upping the ante against the poll body chief, the Congress held protests in Delhi, Bihar, Assam, Punjab, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal, demanding the resignation of Kumar. The Congress has accused the Election Commission of carrying out an “unprecedented attack” on voter equality by allegedly creating a specific ‘Mark VIP’ feature in the BLO Application and urged CEC Gyanesh Kumar to turn “approver” or face trial. The Opposition party asserted that Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah and Kumar will not be spared for their “misdeeds”. It has also put up posters calling for Kumar’s removal. The Congress also put up “Gyanesh Hatao, Chunav Aayog Bachao” (Remove Gyanesh, Save Election Commission) posters.

The poll body has postponed two youth-focused voter awareness programmes in Uttar Pradesh that Gyanesh Kumar was scheduled to address, officials said on Friday.

UP-made BrahMos keeping Pakistan...

He mentioned the BrahMos integration and testing facility in Lucknow, which opened in May 2025 and sent out its first batch of missiles later that year. He said these missiles have become a strategic symbol for the State. He also pointed to the Indo-Russian AK-203 plant in Amethi, saying the rifles were “giving sleepless nights to Naxalites and terrorists alike.”

The minister put these factories in the context of India’s broader defence production. He said India’s defence output has reached ₹1.78 lakh crore, and defence exports have grown 56 times since 2013-14, now reaching nearly 80 countries, with Uttar Pradesh playing a key role. The

Lucknow BrahMos unit, built for about ₹300 crore on nearly 200 acres, is meant to assemble and test missiles and also encourage supplier industries and skilled jobs in the area.

Shah linked the defence industry’s growth to better law and order and increased investment. He remembered that in 2013, an investment conference planned for Lucknow had to move to Delhi because investors did not want to visit the state. He said improved policing under Yogi Adityanath’s Government has created a “fear-free” environment where manufacturing can grow.

The Home Minister also responded to critics of the national economy. He said some people have called India’s economy “dead,” but he replied that their thinking is dead. He said that under Prime Minister Narendra Modi, India has not only protected its growth amid global challenges but also strengthened it, citing GST collections of ₹2.11 lakh crore, 12 semiconductor projects across six States, and capital expenditure of ₹12.2 lakh crore. He added that free trade agreements signed with several countries had expanded Indian industry’s export capacity. By 2047, he said, India aimed to lead in every arena.

At the same event, Chief Minister Adityanath said the world now trusts Uttar Pradesh’s products, supply chains, and entrepreneurs. He pointed out that the state’s exports have passed ₹2 lakh crore and that the trade show, now in its fourth edition, has become a key platform for One District One Product goods, MSMEs, and traditional skills looking for global buyers. His remarks highlighted three points: defence manufacturing in Uttar Pradesh is now a national asset, better governance supports this industrial change, and the trade show aims to turn this base into export orders. The “sleepless nights” phrase, whether seen as deterrence or political messaging, set the tone for the opening day of UPITS 2026.

J&K Statehood: Omar reminds PM Modi...

BJP members accused the Government of “befooling” the people of Jammu and Kashmir, while National Conference and Congress members responded with slogans including Sada Haq Ithey Rakh.

NC members also raised slogans demanding the restoration of Jammu and Kashmir’s special status. The protests escalated as a majority of BJP legislators entered the Well of the House, leading to a noisy confrontation. Amid the continued ruckus, Speaker Abdul Rahim Rather initially adjourned the House for half an hour.

“We will not allow discussion on the issue of autonomy in the House,” BJP MLA RS Pathania said. BJP MLAs alleged that rules were flouted as the chief minister read out the resolution even before tabling it in the House and tore copies of the resolution. Several MLAs got into heated arguments as the pandemonium continued.

Speaking on the resolution, the chief minister said the House should debate and pass it in one voice, as denial of Statehood has proven extremely detrimental to Jammu and Kashmir.

“A promise was made to the people of Jammu and Kashmir. A promise was made in Parliament, a promise in the Supreme Court, and a promise in various public forums that a three-step process would be implemented: first delimitation, then elections, and then statehood,” he said.

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Abdullah said that while delimitation happened and elections were also held in which people participated enthusiastically and willingly, statehood has not been restored.

As the House witnessed acrimonious scenes, the Speaker Abdul Rahim Rather urged the members to take their seats, but the din persisted. The members traded barbs with each other, with some of them starting fist fights. The Speaker marshalled out one BJP legislator from the floor of the assembly before adjourning the House till Monday.

Speaking to reporters outside the Assembly complex, Leader of Opposition Sunil Sharma said the BJP is ready to debate the restoration of full statehood to Jammu and Kashmir, but would not allow a debate on Article 370 or the 2000 autonomy resolution.

He also questioned the Congress party’s position on the autonomy resolution and Article 370, asking it to clarify whether it stood with the resolution or the Government. “Congress should clear its position, from Rahul Gandhi to the State Chief of Congress. Is it with this resolution? Is it with the pre-1953 resolution? Is it with the resolution of 370, or is it with the Government?” he said.

The LoP said the Government is using the statehood issue to divert attention from Governance-related issues, while asserting that the BJP was ready for a debate on statehood. “If you want to debate statehood, we challenge you. We are ready to debate on statehood.”

LoP Sharma said the BJP would continue its protest until the Congress clarified its position on Article 370 and the autonomy resolution and the Government answered its questions.

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah also clarified outside the Assembly complex that the resolution he tabled in the house was not for greater autonomy or special status to Jammu and Kashmir. Referring to the unruly scenes and sloganeering by the BJP MLAs, the chief minister said, “Today, no one is asking them to vote on Article 370. Today, no one is asking them to vote on Jammu and Kashmir’s special position, special status, or autonomy. Those resolutions have already been passed; they are the property of the house,” he said. The Chief Minister said the fresh resolution he tabled in the house on Friday does not subsume the previous resolutions.

Abdullah also referred to BJP MLA Sham Lal Sharma’s remarks that the Government must be accountable for its governance over the past two years. “I am ready. Bring the discussion on Monday; whatever our performance has been over the past two years, we will place everything before the house. And the difficulties we faced over these two years, the problems we ran into, the hardships we had to confront, we will bring all of that forward as well. And after that, we hope the house votes on this resolution, and we will send this resolution to the Central Government,” he said.

CBI nabs key accused targeting US nationals

The operation shows how easily accessible communication technology can enable large-scale deception. Since the organisers stayed physically away from their victims and had converted the cash into a portable form before it had left American soil, they managed to eliminate some of the usual traces that financial investigators normally look for. The psychological impact of a formally worded accusation, delivered with urgency,

helped influence people who had no easy way to check the claims in real time.

Indian authorities have stressed that this arrest is only the first step, with further investigations into how the call-centre infrastructure was financed, how the US-based courier network was recruited and paid, and whether more victims have come forward. Cooperation is expected with their American law-enforcement counterparts as both sides work to freeze the remaining assets and identify any facilitators who are still at large.

The public should be on their guard when someone contacts them uninvited, claims Government authority, and asks them to take immediate financial action. Official organisations do not tell people to withdraw cash or buy precious metals by telephone, so if anyone gets such a call, they should hang up and contact the agency on its official lines.

The CBI has said its investigation is still ongoing; as it examines more digital evidence, a clearer picture of the syndicate’s reach and how many people it has affected is expected to emerge. The arrest of the main accused represents a major disruption. However, the core method of remote impersonation and commodity extraction remains a problem that law-enforcement agencies on both sides of the Atlantic will have to deal with for some time, an official said.

Six booked, three detained in Mandar...

Police later identified three men from the video: Abdullah, Nitish Kumar Rai, and Vikas Kumar, all from the Barahat police station area. Investigators say the woman went to the hill with two friends. The accused allegedly grabbed, abused, and threatened them, and forced one companion to transfer ₹1,500 through PhonePe before letting them go.

By 25 September, Banka Superintendent of Police Amitesh Kumar said police had detained the three men and were questioning them. Raids continued for others seen in the video. Kumar said police first filed an FIR against unknown persons because neither the victim nor her friends were identified at first. Police later took the victim’s statement.

This is the third viral case from Bihar in a few days, after similar videos from Jamui and Samastipur. This pattern, more than the new criminal code, explains why Banka is getting political attention. Mandar Hill is a well-known spot for pilgrims and tourists. However, the first reliable report of the assault came almost three weeks after the date shown on the video.

Some police briefings suggest the incident could have happened months earlier if the video was recorded on 3 June instead of 3 September. Officials have mentioned both dates. What is worrying is the fact that a public crime at a well-known place went unreported until a phone video spread beyond the original group.

AI suspends pilot after alcohol test...

Air India subsequently informed local authorities, following which the pilot was removed from operating duties and subjected to further medical evaluation.

According to officials, local authorities imme-

diately removed the pilot from flight duties after providing a preliminary breathalyser test report. He was later repatriated to India as a passenger and remains suspended pending the final medical examination report and completion of the investigation.

Officials said they will take “Appropriate disciplinary action” based on the findings.

The Swiss Federal Office of Civil Aviation (FOCA) confirmed that it had taken the necessary measures under applicable national and international regulations. A FOCA spokesperson said the operator and India’s Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) were informed and, as a result, AI151 could not operate as scheduled.

Citing data-protection requirements, FOCA declined to provide further details and said responsibility for further handling of the case rests with the DGCA as the competent authority of the state of the operator.

Air India has also been strengthening its internal measures following a series of recent safety-related incidents. Officials said the airline is tightening accountability across flight operations and continuing mandatory testing of pilots for psychoactive substances.

The airline is also monitoring compliance trends and operational conduct, expanding safety-awareness programmes and increasing leadership engagement with flight crew, officials said. Where violations are established, disciplinary measures-including suspension or termination-are taken depending on the nature and severity of the non-compliance.

The Zurich incident came days after Air India terminated the services of the pilot-in-command of a Phuket-Delhi flight after he tested positive for drug use. On September 4, the airline dismissed the pilot, hours after the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB), in its preliminary report into the August 4 Phuket-Delhi incident, described the drug-use finding as a serious concern and asked the DGCA to take appropriate action. The Phuket-Delhi flight, operated by an Airbus A320, suddenly lost nearly 300 feet of altitude while cruising at 36,000 feet. The aircraft carried 145 people, and 24 passengers were injured.

The latest Zurich incident adds to scrutiny of Air India’s flight-operations oversight as the airline moves to reinforce compliance and safety protocols among its cockpit crew.

DJ noise nuisance spreads to Badrinath Dham

The senior leader also raised health concerns about high-altitude gatherings, saying that allowing thousands of people to dance at such extreme elevations ignores the severe physiological impacts. He cautioned that such events symbolise a troubling shift towards transforming Devbhoomi (Land of the Gods) into a commercial culture hub.

Appealing to followers of Indian culture, revered Shankaracharyas, and leading saints, Joshi urged them to raise a collective voice to halt the erosion of spiritual values. He further called upon both the Central and State Governments to immediately ban such events to preserve the dignity of the revered pilgrimage site.

“The Himalayas are the soul of the divine, the abode of Lord Shiva, and the source of Mother Ganga,” Joshi said, warning that turning these sacred heights into a dance arena inflicts a deep wound on the faith of millions of devotees across the nation.

NDA allies ask ECI to issue clarification to dispel doubts

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

With questions raised about reported fissures in the Election Commission of India (ECI), some NDA leaders, including the Telugu Desam Party, Lokjanshakti Party and Rashtriya Lok Morcha, have now come out asking the poll body to dispel the misgivings. The allies said a clarification was needed to assure people about the institution's integrity. "Problematic if people begin to doubt the electoral process," says Chirag Paswan; clarification "will only help strengthen public confidence," says TDP. Their remarks mark a departure from the position taken by several BJP-led NDA constituents.

Amid controversy, sources in the poll body said the Chief Election Commissioner and two Election Commissioners "unanimously" approved the orders pertaining to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process for Bihar and other States. The approved SIR orders include a Declaration Form to be submitted along with Form 6



for the inclusion of new voters, a step aimed at reducing paperwork and easing the registration process for citizens. This is in line with Section 21(3) of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 and has also been upheld by the Supreme Court. The ECI has said the declaration is an additional requirement and does not alter the existing Form 6.

Paswan asked the poll body to "dispel misgivings in the minds of the people" that have arisen over a report on the alleged differences within the poll panel over Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Paswan, who heads

Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas), also made it clear that "as part of the Government" he did not intend to "defend a Constitutional body", nor did he set much store by allegations levelled by opposition leaders like Rahul Gandhi. "Let me make it clear that as part of the Government, I do not intend to defend what is a constitutional body. I am also not much worried about the allegations made by the opposition, which will always take a stand that suits it politically," the Hajipur MP said.

He, however, added, "If the people start losing trust in the electoral system, that will not augur well for

democracy and, therefore, I think the ECI must come out with its clarification more forcefully. It need not respond to what Rahul Gandhi and his associates are saying. But it must dispel misgivings in the minds of the people."

While the BJP and JD(U) have largely avoided amplifying the controversy or defending institutional processes, Paswan's insistence on public clarification sets his party apart within the ruling alliance.

This is not the first time the LJP(RV) leader has charted an independent course while remaining part of the NDA. In Bihar, where his party is an ally of the Government led by chief minister Samrat Choudhary after the political transitions of recent years, Paswan has repeatedly raised the temperature on law-and-order issues that embarrass the dispensation.

Upendra Kushwaha, an NDA ally and Rajya Sabha MP, expressed that there was an urgent need to clear the entire picture and dispel confusion in the minds of the voters.

2.73 crore Gen Z voters added to electoral rolls since 2025: ECI

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

As many as 2.73 crore Gen Z voters in the 18 to 28 age group have been added to electoral rolls since the Election Commission of India (ECI) began its Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise in 2025, according to ECI officials. The figure comes amid a row over the ECI adding a declaration to the form for new voters seeking to enroll in the electoral rolls and making the registration process difficult.

"As per the amendment in Section 14 of the RP Act, 1950, in 2021, read with Section 19 of the RP Act, 1950, any person whose name is not on the electoral rolls or attains 18 years of age on January 1, April 1, July 1 or October 1 can register as a voter without waiting for any kind of revision, as a part of regular updation of electoral rolls. Both Special Summary Revision (SSR) and Special Intensive Revision (SIR) are done under Section 21(3) of the RP Act, 1950 and are optional. There is no legal require-



ment to hold both together," the officials said.

The four qualifying dates were introduced after an amendment to Section 14(b) of the Representation of the People Act. An eligible citizen who has completed, or is completing, 18 years on any of the four dates can submit an advance application in Form 6. The application is processed in the relevant quarter in which the applicant attains the qualifying age.

After the change in the online form, it's not only the existing voters who must show details of their parents in SIR to remain on the electoral rolls; those seeking inclusion in the voter list also

have to cite details of the exercise. By issuing instructions, the ECI has made it mandatory to attach SIR details of parents for new voters filling Form 6 for inclusion in the electoral rolls. The official underlined that the declaration was added through instructions and that Form 6 has not been amended.

The declaration was added in the Bihar SIR rolled out in June last year. New voters were made to file the declaration along with Form 6. ECI officials said that since June 24, 2025, 2.37 crore new voters in the 18 to 28 age category have been added to the voter list across India. As of now, there are 17.38 crore

voters in that age bracket.

Daily SIR bulletins for Bihar showed the forms filled along with the declaration, an ECI functionary said. "It helps in mapping electors and reduces the documents the new voters need to submit along with their applications," the officer added. If a person fills out Form 6 online, he or she cannot proceed further till the declaration is filled.

The Congress on Thursday alleged that Gen Z is being targeted for exclusion and pressed for its demand that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar must resign immediately.

Sources have revealed that the SIRs in 12 States, including Bihar and Assam, had the approval of the Election Commissioners and the Chief Election Commissioner. The decision was unanimous. Sources said that the Election Commissioners and the Chief Election Commissioner together approved the SIR Order for Bihar, SIR Order for Assam, SIR Order for 12 States and Union Territories, and SIR Order for 19 States/Union Territories.

Govt extends AFSPA in Manipur, Nagaland, Andhra for 6 months

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

The Union Government has extended the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act, 1958, in specified Areas of Manipur, Nagaland and Arunachal Pradesh for another six months from October 1, 2026. Gazette notifications issued on Friday said the law will remain in force unless withdrawn earlier.

The notifications stated that the decisions followed a further review of the law and order situation in the three States. The orders cite Section 3 of the Act, which empowers the Union Government to declare any area "disturbed" if it concludes that armed forces must assist the civil administration. Once that declaration is made, security personnel may search premises, arrest without warrant, and use force, including lethal force, if they consider it necessary to maintain public order. Actions taken in good faith are protected from prosecution unless the Union Government grants prior sanction.

In Arunachal Pradesh, the extension covers Tirap, Changlang and Longding districts in full. It also applies to areas under the Namsai, Mahadevpur and Chowkham



police stations in Namsai district, which borders Assam. These locations have seen repeated six-month renewals because of residual insurgent activity, porous routes into Myanmar and narcotics trafficking along the eastern frontier. The rest of Arunachal Pradesh remains outside the disturbed-area regime. In Nagaland, the Act continues in nine districts, Dimapur, Nuland, Chumoukedima, Mon, Kiphire, Nokiak, Phek, Peren and Meluri, together with the jurisdictions of 21 police stations in Kohima, Mokokchung, Longleng, Wokha and Zunheboto.

In Manipur, the disturbed-area tag has been retained

across almost the entire State, excluding only 13 police-station areas in five valley districts. Ethnic violence that began in 2023 has not fully subsided, and the Union Government has judged that a wider rollback would be premature. AFSPA has already been withdrawn completely from Mizoram, Meghalaya and Tripura. Its limited continuation in the remaining States reflects an official view that extraordinary powers are still required in selected belts even as overall insurgency has declined. The latest notifications keep the legal framework in place until March 31, 2027, subject to any earlier review if conditions improve.

Delhi court allows 7 arrested in Myanmar drone case to go home

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A Delhi court has permitted seven foreign nationals, arrested in a case under investigation by the National Investigation Agency (NIA), to return to their home countries in the United States and Ukraine. The court observed that the right to travel abroad is an extension of fundamental rights. The court also directed that all seven foreign nationals must return to India after completing one month in their respective countries.

The NIA arrested the individuals for their alleged involvement in a drone warfare training camp associated with ethnic armed groups in Myanmar.

Special NIA Judge Prashant Sharma, in an order passed on Thursday, had discharged US national Matthew Aaron Van Dyke and six Ukrainian citizens under sections 21 (penalty for unauthorised entry) and 23 (penalty for visa overstay and general contraventions) of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, taking note of the compounding of offences by the FRRO.

On September 18, the FRRO compounded the offences and imposed a fine of ₹5.5 lakh on each accused.

Judge Sharma noted that all accused persons had filed applications for passport release and permission to travel abroad.

"Admittedly, investigation with respect to offences under the Unlawful Activities Prevention Act (UAPA) is going on. NIA will take some time to conclude said investigation and this court cannot direct NIA to conclude



said investigation within a particular time, as per law," the judge said.

The court observed that the NIA did not require the seven accused to be physically present to continue the investigation.

"Further, the right to travel abroad is an extension of fundamental rights under Article 21 of the Constitution, as per the law, which cannot be taken lightly and a balance has to be struck," Judge Sharma said. He noted that the accused persons have shown willingness to join the investigation when asked by the NIA.

The court permitted the accused to travel to the USA and Ukraine for one month from the date of departure, subject to certain conditions.

The court directed the accused to join the investigation virtually or in person as required by the NIA. The accused must provide their residential addresses, active mobile numbers, and email addresses to the NIA. If they do not have working phone numbers, they are to submit their family members' mobile numbers within 24 hours. After reaching their destinations, they must provide their own working phone numbers within a week. Dyke was granted default bail on September 18, while the six Ukrainians – Hurba Petro, Slyviak Taras, Ivan Sukmanovskiy, Stefankiv Marian, Honcharuk Maksim alias Maksym and Kaminskyi Viktor –

were granted default bail on September 23. The NIA had earlier registered the case against the Ukrainian nationals and Van Dyke under section 18 (punishment for conspiracy) of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), along with sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

The NTH NIA investigated the case as involving alleged UAPA offences for 180 days after receiving a court extension. In its first chargesheet, filed on September 8, the agency invoked provisions of the Immigration and Foreigners Act and said the UAPA investigation was ongoing. The agency said it kept the investigation into offences under the UAPA pending and could file a supplementary chargesheet if it established an offence under the anti-terror law.

The NIA said it has completed a substantial part of the investigation into alleged UAPA offences, but needs more time to establish all facts, especially regarding the import and recovery of a large quantity of drones and accessories in India.

Earlier, the agency informed the court that the accused were under investigation for a broad terror conspiracy, including providing assistance and drone training to ethnic armed groups in India and Myanmar. The NIA stated that the accused entered Myanmar through Mizoram without valid travel documents and took part in a scheduled training programme on drone warfare, operations, assembly, and jamming technology for Myanmar-based ethnic armed groups targeting the Myanmar military.

President returns West Bengal Goonda Bill; State to review

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
■ Kolkata

President Droupadi Murmu has returned for reconsideration the much touted West Bengal Public Safety and Control of Anti-Social Activities Bill, more popularly known as the 'anti-Goonda' Bill. The Bill was returned for amendment after objections were raised regarding certain conflicting provisions, particularly the definition of the term Goonda as it has been mentioned in the Prevention of Illicit Traffic in Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, 1988 (PITNDPS Act) sources said.

Opining that certain provisions may "therefore, create an overlapping or parallel preventive detention mechanism in respect of drug related activities" making it repugnant under Article 254, the central Government in its note said, "Section (B) of the proposed Bill, insofar as it includes within the definition of 'goonda' a person who commits, attempts to commit, abets, promotes, finances or facilitates any offence punishable under the NDPS Act, 1985, may



President Droupadi Murmu

overlap with the preventive-detention framework provided under the PITNDPS Act, 1988, which is a specific Central legislation dealing with preventive detention of persons engaged in illicit traffic in narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances."

Soon after assuming power the new BJP Government in the month of June had enacted the Prevention of drafted and sent it for Presidential assent, prompting the opposition outfits including the Left and the Trinamool Congress to call it a "Bill of vendetta" passed to suppress the opposition voices leading Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari to ally public fear saying the Bill had been brought not as a tool of oppression but to measure to counter anti-social activities to ensure a peaceful social life.



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

सेवा संकल्प अभियान

के अंतर्गत

सेवा सेतु शिविर

दिल्ली सरकार अब आपके द्वार

सरकारी सेवाओं और जनकल्याणकारी योजनाओं की जानकारी एवं सहायता अब आपके नजदीक
दिल्ली की हर विधानसभा में 02 दिन का कैम्प

📅 26 सितंबर से प्रारंभ
🕒 समय: सुबह 10:00 बजे से दोपहर 3:30 बजे तक

एक ही स्थान पर, कई विभागों की सुविधाएं

स्वास्थ्य विभाग

BSES/TPDDL

खाद्य एवं आपूर्ति विभाग

राजस्व विभाग

DTC

महिला एवं बाल विकास विभाग

समाज कल्याण विभाग

दिल्ली पुलिस

शिक्षा विभाग

श्रम विभाग

कला एवं संस्कृति विभाग

MCD

DJB

SC & ST विभाग

DDA

राष्ट्रीय राजधानी क्षेत्र, दिल्ली सरकार

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/097/26-27



अपने नजदीकी शिविर का पता जानने के लिए QR कोड स्कैन करें

States Focus



SIR BEING USED AS A WEAPON BY THE BJP: RAJ THACKERAY

Maharashtra Navnirman Sena president Raj Thackeray on Friday demanded that the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise be scrapped, alleging that the BJP has used it as a weapon since 2025.

In a post on X, Thackeray said the SIR process should be started anew.

"It has become evident how the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leveraged individuals like Gyanesh Kumar to secure an endless grip on power. To this end, they have adopted a new weapon since 2025: the SIR (Special Intensive Revision).

"Observing the irregularities within the SIR and noting that even Election Commissioners are speaking out about them, only one conclusion remains: the entire SIR process must be scrapped," he said. (PTI)



ANDHRA REVISES TEXTBOOKS TO REMOVE GENDER STEREOTYPES

School textbooks in Andhra Pradesh have been revised to remove gender stereotypes and instil respect for women from an early age, according to the State HRD Minister, Nara Lokesh.

The minister made the comments on Thursday during a fireside chat organised by the Public Affairs Forum of India (PAFI) in Delhi and outlined the State's ongoing reforms in school and higher education, with a strong focus on value-based education, gender sensitivity, technology-enabled learning, curriculum reform and industry-linked skilling.

He said Andhra Pradesh is examining which courses, majors, and minors are offered, whether they remain relevant, and how closely curricula align with market requirements. "Textbooks for Classes 1 and 2 earlier depicted household chores as being performed entirely by women. The State has changed this approach so that 50 per cent of the household chores shown are performed by men and 50 per cent by women, aiming to avoid gender stereotyping from the first grade itself," he said. Lokesh, who is also Andhra Pradesh's IT Minister, said that Saturday is observed as a "No Bag Day" in schools, providing an opportunity for value-based and practical learning. On curriculum reform, Lokesh said the state has already undertaken two rounds of curriculum improvement. (PTI)

COAS reviews Chinara Corps LoC preparedness

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Jammu

Chief of the Army Staff (COAS) General Dhiraj Seth visited forward areas and formations of the Chinara Corps under the Northern Command on Friday to review operational preparedness and the security situation along the Line of Control (LoC) and in the hinterland.

During his visit, the COAS was briefed by commanders on the prevailing security environment, operational readiness, and capability development initiatives.

Before him, Air Chief Marshal AP Singh had visited HQ Northern Command, Udhampur, on September 23. Air Chief Marshal Singh, Lt Gen Pratik Sharma, Army Commander Northern Command, briefed Air Chief Marshal Singh by Lt Gen Pratik Sharma, Army Commander



Northern Command, on the operational environment and preparedness.

The COAS was updated on measures instituted to maintain a robust security posture along the LC and preparedness for counter-terrorist operations in the hinterland. While interacting with troops in the operational areas, the COAS commended all ranks for maintaining a high state of vigilance across the operational spectrum.

He reiterated the thrust

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Police have recorded the statements of 20 individuals, including students and staff members, in connection with the alleged suicide of IIT Bombay student Sahil Wakode, officials said on Friday. Efforts are also being made to access call logs and messages from his phone, they said.

According to preliminary details, 22-year-old Sahil, a student in the Department of Energy Science and Engineering, went straight to his hostel room after leaving the examination hall on September 18. When he did not emerge from his room by around 7 pm, the door was opened and he was found dead inside.

Among the 20 persons questioned are students who were present in the examination hall alongside Sahil, as well as invigilators and various administrative



Ravindra Wakode and Sonali Wakode, parents of 22-year-old B Tech student Sahil Wakode, who allegedly died by suicide at the IIT Bombay campus, protest along with relatives at Azad Maidan in Mumbai

PTI

officials from the premier institute.

Investigators said Sahil's mobile phone was secured with a pattern lock, limiting immediate access to call logs and messages, though several missed call notifications were visible on the display screen. Forensic efforts to access the device

are underway, they said.

IIT Bombay faculty member Suryanarayan Doolla, named in the FIR which alleges abetment to suicide on grounds of caste discrimination, has been sent on leave to facilitate an impartial probe into the case. Sahil's parents Ravindra and Sonali Wakode began a

hunger strike at Azad Maidan in Mumbai on Thursday, alleging that their son repeatedly faced caste discrimination at the institute and demanding action against his 'tormentors'.

Meanwhile, IIT B has apologised twice over its communication that had indicated that Sahil died by suicide hours after allegedly being caught using ChatGPT in an exam. Some TV channels aired CCTV footage from the examination hall that captured Sahil's movements before a professor approached him and led him away from the hall after he was allegedly caught copying. However, there was no word from the police on this issue.

Police officials said they are using CCTV footage and the statements recorded so far to reconstruct the exact sequence of events leading up to the tragedy. Further investigation into the matter is ongoing, they added.

TN CM Vijay launches scathing attack on DMK, AIADMK

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Madurantakam (Tamil Nadu)

In a fresh salvo against the main Opposition DMK and the AIADMK, TVK supremo and Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Friday yet again dubbed the MK Stalin-led party as an "evil force" and alleged collusion between the two Dravidian giants and the BJP as well.

He was addressing a campaign here for the October 6 bypoll, necessitated due to the resignation of AIADMK's K Maragatham Kumaravel, who later joined Vijay's TVK. She has been re-nominated.

Harping on TVK's "clean governance and pure force" plank, Vijay accused the DMK of corruption and charged it with colluding with the AIADMK even in the horrendous case of abuse of girls by granite baron R Veeramani.

The DMK, as they were unable to level any allegation against the ruling party, out of frustration and irritation, has taken up a dangerous weapon. Vijay said he tolerated it even when they spoke badly about his own mother. But when they spoke obscenely about "my sisters and mothers in Tamil Nadu," he could not accept it.



Both the DMK and the "DMK family" speak in such a manner, and Stalin and his family enjoy such speech. "This cannot be tolerated."

Without mentioning the POCSO case against Veeramani directly, Vijay alleged the industrialist was abusing children for so many

6 killed, 7 injured in truck crash in Chhattisgarh

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Balod

Six people were killed, and seven others sustained injuries after a truck transporting wheat rammed into a stationary mini goods vehicle on a highway in Chhattisgarh's Balod district on Friday, police said.

The accident occurred around 11:30 am at Markatola Ghat, under Purur police station limits, on National Highway-30, when the victims, members of a



'dhumal' music band, were travelling towards Jagdalpur from Kabirdham district, an

official said. He said that the goods vehicle, carrying 15 people and their musical instruments, broke down at Markatola Ghat, and two of the occupants had gone to Dhamtari in search of a mechanic.

A 16-wheeler truck loaded with wheat, heading towards Jagdalpur from Raipur, crashed into the stationary goods vehicle from behind. The truck dragged the vehicle about 30 metres before it overturned, the official said.

Nitin Nabin hits back at Rahul over anti-incumbency remarks



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Jaipur

A day after Congress leader Rahul Gandhi questioned anti-incumbency regarding the BJP, its president Nitin Nabin on Friday here hit back, saying the party's confidence comes from serving people and winning their trust.

The sharp retort came as Rahul Gandhi had remarked as to why the BJP Governments return to power repeatedly despite anti-incumbency.

Speaking at the 'Seva Sankalp Sabha' at Dadiya near Jaipur, Nabin referred to Rahul Gandhi's press conference in New Delhi on Thursday, where the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha asked how BJP leaders could say the party would remain in power for decades.

"Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi was asking why the BJP Governments keep returning to power and why the BJP leaders say that we will serve the

people for the next 25 years. He asks how they can say this with such confidence," Nabin said.

"This confidence comes from serving the people. It comes from winning their trust and working for them," he said.

Rahul Gandhi had alleged that while the Congress and regional parties face anti-incumbency, it "disappears" for the BJP. He also questioned how the BJP leaders could speak with certainty about remaining in power for decades.

Nabin said the BJP's confidence was based on welfare measures and changes brought in people's lives by the Narendra Modi Government. "When more than 4 crore houses are built for the poor, their blessings come to us in the form of votes. When toilets are built for 12 crore poor women, and they can live with dignity, their blessings come to us in the form of votes," he said.



IIT BOMBAY STUDENT'S DEATH MERITS THOROUGH PROBE: RAMDAS ATHAWALE

Mumbai: Union minister Ramdas Athawale on Friday sought a "thorough investigation" into the death by suicide of IIT Bombay student Sahil Wakode last week.

"Any student who gets admission to the IIT is very clever and highly capable. Sahil's death should be thoroughly investigated and action should be taken against those responsible," the minister said after visiting IIT Bombay.

"The way he died by suicide suggests there could be some major reason behind it. Someone may have insulted him and forced him to take the extreme step," Athawale said. Sahil's parents Ravindra Wakode and Sonali Wakode went on a hunger strike at Azad Maidan in Mumbai on Thursday to seek justice for

their son, who died on September 18.

They have alleged that he faced caste-based discrimination on campus and are demanding a fast-tracked investigation, accountability, and the arrest of individuals they hold responsible.

Sahil's parents were detained by Mumbai Police in Bhandup on Thursday morning while they were on their way to the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay campus in Powai, their lawyer Nikhil Kamble claimed. (PNS)

West Bengal: ex-TMC MLA arrested in extortion case



Former TMC MLA Ajit Maity

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
■ Kolkata

In yet another setback for the pro-Mamata Trinamool Congress, a former MLA of the party and a Mamata Banerjee loyalist, Ajit Maity, was arrested from his residence near Kharagpur on Friday.

He was arrested in connection with an extortion case, police said. Maity was an MLA from Pingla seat in West Midnapore.

The former MLA was picked up from his residence and taken to the Debra Police Station, sources said. No one commented further, though inside sources said his arrest was linked to the arrest of Sumit Roy, the former PA of Mamata TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee. Roy was arrested in connection with a land-grab case in Jhargram.

BJP leader Gobinda Das lodged a complaint against Maity at the Pingla police station on September 23, based on which the arrest was made, police said. Das alleged that in 2016, when he was the TMC president of the Jamna area in the Pingla-II block, Maity took Rs 15 lakh from him on the promise of making him the party's block president.

He alleged that he was not given the post, and when he asked for a refund, Maity harassed him. Maity is currently the vice-chairperson of the Paschim Medinipur Zilla Parishad, and had served as the TMC's district president for several years.

He was elected from Pingla in the 2021 Assembly elections. The TMC fielded him again from the seat in the Assembly elections held earlier this year, but he lost to BJP candidate Swagata Manna by more than 18,000 votes.

111 MPs, MLAs changed parties after winning elections since 2022: ADR

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

As many as 111 MPs and MLAs changed their parties after winning elections to Parliament or State Assemblies between 2022 and 2026, with the highest number of such switches recorded in Nagaland and West Bengal, according to an analysis by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) and National Election Watch.

The analysis, which covered elections and bypolls during the period, found that 26 Lok Sabha members, seven Rajya Sabha members and 78 MLAs changed parties.

ADR said the cases covered individual defections, party mergers, resignations followed by bypoll victories and disqualification followed by winning a seat in a bypoll.

Nagaland accounted for the highest number of cases at 32, all involving MLAs. The bulk of these cases were linked to a realignment involving the ruling Nationalist Democratic Progressive Party (NDPP) and the Naga People's Front (NPF), with the NPF emerging as the largest recipient of lawmakers in the ADR analysis.

Overall, 25 legislators originally elected from the NDPP were among those who

changed parties, while 32 lawmakers joined the NPF.

West Bengal recorded 20 cases, all involving Lok Sabha members. All 20 were originally elected on All India Trinamool Congress (AITC) tickets and subsequently moved to the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI), according to the analysis.

The MPs have claimed a merger with the NCPI and the matter is before Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla.

Telangana was next with nine cases, all involving MLAs. The nine were legislators elected from the Bharat Rashtira Samithi (BRS), while the Congress emerged as the



Representative image

principal recipient of lawmakers in the State.

Goa recorded eight cases, with Congress MLAs moving to the BJP, while Punjab also accounted for eight cases, including six Rajya Sabha

members and two MLAs.

Maharashtra recorded six cases, all involving Lok Sabha members elected from Shiv Sena (Uddhav Balasaheb Thackeray), who subsequently moved to the

Shiv Sena led by Eknath Shinde. Meghalaya had six MLA cases and Manipur five, while Arunachal Pradesh and Gujarat recorded four each.

Himachal Pradesh and Rajasthan recorded two cases each, while Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh, Sikkim and Uttar Pradesh had one case each. Delhi accounted for one Rajya Sabha member changing party.

At the party level, the NDPP recorded the highest number of exits at 25, followed by the AITC with 20 and the Congress with 19. The BRS accounted for nine, AAP and NCP seven each, Shiv Sena (Uddhav Balasaheb

Thackeray) six, JD(U) five and NPP four. Together, NDPP, AITC and Congress accounted for 64 of the 111 cases, or 58 per cent. The NPF received the highest number of lawmakers who changed parties, at 32, followed by the BJP with 29 and NCPI with 20.

The Congress received nine, Shiv Sena eight, NPP six and People's Party of Arunachal four. The NPF, BJP and NCPI together accounted for 81 of the 111 lawmakers, or 73 per cent. ADR said recent defections had also been associated with the fall of governments in some state assemblies. It also clarified the exercise was not neces-

sarily exhaustive because there is no systematically maintained and readily accessible official database of legislators changing parties.

The watchdog has recommended changes to the anti-defection framework, including transferring the power to decide disqualification petitions from presiding officers to the President, in the case of MPs, and governors, in the case of MLAs, based on the Election Commission's advice. It has also suggested a time limit for deciding disqualification petitions and restrictions on defectors holding public office until they are re-elected.

Congress protests nationwide, demands sacking of CEC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Upping the ante, the Congress on Friday launched its nationwide protest campaign against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar with demonstrations in various parts of the country. From Delhi to Patna to Jammu to Kolkata to Punjab to Assam and Arunachal, Congress workers took to the streets demanding Kumar's resignation.

In Delhi, the Congress protest saw dramatic scenes with the party leaders breaking barricades and trying to

march towards the Election Commission office to demand the CEC's resignation. Several Congress workers were detained as the police tried to stop the march.

"Gyanesh Kumar must resign immediately. We are not going to let democracy be destroyed in India and sit silent, and the people responsible for this are going to be punished," Delhi Congress president Devender Yadav said.

Earlier, wearing masks bearing Gyanesh Kumar's face and with their hands bound in chains, Indian Youth Congress workers on Friday protested in

Delhi against the Election Commission, demanding Kumar's resignation over alleged differences among the poll panel's top officers on key electoral decisions.

The protesters raised slogans and displayed posters and banners demanding accountability from Kumar as they marched from the IYC office on Raisina Road towards the Election Commission headquarters.

In Assam, state Congress chief Gaurav Gogoi and several workers were detained during the party's protest against the CEC.

In Bihar's Capital Patna,



Congress party members during a protest rally demanding the arrest of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged electoral roll revision concerns in Hyderabad on Thursday

police used water cannon on Congress workers who staged a march to the poll panel's office.

Similar protest marches were organised by the Opposition party in several state capitals, including

Kolkata, Chandigarh, Jammu other parts of the country.

The Congress on Thursday had directed its state units to organise protest marches to their respective state election commission offices on September 25, demanding the CEC's immediate arrest, removal from office, and an independent review of all decisions and electoral roll changes made under him.

This came after a media report said Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had objected on record at least 14 times over the last 10 months to decisions and orders.

Their objections covered the manner in which the statutory voter registration Form 6 was amended, the handling of additions and deletions from voter lists, and centralised control over the electoral roll database, according to the report.

Under fire over the red flags raised by two of its commissioners over the SIR process, the ECI has asserted that differing views and observations are a normal part of deliberations in any institution and all its orders carry full legal sanction and follow established statutory procedures. In a statement, the

poll panel also said that not only the three commissioners, but every officer of the EC is fully authorised to give suggestions to the commission to improve the electoral system.

The Congress and the Opposition have stepped up its campaign against the Election Commission. Addressing a press conference in New Delhi on Thursday, Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi termed Kumar a "traitor", demanded his resignation and warned that the Congress would not remain silent and watch democracy in India "being destroyed".

RBI unions back nationwide bank strike over 5-day week, PLI scheme

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Top trade unions representing Reserve Bank of India (RBI) employees and workers have extended full support to the three-day nationwide strike called by bank staff from September 28 to 30, while fiercely criticising the central bank for directing commercial banks to remain open on Sunday.

In a joint communication, the All India Reserve Bank Employees Association (AIRBEA) and the All India Reserve Bank Workers Federation (AIRBWF) expressed solidarity with the United Forum of Bank Unions (UFBU)—an umbrella body of seven national bank unions representing over one million employees across public, private, foreign, regional rural, and co-operative banks.

The central issue driving the industrial action is the long-pending implementation of a 5-day work week. Unions highlighted that an agreement was reached between the Indian Banks Association (IBA) and UFBU in December 2023, with the



Representative image

Department of Financial Services (DFS) assuring progress in March 2025. Workers have offered to extend daily working hours to maintain equivalent operational service, ensuring no inconvenience to customers.

Unions also condemned recent modifications to the Profit Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme introduced by the DFS. Under the revised norms, top executives (Scales IV to VIII), who constitute less than five per cent of the workforce, are set to receive incentives equivalent to 365 days' wages, while the remaining 95 per cent of staff will receive around 15 days'

wages. Terming this discrimination a gross injustice, the unions argued it undermines the collective effort required in banking operations.

Taking sharp aim at the central bank, AIRBEA and AIRBWF strongly opposed the RBI's directive instructing banks to stay operational on Sunday, September 27. They urged the regulator to persuade the Finance Ministry toward a peaceful resolution rather than taking a confrontational stance.

To demonstrate solidarity, RBI staff will hold gate demonstrations on September 28 across offices with posters and placards.

PM-JAY facilitated over 13 crore hospital admissions, says Nadda

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Health Minister JP Nadda said on Friday that the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY) has transformed healthcare in the country, with the scheme facilitating over 13 crore hospital admissions, providing treatment worth more than ₹2 lakh crore.

Addressing Aarogya Manthan 2026 at the Vigyan Bhawan, Nadda stated that the scheme has covered over 60 crore beneficiaries and has emerged as the world's largest health assurance programme since its launch eight years ago. The event also marked five years of the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM).

Nadda highlighted that the Government has expanded PM-JAY to include all senior citizens aged 70 and above, regardless of their socioeconomic status. He recalled that before Ayushman Bharat, families often had to sell land or homes to afford treatment, especially for serious illnesses



like cancer. "I became an MLA in 1993. At that time, we would approach the chief minister to request ₹1 lakh for a patient needing bypass surgery.

The chief minister would respond that many patients were seeking help from the relief fund and ask how many he could assist," Nadda shared. He emphasised the portability of the scheme, particularly benefiting migrant workers, and acknowledged the contributions of State Governments, healthcare institutions, and other stakeholders in advancing the program.

Regarding ABDM, Nadda said that more than 97.8 crore Ayushman Bharat Health

Accounts (ABHAs) have been created, with over 121 crore health records linked. Additionally, over 5.6 lakh health facilities and around 11 lakh healthcare professionals are registered on the ABDM ecosystem, he said.

Nadda also highlighted the National Health Claims Exchange (NHCE), which seeks to bring hospitals and insurers onto a common digital platform. He said the initiatives launched at Aarogya Manthan 2026 would further strengthen digital healthcare, facilitate secure use of health data and create opportunities for health research, innovation and data-driven decision-making.

Patnaik blames Odisha BJP MPs for mines law passage

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bhubaneswar

BJD supremo Naveen Patnaik on Friday blamed BJP MPs from Odisha for the passage of the amended mines law in Parliament, and asked the chief minister to pause its implementation as the legislation infringes the State's constitutional rights and would stymie its progress.

The party has announced it will hold a massive rally outside the Assembly on September 28 to protest against the amended Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act.

The Monsoon Session of the Odisha Assembly has been facing disruptions for four days now, as the opposition BJD and Congress MLAs, sporting black scarves, raised slogans in the House on Friday, demanding repeal of the law. The proceedings had to be adjourned till 4 pm.

Following the adjournment, leader of the Opposition, Patnaik said: "As far as the MMDR Act is concerned, why blame others when 20 Lok Sabha MPs from Odisha belonging to the BJP supported the bill in Parliament?"

"The BJD will take this up strongly with the State Government and ask it to pause and examine the issue, as this process could lead to a huge loss of revenue for the State," the former chief minister said. Under the amended Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, passed by Parliament in August, the Centre seeks to take under its control the regulation of mineral-bearing lands containing mineral deposits in accordance with parameters prescribed under the legislation. Opposition parties in Odisha have alleged that the law "snatches the rights" of mineral-



rich states and weakens their financial autonomy.

Immediately after the Bill was passed in Parliament, Patnaik on August 29 wrote to Odisha BJP MPs urging them to call for a reversal of the amendments, saying the changes curtail the state's powers to levy taxes on mineral rights and mineral-bearing land.

He had also appealed to the saffron party MPs to safeguard the interests of the people who elected them to Parliament. "I earnestly

appeal to you (BJP MPs) to listen to your conscience and think about the future generations of Odisha. I appeal to you to challenge and call for a reversal of the amendment made in the MMDR Act that takes away the powers of the State Government," he had said in the letter. Odisha MPs, including former Union minister Dharmendra Pradhan, had claimed that the new mining law would instead benefit all states, including Odisha. One of the MPs claimed the new

law would boost economic activities in the State.

BJD vice-president Pratap Jena claimed that Odisha would suffer a loss of over ₹1 lakh crore and pointed out that a nine-judge Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court on July 25, 2024, ruled that States could impose taxes and levies on mines and minerals.

"This created an opportunity for Odisha to receive ₹1 lakh crore towards arrears, and ₹12,000 crore annually as revenue from mining. However, the State lost the opportunity due to the implementation of the Act," Jena said. Following the 2024 general elections, the BJP has 20 Lok Sabha MPs, and the Congress has one. However, the BJD has five MPs in the Rajya Sabha, who had opposed the MMDR Amendment Act when it came to the Upper House of Parliament.

CITU, AIKS demand removal of CEC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Trade unions and farmers' bodies have launched a joint offensive against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, demanding his immediate removal over alleged irregularities in the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls that have purportedly disenfranchised millions of working-class citizens.

In separate statements issued on Friday, the Centre of Indian Trade Unions (CITU) and the All India Kisan Sabha (AIKS) voiced grave concern



Representative image

over recent media disclosures. The reports revealed that two Election Commissioners had raised formal objections on at least 14 occasions over the past ten months regarding key decisions, including the cen-

tralisation of the electoral roll database, restricted access for field officers, and procedural decisions during the SIR process.

CITU General Secretary Elamaram Kareem accused the CEC of undermining uni-

versal adult franchise at the behest of the Central Government. He highlighted that the majority of those affected by the revisions are poor, marginalised, and seasonal migrant workers who are forced to forego daily earnings while attempting to re-enrol. CITU further warned against plans by certain State Governments to link access to welfare schemes and social security benefits under the new Labour Codes directly to voter identification, threatening to strip vulnerable populations of both their voting rights and welfare entitlements.

8 ex-UDP MLAs submit merger letter to Meghalaya Assembly

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Shillong

In a major political development in Meghalaya, eight former United Democratic Party (UDP) MLAs who recently crossed over to the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) formally submitted a letter to the State Legislative Assembly on Friday, informing the House of their merger with the saffron party.

In the absence of Assembly Speaker Thomas A Sangma — who is currently on an official study tour in Malta — the merger documents were handed over to Dr Andrew Simons, Adviser (Legislation) to the Meghalaya Legislative



Assembly. The legislators were accompanied during the submission by BJP State President Rikman G Momin and BJP MLA Sanbor Shullai.

Speaking to media persons after accepting the papers, Dr Simons confirmed that all eight legislators had submitted their documents seeking recognition of their

merger with the BJP. "The papers have been submitted by all of them. The letter is addressed to the Hon'ble Speaker, informing about the merger with the Bharatiya Janata Party. They have submitted the required documents, and it will be processed accordingly. The matter will be examined

by the Hon'ble Speaker, following which an appropriate order will be passed," Simons stated.

Of the eight legislators, seven were physically present during the submission, while the papers of Mayralbom Syiem were submitted on his behalf in his absence. Addressing queries on whether the move constitutes a full merger of the UDP Legislature Party given that four UDP MLAs remain outside the group, Dr Simons noted that the Assembly Secretariat would thoroughly examine all technicalities, documents, and constitutional provisions before the Speaker delivers a final ruling.

Assam looking for tech-driven solutions for flood preparedness, says CM Himanta

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Guwahati

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Friday said the State was looking for technology-driven solutions for flood preparedness, especially after the recent deluge that caused huge loss of lives and resources.

Speaking at the launch of the North East Seva Innovation Challenge (NESFIC) here, Sarma said everybody in the State understands the importance of better flood preparedness and that he has a firm belief that the youth will come up with solutions to address it.

The Science and Technology Department has



Himanta visiting flood-hit areas in Assam

FILE PHOTO

brought challenges involving satellites, drones and artificial intelligence for crop-health monitoring, wetland mapping, encroachment detection on Government land and development of systems for flood management and early warning.

The chief minister said that

even a few additional hours of advance warning provided through technology could help a district administration protect lives, homes and livelihoods during floods. "We have seen recent floods in Sivasagar and Charaideo districts... Perhaps, had we received a warning five or six

hours earlier, several lives and properties could have been saved," he added. He said 'NESFIC-Ashtalakshmi for Viksit Bharat' provides a dedicated platform for talent, creativity and problem-solving capabilities of youth of the Northeast. NESFIC seeks to create a practical ecosystem in which young innovators can identify real-world challenges, develop solutions and move toward actual implementation.

The initiative is not about innovation merely for the sake of creating something new but about understanding the problems faced by people, government institutions and industries and applying knowledge, creativity and technology to develop practical solutions, he added.

CIC seeks data on fireworks licences cancelled after fatal accidents

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Central Information Commission (CIC) has directed the Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation (PESO) to provide data on fireworks licences cancelled following fatal accidents, after the explosives safety body said it had no information on the standard operating procedure followed in such cases.

Information Commissioner Khushwant Singh Sethi issued the direction while hearing an appeal seeking information on fireworks approvals, safety procedures followed after fatal accidents, accident reports made available for public awareness and licences cancelled after fatal accidents.

The commission observed



that the respondent had provided only partial information and directed PESO to furnish a revised reply covering the information sought.

On licences cancelled after fatal accidents, the commission directed PESO to provide the "numerical value of the number of Fireworks Licenses that were cancelled due to the Fatal Accidents, by finding responsibility on the

part of manufacturers", for the three years preceding the RTI application.

PESO had initially said "no information available" on the SOP followed after fatal accidents and referred to Rule 131 of the Explosives Rules, 2008. The commission directed it to provide the SOP or relevant rule as sought. The RTI application also sought the number of

aerial and display fireworks products approved by PESO, permitted shell sizes and a list of factories and approved products.

During the hearing, the respondent submitted that a link to the list of authorised fireworks had been provided. The commission, however, queried why the list of factories and approved products had not been provided. The respondent acknowledged that he had "missed out on answering the said point" and submitted that the sought list would be provided, according to the order.

The commission also directed PESO to provide the numerical figure, if available, of combination fireworks products using various sizes of shells that had been approved.

Editor's
TAKE

Xi in DC: Pageantry, but little substance

The Trump-Xi summit leaves the US-China rivalry largely unchanged, managing competition rather than delivering a breakthrough

Xi Jinping walked down the red carpet at Joint Base Andrews this week for his first Washington visit in over a decade – the third face-to-face meeting between him and Donald Trump in under a year, after Busan in October and Beijing in May. The optics were unmistakably warm: a military review in the Rose Garden, a state dinner in the East Room, and both leaders speaking of mutual respect.

Beneath it, the same unresolved fault lines – trade, technology, Taiwan – remain exactly where they were. Xi's concerns were not disguised. On artificial intelligence, Beijing wants Washington to ease chip export controls and open the door to Chinese AI models, while offering rhetorical convergence on keeping AI "under human control" and pitching a multilateral governance framework built around China's newly launched World AI Cooperation Organisation.

On trade, China wants relief from tariffs and validation of the rare-earth leverage it has built, in exchange for renewing the Busan truce. On Taiwan, Xi's line hasn't moved: no separation, and "utmost caution" urged on US arms sales.

None of this travels far. Washington's own reporting shows Beijing's offer to extend the rare-earths truce to the end of Trump's term collapsed on mutual distrust before the summit even began. The May Beijing agreement – \$17 billion in annual agricultural purchases, 200 Boeing jets, new trade boards – is already behind schedule, with farm purchases undershooting and the boards still not operational.

AI cooperation, the one area both sides call promising, is constrained by the same suspicion: Beijing believes safety talk is a pretext for containment, while Washington doubts any Chinese commitment would be honoured. The realistic ceiling is a narrow, symbolic step – perhaps an incident-warning channel - not a governance breakthrough. The real story is what each side is buying with this summit, not what they're solving. Trump needs a trade win before midterms dominated by cost-of-living anger. Xi needs to project strength before his party congress, and he has spent recent weeks doing exactly that - courting BRICs in Delhi, pitching a Middle East "security architecture" in Cairo, and positioning China as the stabilising power to Washington's war-fatigued unpredictability.

Iran's war, in its seventh month, has quietly shifted leverage towards Beijing: depleted US munitions stocks need the rare earths and critical minerals China still dominates.

Expect the Busan truce extended, an AI working group formalised without teeth, and Taiwan left carefully unresolved. That last point deserves attention: allies from Tokyo to Taipei worry Trump could trade Taiwan assurances for a trade headline, and nothing in his instincts rules that out.

For the rest of the world, including India, the takeaway is a fragile equilibrium, not a settled order. Two leaders too entrenched in their own judgement to concede ground are buying time, not making peace. The contest for technological and economic primacy continues exactly as before - only with better photographs.



MD AFSHAR ALAM

Artificial intelligence has moved from the margins of defence planning to the heart of the war room, and the diplomacy meant to govern it is being left far behind. Machines now sift oceans of surveillance data and hand commanders ranked target lists in seconds. The people who set the rules are still arguing over definitions that date back to the last decade.

Washington, Beijing and Moscow treat AI as a strategic asset of the same order as air power or the nuclear arsenal. President Putin said years ago that whoever leads in AI will rule the world. President Xi has called for self-reliance and mastery across every core AI technology. President Trump has committed the United States to doing whatever it takes to lead the field. Those words have turned into budgets. The US Army trains officers on the Maven Smart System, and the Pentagon has created a Defense Autonomous Warfare Group that is absorbing tens of billions of dollars. China and Russia are pouring rising sums into swarming drones and autonomous strike systems, and the two defence ministries have held talks on how AI might aid a large conventional conflict.

The sharpest question is what happens when AI stops driving weapons and starts advising the humans who fire them. At a Congressional hearing this month, witnesses cautioned that an AI system can influence a human decision leading to a strike while the person retains formal responsibility for the final call, and that recommendations can arrive faster than officers can authenticate them, compressing the time to intervene. Responsibility becomes blurred. A commander who approves a target in seconds, trusting a system he cannot fully audit, is accountable in name while the real selection happened inside a model.

Gaza offers the most documented example of what this looks like in practice. Israeli forces used AI systems called Lavender and the Gospel to generate targets at speed, with Lavender marking around 37,000 people as suspected militants and Gospel flagging buildings and infrastructure. A separate tracking tool named "Where's Daddy?" signalled when a target entered his home, and in some cases the house was marked for bombing while the family was present. Intelligence officers described treating the machine's output as though it were a human decision, and reported that the army accepted the deaths of 15 to 20 civilians for a junior operative and more than 100 for a senior commander. Legal scholars have identified



AT THE UNITED NATIONS, THE PICTURE IS SLOWER STILL. THE GROUP OF GOVERNMENTAL EXPERTS SPENT MUCH OF ITS THREE-YEAR MANDATE DEBATING WHAT HUMAN CONTROL EVEN MEANS AND REACHED THE END OF THAT MANDATE WITHOUT A BINDING TEXT, LEAVING THE QUESTION TO THE SEVENTH REVIEW CONFERENCE OF THE CONVENTION ON CERTAIN CONVENTIONAL WEAPONS IN NOVEMBER

The writer is a former Vice-Chancellor of Jamia Hamdard, New Delhi

these practices as potentially violating the principles of distinction, proportionality and precaution.

Ukraine has become the world's largest live proving ground for the same technology. AI-enabled combat systems there are being tested at a scale seen nowhere else, and Russia has fielded AI-powered strike drones that can evade air defences, identify targets and operate offline. What one war validates spreads quickly to every arsenal watching.

Diplomacy has produced movement without much grip. At their summit in May, the American and Chinese leaders agreed to improve policy exchanges on AI, and a bilateral channel on AI governance was announced, after which Chinese officials urged the world to close the regulatory vacuum around military AI and backed rules that could eventually become binding. Yet both powers sent substantially smaller delegations to the recent Responsible AI in the Military Domain summit in Spain than they had to the 2024 meeting in South Korea. The one understanding they had quietly held, keeping AI away from the decision to use nuclear weapons, looks to be eroding rather than consolidating.

At the United Nations, the picture is slower still. The Group of Governmental Experts spent much of its three-year mandate debating what human control even means and reached the end of that mandate without a binding text, leaving the question to the Seventh Review Conference of the Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons in November. In December 2025, the General Assembly passed Resolution 80/57, and India voted in favour of it. New Delhi holds to a careful line of its own. It backs the expert process and

insists that any use of autonomy obey the laws of armed conflict with human accountability intact, while declining to support a legally binding ban. On that stance, it sits alongside the United States, Russia and Israel among the main opponents of treaty negotiations, wary of rules that could freeze its own options.

This is where AI has become a weapons danger of a new kind. The same models that draft text and design molecules can speed the engineering of novel arms and lower the skill needed to build them. Capabilities once held by great powers can pass to smaller states and to groups that answer to no state. Systems that can select and engage targets on their own already exist, are being deployed in combat, and are being procured at unprecedented scale. More than 160 countries have voted for restraint, while the strongest military powers resist anything that might constrain their programmes.

The problem forces a rethink of what a weapon is. For centuries, a weapon waited for a human to aim and fire. A system that picks its own targets breaks that assumption and asks whether a machine should ever be allowed to make the choice that ends a life. Defence ministries insist a person will always stay in the loop. That loop keeps tightening as the systems grow faster, and a human given three seconds to say yes is a supervisor in title alone. For now, the race is ahead of the rulebook by a clear margin. Whether governments can close that gap before an AI-driven error, in a crowded sky or a nuclear command chain, forces a decision no one intended is the test the coming summits and the November review will have to meet. The technology will not wait for them to agree.

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

Ordinary life could be Extraordinary

Not every spiritual figure we have heard of have renounced ordinary life. Some of them did the Sadhana and transformed from within.

Sarada Devi continued performing household duties, cooking, managing finances, receiving a constant stream of guests, throughout her life as the spiritual head of Ramakrishna's growing community of monks and devotees. Even as her reputation grew and disciples began to revere her as a living embodiment of the divine mother, she never stepped back from the kitchen or the daily running of the household. When asked why she continued such ordinary domestic work herself rather than delegating it entirely, she reportedly said that these small daily duties, done with awareness and love, were themselves a form of worship, no less sacred than formal meditation or ritual observance.

Her life quietly dismantled the common assumption that holiness requires escaping ordinary responsibilities altogether, retreating into caves or renouncing household life. Instead, she showed that the sacred can inhabit the most mundane tasks, cooking a meal, welcoming a stranger, balancing accounts, when approached with full presence and unwavering care. We often separate our "real" spiritual life, meditation, prayer, quiet reflection, from our daily obligations of work, chores, and family duties, treating the latter as unavoidable distractions rather than a genuine opportunity for practice. One can be in the normal life but lead an extraordinary life.

Today, perform one ordinary task, cooking, cleaning, routine chores, with the same attention and care you might otherwise bring only to a meditation practice.

—DAIV



DIVYA BHATIA

2ND OPINION

Every September 27 World Tourism Day is celebrated around the world to spare a thought to the industry that not only is a money spinner but also connects the world. This year it is hosted by El Salvador, with UN Tourism choosing "Digital Agenda and Artificial Intelligence to Redesign Tourism" as its theme. For India, the day is also a moment to ask a sharper question: is the country monetising the one asset no competitor can copy - its spiritual depth?

The economic case for tourism needs no dressing up. Provisional National Accounts Statistics for 2023-24 put tourism's contribution to India's GDP at 5.22 per cent, and roughly 13 per cent of all employment in the country. The Ministry of Tourism and NITI Aayog jointly project wellness tourism alone could add \$18 billion to GDP by 2030.

Yet India is yet to realise its full potential. India ranks 39th of 119 countries - despite scoring in the global top ten for natural, cultural and non-leisure resources, one of only three



countries to do so. The gap between resource and rank is exactly where policy must work harder: on connectivity, visa friction, last-mile infrastructure and destination marketing. This is where spirituality becomes strategy, not sentiment. India is the only country on earth that is simultaneously the birthplace of Buddhism, the home of yoga, and a living laboratory of meditation traditions stretching back millennia. Nowhere else can a traveller walk in the Buddha's actual footsteps and take a sunrise yoga class on the same trip.

The Buddhist circuit - Bodh Gaya, Sarnath, Kushinagar, Rajgir, Nalanda, Sravasti - draws only around 1.2 million pilgrim visits a year, a fraction of the world's roughly 500 million Buddhists, concentrated overwhelmingly in Sri Lanka, Thailand, Japan, South Korea and Vietnam. India's hand strengthened considerably this July when Sarnath, where the Buddha delivered his first sermon, was inscribed as the country's 45th UNESCO World Heritage Site. That

recognition should be the trigger for a harder push: direct flights into Gaya, Varanasi and Kushinagar from Buddhist-majority countries, a unified multi-country e-visa with Nepal for the Lumbini leg, and monastery-standard stays instead of ad hoc guesthouses. Schemes like Swadesh Darshan and the IRCTC's Buddhist Circuit train must be scale. The yoga and wellness story is, if anything, moving faster than policy can track it. Realising the full value of that lead needs three things New Delhi has only partly delivered: certification standards so a "yoga retreat" or "meditation centre" actually means something to a foreign traveller booking sight unseen; river and ecological safeguards around the Ganga so Rishikesh does not develop itself into the very congestion tourists are fleeing; and a coordinated diplomatic push, riding on the goodwill already built by International Yoga Day, to position yoga and Vedic meditation as India's answer to Japan's onsen tourism or Bali's wellness branding.

This year's World Tourism Day theme of AI and digital tourism is not a distraction from that spiritual case - it is the delivery mechanism. AI-powered translation at Buddhist pilgrimage sites, digital queue and crowd management at Rishikesh's ghats, and app-based authentication of genuine yoga schools would do more for India's spiritual tourism brand than any glossy campaign. The Buddha and the yogi built India's spiritual capital over two millennia; it is now government policy's turn to compound the interest.

The writer is an educator and a columnist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

CJP demands CEC's resignation over SIR

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Thursday demanded that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar resign within 48 hours over concerns surrounding recent elections and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. It warned of a nationwide agitation and an indefinite sit-in in Delhi if he remained in office.

At a press conference, CJP co-convener Ashutosh Ranka called for criminal proceedings against Kumar. The party also demanded that upcoming elections be halted, electoral rolls from before the SIR be restored and an independent commission be constituted to examine the revision process.

Ranka urged the Supreme Court to secure files relating to SIR decisions, arguing that they could otherwise be destroyed. The CJP also called for the repeal of the 2023 law governing the appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners, and sought a new law involving civil society groups.

The CJP has alleged that the Election Commission's handling of the SIR process threatens electoral transparency. These allegations warrant scrutiny and a transparent response from the authorities.

BHAGWAN THADANI | MUMBAI

A drop saved is a drop shared

Change our daily habits to save litres of clean, fresh water every day. Use a glass of water instead of a running tap to wet and rinse your toothbrush. A running tap can waste about 16 litres of water every minute.

Take a shower instead of a bath and limit it to four minutes. Use a cup, sink or container of warm water to clean your shaver rather than leaving the tap running. Never shave in the shower.

Scrape food waste from plates and dishes instead of rinsing it away. Rinse dishes in a bucket and reuse the water in the garden. When loading the dishwasher, do not rinse dishes beforehand. Run the dishwasher and washing machine only with full loads, preferably using cold water and adjusting the water level to the load size.

Repair dripping taps and leaking toilets promptly; they can waste up to 13 litres of water a day.

Fresh water is the lifeblood of nature. Without it, we cannot sustain clean air, food, drinking water or countless ecological and recreational benefits. We must therefore use water sustainably, respecting it as a shared resource. The consequences of waste are already visible in expanding deserts, droughts and famine. It is time to save water.

S AKHILESH KRISHNAN | MUMBAI

A Route to Preferential Treatment?

The Supreme Court's recent observations in the SASTRA University land-encroachment case raise a disturbing question: can prolonged encroachment of public land eventually become a pathway to preferential treatment?

According to the judicial record, SASTRA has occupied 31.37 acres of government land in Thanjavur since 1985. The land was allotted to the Prison Department for an open-air jail, but the project could not proceed because of the occupation and subsequent litigation. After a prolonged legal battle, the Madras High Court directed eviction. SASTRA has challenged the verdict in the Supreme Court. The Supreme Court has asked the Tamil Nadu Government to explore alternatives, including alternative land or payment of the market value of suitable land. While protecting students and ensuring educational continuity is important, the State's concern that such a solution could put a "premium" on encroachment deserves consideration.

The issue is also one of equality. If institutions receive accommodation on humanitarian grounds, similar compassion should extend to the poor. Public land must be governed by law, not prolonged occupation. Any solution should protect students without rewarding encroachment.

THARCIOUS S FERNANDO | CHENNAI



PHOTO: PTI

Geostrategic communication: The new battleground for global influence

As the world becomes increasingly interconnected, effective communication is vital to navigating the complexities of the neo-geopolitical era. The global stage demands informed, inclusive communication that can withstand noise, bridge divides and build a more cooperative global order



CHAITANYA K PRASAD

In view of the geopolitical turbulence and uncertainty that unfolds globally on a regular basis, geostrategic communication today has become a multi-dimensional and complex process. Thanks to the fragile shifts that are taking place in the geopolitical space, the design of geostrategic communication is anything but constant. Changes are taking place within seconds, or on a 24x7 basis within a 360° ecosystem. While new opportunities are emerging, disruptions are ruling the roost and strategic narratives are becoming victims of fakery, misinformation and misguided information flow. In the midst of this uncertainty, it is important to understand and outline the ecosystem of geostrategic communication today.

There is no doubt that the communication process and tools have become core instruments of perception management, narrative building and influence over countries, polity and citizens at large. As the entire geopolitical philosophy and practice has become disruptive, media management, influence, messaging and info-networking have adopted disruptive shades and colours in operation.

While real-time information exchange systems exist, practitioners are constantly witnessing the deluge of credibility crises within the geostrategic framework. Due to the multiplicity of sources of information, audiences and analysts and communication strategists have to deal with conflicting ideas, perspectives, lower attention spans and polarisation of thoughts and actions. As a consequence, the credibility quotient in diplomatic practice has at times lacked coherence and has been subject to flip-flops in practice and application. When we talk about global power today, we rarely talk just about weapons or borders anymore; we talk about stories. We talk about who controls the narrative. That's essentially what geostrategic communication is: shaping how a country is perceived in the global mind-space, and making that perception work in its favour.

The reality today is that the global information landscape faces mounting challenges of consistency, focus, norms and practices. Due to the complexities prevailing, there is no conceptual clarity within communication frameworks to decode issues such as climate change, the green economy, the circular economy, tariffs and trade wars, or sustainable development. Perceptions of these issues are increasingly dependent on algorithms, data analytics, surveys and social media tools - mechanisms that filter, amplify or distort realities. In this absence of clarity and deeper understanding, audiences are being subjected to new ground rules for transparency, authenticity and content creation, often with uneven results.

What is required is a collaborative effort towards a new "Global Information Order", an institutional platform bridging the gap between medium and message, narrative and policy. The 7Rs of communication - relevance, reliability, response, revival, reconnection, reconstruction and reposition - must be mainstreamed to create a communicative ecosystem that builds trust while respecting diversity.

The new global order must calibrate perception, build relationships and drive action through mutually agreeable communication tools. It must integrate rather than divide, connect rather than confuse. At its core, communication must transform from a transactional act into a trust-building exercise, placing people, their lived realities and their collective aspirations at the centre.

The geopolitical reality of 2026 makes one truth clear: communication is no longer a tool to package decisions but a core element of policymaking itself. Perception is as powerful as policy, and a well-crafted message can be as consequential as a treaty. Strategic communication must therefore be embedded at the start of the decision-making chain, ensuring coherence, credibility and clarity.

Geostrategic communication today operates at several levels. One of the key themes relates to the idea of balancing communication and messaging without leaning towards a particular group or entity. Due to the proliferation of multiple power centres and alliances, the geostrategic communication system should focus on consistency and constructive parameters in transmitting messages to multiple stakeholders. On the other end of the spectrum is the challenge posed by 'algorithmic tools', processes and deepfakes, which encourage a credibility hurricane, leading to crisis communication. Hence, the



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

THE GLOBAL STAGE DEMANDS NOT JUST INFORMATION, BUT INFORMED, INTENTIONAL AND INCLUSIVE COMMUNICATION THAT CAN WITHSTAND THE NOISE, BRIDGE DIVIDES AND BUILD A MORE COOPERATIVE GLOBAL ORDER

The writer is Former Civil Servant. Writes on strategic communication and cinema. Inputs provided by Zoya Ahmad and Vaishnavie Srinivasan

blending of soft power and hard power and narrative configuration remains the biggest test and threat of geostrategic communication being implemented at ground zero.

The rise of artificial intelligence has added another layer of complexity to global communication. AI-driven analytics enable unprecedented insights into audience behaviour, preferences and sentiments, allowing for hyper-personalised messaging. These tools are invaluable for diplomats and foreign policy experts, who can now craft messages with immense precision and predict their impact with greater accuracy. However, with this advancement come ethical dilemmas. The line between strategic communication and manipulation can easily blur, necessitating robust frameworks to ensure accountability and fairness. As the communication landscape becomes more intricate, the demand for skilled specialists is growing. These professionals are not just channels for information; they are strategists, analysts and creators who understand the nuances of messaging in a diverse and rapidly changing world.

As the world becomes increasingly interconnected, the ability to communicate effectively will be one of the most powerful tools in navigating the complexities of this neo-geopolitical era. The global stage demands not just information, but informed, intentional and inclusive communication that can withstand the noise, bridge divides and build a more cooperative global order.

New ideas and platforms influence the contours of global discourse. The information dissemination process today hinges on the interplay of ideas, experiences with exposures and perceptions. As communicators fight to stay relevant, the ecosystem is caught up in flair and the excesses of instant communication. In such an environment, the challenge for policymakers and media strategists is to recalibrate the tone and strategy of messaging. It is no longer sufficient to just 'speak'. It is important to understand the dynamics of the international communication system. Geostrategic communication is under constant threat from information overload, exaggeration and infodemics. With every global event instantly translatable into trending hashtags and viral videos, boundaries between statecraft and storytelling are blurring. The rise of visual culture — Instagram reels, AI-generated avatars, TikTok diplomacy — demands that institutions adapt to the speed of sentiment and social perception. Public diplomacy strategies must be re-engineered for a world running on 15-20-second attention spans.

This reaffirms the 7Cs perspective, which is broad-based and captures the reality of geopolitical leanings and practice. The 7Cs reiterate the SOPs which all stakeholders of geostrategic communication need to imbibe and apply in leading the information flow and creating the appropriate institutional verticals.

- CONTEXT: What is the strategic significance?
- CONNECT: Who needs to hear it?
- CONSTRUCT: What is the one key message?
- COMMUNICATE: Which channel works best?
- COUNTER: What misinformation or misunderstanding could emerge?
- CREDIBILITY: What evidence supports our message?
- CONSEQUENCE: How will we know communication made a difference?

Hence, today, communication is no longer just about delivering a message; it is about shaping perceptions, building relationships and driving action. As the world becomes increasingly interconnected, the ability to communicate effectively will be one of the most powerful tools in navigating the complexities of a neo-geopolitical era. In an era marked by shifting alliances and evolving global priorities, multilateral institutions face both challenges and opportunities in devising the perfect path for effective geostrategic communication.

Student suicides: Whose goals are we chasing?



ACHARYA PRASHANT

IIT Bombay has lost its third student to suicide this year, there are allegations of caste-based discrimination, and the matter is under investigation. I will not pre-empt what the investigation finds. But during my visits to over a dozen IIT campuses in the last year, students have recurrently spoken of a vicious pattern. This year, at least eight IIT student suicides have been reported so far.

As per the NCRB, 14,488 students died by suicide in India in 2024, the highest ever recorded, up about 80 per cent from 8,068 in 2014. And each time a student dies, one reason is almost always cited: too much pressure. A student who also faces discrimination, or has no one to talk to, carries that pressure twice over.

To say that students are tragically ending their lives because of the high-pressure environment in IITs and other places is to see only half the picture. Somebody who clears the JEE is used to high pressure; otherwise, he would not have made it to the campus. Pressure alone is not the problem; the deadly situation is one where the cacophony of external pressure meets the void of internal purposelessness.

With no purpose and no pressure, one is a rolling stone. At most, life will be wasted, but one lives on. Now keep the purposelessness and add high pressure. This is where suicides happen. Pressure alone doesn't kill: think of a youngster with great purpose and high pressure. There will be great pressure, but he will say, "I will live on, because I understand my purpose."

Does purposelessness start when the student enters the campus? No. The whole system, from home onwards, robs him of any purpose of his own. And how is that done? By supplying him with external, artificial, fake purposes. The family says, "Now you are 15 and it's your boards, and this year your purpose must be to score 99."

He has not been left free to ask himself, "Who am I, and what am I here for?" Parents and educators seldom address this question. They say, "You exist to achieve." So now the student comes to campus, having been given impossible targets and told that if he doesn't achieve them, life is meaningless. Some students buckle. If one pulls too hard on the ends of a chain, some link will break. The fault does not belong to the link; one must question those who are pulling.

There is great talent in the top institutions, but what is that talent being told to do? Somebody is selling shoes after doing a B.Tech in computer science. What success is there in this? We say, "My Johnny has landed a three-crore package," and that some-



times makes the newspapers as well. That should indeed make the newspapers, as a tragedy, not as a celebration. From all directions, the message is that there is one particular definition of success, and if one cannot measure up to it, then life is not worth living. And some, unfortunately, are crushed by it.

All this is symptomatic of a society where inner education is considered dispensable. Just as one requires experts to teach maths and physics, one requires experts to deliver life education. The IITs do the first superbly; the second is where the whole chain, from home to campus, has fallen short. The Supreme Court has made institutions responsible for preventing suicides. But a counsellor's room cannot carry this alone.

I was a student at IIT Delhi myself for four years, and I owe a great deal to the rigour of that education. I don't remember anyone from my batch dying by suicide. One reason could be that our longings had not been stoked that high. Today, after every such tragedy, the term that comes to the fore is "mental health". What we call mental health is actually the health of the ego, the health of the self.

And the self is born sick. The very name of that which is born is incompleteness. And all its life it keeps adding things to itself, so that somehow it may feel complete. The parents, teachers, society and market that put this pressure on the young, in fact all of us, carry the same incomplete ego, only now it runs as a system.

Depression is the flip side of hope. In the past, hopes remained unfulfilled. Today, hopes are fulfilled, but their fulfilment does not make us complete, and that is what becomes depression. At every step, the student is told only that there is more to be done. It's like a falling stock. We invested, and it fell, and the broker says, "Don't cry. Invest more." The more it sinks, the deeper we sink with it. We all stand deeply invested in a falling stock called our way of life. Who are we, what is life and, if one is to live, what is one to live for? These questions never even come up for discussion. So where does a young person begin? With a no.

"No" must be the first word in one's dictionary. There has to be a resounding no to all those who attempt to impose themselves on one's life. And if you are a student going through this right now, I am not going to tell you it is nothing. The sorrow is real, and it is not new. But your life is bigger than any grade, rank, placement or expectation. Please do not end it. Your personal sorrow is one thing; sorrow itself, the universal problem of sorrow, is another and much bigger one. So, dear youngster, why not step away from your personal sorrow and invest your life in fighting the greater problem of sorrow itself? That can happen only when you set yourself a goal beyond yourself. Win or lose, this enemy that has made everyone's life hell has to be fought. All the restlessness within a person is energy coming out as grief. It must be channelled. The sorrow within must be turned into a worthy struggle. But struggle holds up, and lasts, only when it is not waged for oneself alone.

Acharya Prashant is a philosopher and author whose work centres on self-inquiry and its application to contemporary life

Social security net: What the new EPFO wage ceiling means for employees



DEEPAK JAISWAL

The significance of a job lies beyond the monthly wage. For a worker, it is also the foundation on which a secure future is built. As India's economy and workforce evolve, social security institutions must change with them. The decision to raise the wage ceiling for mandatory coverage under the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000 per month is important in this larger context. It brings a wider section of workers into the formal provident-fund system and, in doing so, strengthens a key link between employment today and financial security tomorrow.

The earlier ceiling of ₹15,000 had remained unchanged since 2014. During these years, wages, living costs and the nature of employment have changed considerably. India today has a larger and more diverse formal workforce, with expanding manufacturing, services and organised employment. Raising the ceiling to ₹25,000 therefore brings EPFO coverage closer to the realities of today's workforce. It also ensures that employees who earn more than the earlier limit are not left outside mandatory social security merely because their wages

have crossed a threshold that was set for a very different economic environment.

The importance of the change is best understood from the perspective of an ordinary employee. Provident fund savings are not simply deductions from a worker's salary. They represent a mechanism for building financial security over the course of a working life. Contributions made regularly, together with accumulated interest over time, can create a meaningful financial cushion for the future. A higher contribution base can consequently make a significant difference to retirement preparedness, particularly when contributions continue over several decades.

For employees, this wider coverage can provide greater confidence that their years of work are contributing towards their financial security beyond their active working years. It can also reduce dependence on individual savings arrangements alone and provide greater assurance during periods when regular employment income may no longer be available.

The benefits can extend beyond the individual employee. Stronger provident-fund coverage can contribute to household financial sta-



bility, deeper domestic savings and greater financial inclusion. A household with stronger financial protection is better positioned to plan for important needs such as education, housing and health. At a broader level, a stronger culture of long-term savings can contribute to a more resilient economy. The expansion of EPFO coverage therefore has significance not only for the employees directly brought within the revised ceiling, but also for the wider financial security of their families.

The increase in the ceiling also fits into India's larger movement towards formalisation of

employment. As more workers enter formal employment, access to social security becomes an important part of the employment relationship. Formal employment is not simply about receiving a salary through an organised employer; it is also about having access to recognised benefits, protections and retirement savings. The expansion of EPFO coverage strengthens this connection between employment and social security and can encourage a stronger culture of documented employment, regular contributions and long-term financial planning.

This is particularly relevant as India expands its manufacturing capacity, infrastructure and organised services. A growing economy needs not only more jobs, but also better employment arrangements. Workers are more likely to see the value of formal employment when it provides benefits that extend beyond the monthly wage. Social security consequently becomes an important component of the quality of employment and of the broader formalisation process.

The expansion of EPFO coverage therefore strengthens an important link between economic growth and social security. As India's economy grows and the formal workforce

expands, labour institutions must evolve alongside changing wages, employment patterns and economic conditions. Revisiting the wage ceiling reflects the need to keep social-security systems responsive to workforce realities.

The increase from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000 may appear to be a simple revision of the wage ceiling, but its significance is considerably wider. It brings a larger group of workers into mandatory EPF coverage, strengthens long-term savings and extends social-security protection to employees in the covered wage range. At the same time, it supports the continuing formalisation of India's labour market and can contribute to a more stable and secure employment ecosystem.

Economic development is not only about higher growth, increased production or better infrastructure. It is ultimately about improving the quality of life and security of citizens. For workers, development means being able to earn a decent income today while having greater confidence about tomorrow.

Stable employment, timely wages and financial preparedness for the future are important dimensions of that confidence. In this backdrop, the revised EPFO wage ceiling represents an important step forward towards building a more resilient workforce as India advances towards Viksit Bharat@2047.

The author is National President, National Front of Indian Trade Unions



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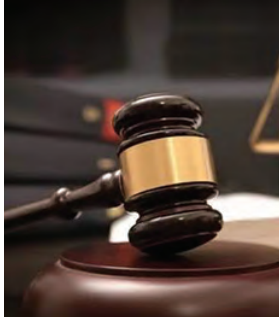
2-day family court conference to be organised in Guwahati

A Supreme Court committee and the Gauhati High Court will organise a two-day conference on Saturday and Sunday in Guwahati regarding family court issues, a release said.

It said the apex court's Committee for Family Court Matters along with the high court is organising an Eastern Zone Regional Conference on 'Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) versus Adjudication in Family Disputes: Challenges and Way Forward'. According to the release, Supreme Court judges Justices B V Nagarathna, Ujjal Bhuyan and N V Anjaria will be the chief guests.

It said the inaugural session will be presided over by Justice Ashutosh Kumar, Chief Justice of the Gauhati High Court. "The two-day conference will bring together judges, judicial officers, senior advocates, mediators and experts for deliberations on key issues concerning justice in family matters, including domestic violence and welfare of senior citizens; marriage, divorce and restitution of conjugal rights; custody of children, shared parenting and visitation rights," the release said.

It said the crucial matters also include maintenance and alimony, and division and partition of property, besides the issue of strengthening the human resources and infrastructure of family courts.



Search of Delhi lawyer's office: SC asks GST authorities

The Supreme Court on Friday asked the Goods and Services Tax (GST) authorities not to proceed with analysis of data seized from Advocate Puneet Batra's office till September 28.

A bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu asked Additional Solicitor General S V Raju, appearing for the authorities, not to take action till the court hears the lawyer's plea.

Batra has challenged the Delhi High Court's judgment holding that a lawyer's office can be searched by law enforcement agencies if there is prima facie evidence that the legal professional has committed an offence.

At the outset, Justice Datta clarified that they have not gone through the case files, which came to them late at night. He suggested that the matter be heard on September 28. Senior advocate N Hariharan, appearing for Batra, submitted that the investigating agency has issued summons to Batra for September 28 and urged the bench to hear the matter. "They have sent summons for Monday. Your Lordships may say that no coercive steps be taken," Hariharan said.

The bench told Raju not to take any coercive action till Monday. The Additional Solicitor General submitted that the agency was only analysing the data, and this is not a case of a lawyer-client relationship.

The bench said, "You have read the briefs, you know the facts; we don't. Don't do anything till Monday." On Wednesday, the top court took note of the submissions of senior advocates Vikas Singh and N Hariharan, and agreed to list for urgent hearing a plea challenging the Delhi High Court judgment that upheld a GST search of Batra's office and the seizure of his computer.



Procure furniture for Govt school: HC to woman who failed to deposit passport

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The Delhi High Court has asked a 64-year-old woman, who failed to deposit her passport for over two years despite a 2024 trial court direction while granting anticipatory bail, to procure essential furniture or other items worth ₹2 lakh for a Government school for the default.

The woman's senior counsel tendered an apology to the high court for the "inadvertent lapse", arguing that she never intended to derive any benefit from the non-surrender of her passport.

While seeking permission to travel to the United States of America for her son's wedding, the woman's senior counsel submitted that the passport was surrendered to the trial court in August and taken on record without any adverse action. Justice Purushendra Kumar Kaurav agreed to



grant relief to the petitioner considering her age, "candid tender of apology", absence of any foreign travel during the period and the acceptance of her surrendered passport without demur, subject to a "proportionate and accountable condition".

The judge allowed the petitioner to travel abroad for the specified time period and said such a relaxation, even in case of an admitted inadvertent default, cannot be granted without some countervailing measure. The petitioner volunteered

Sambhal mosque row: SC reserves verdict

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Friday reserved its verdict on pleas challenging a survey ordered by a Sambhal court in the Shahi Jama Masjid and Harihar temple dispute.

A bench of justices P S Narasimha and Alok Aradhe was hearing two petitions filed by the management committee of Sambhal's Jama Masjid challenging a May 19, 2025 order of the Allahabad High Court.

The high court had dismissed the mosque committee's plea against the survey ordered by the Sambhal court, upholding the civil court's direction for the survey.

The high court had said the

order to appoint a court commissioner and the suit were maintainable.

During the arguments on Friday, Additional Solicitor General K M Nataraj, appearing for the Uttar Pradesh Government, told the apex court that the state does not want to get into the respective claims of the parties.

"As the State, we don't want to get into the respective claims of either of the parties," the law officer said, adding, "As the State, we are committed and bound to protect the interests of all."

He referred to the provisions of the Places of Worship (Special Provisions) Act, 1991.

The 1991 law prohibits conversion of any place of worship and provides for the maintenance of the religious



character of any place of worship as it existed on August 15, 1947. However, the dispute relating to Ram Janmabhoomi-Babri Masjid at Ayodhya was kept out of its purview.

The bench also heard the submissions advanced by senior advocate Huzefa

Ahmadi, who appeared for the mosque committee, and advocate Vishnu Shankar Jain who represented some Hindu parties.

Ahmadi told the bench that the issue concerning interpretation of the 1991 Act was pending before a larger bench of the top court.

SC allows forensic audit of Fortis deals in Daiichi Sankyo case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Friday rejected a plea of Fortis Healthcare Ltd against the forensic audit of the company's and its former promoters' transactions allegedly linked to a ₹3,500 crore arbitral award passed in favour of Japanese pharma major Daiichi Sankyo.

On August 31, the Delhi High Court had ordered the forensic audit of Fortis and its former promoters Malvinder Mohan Singh and Shivinder Mohan Singh. A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana was hearing a plea filed by Fortis Healthcare and refused to interfere with the high court order.

"We see no reason to interfere with the impugned judgment of the Delhi High Court," the bench said.

The top court also observed that the Delhi High Court's observations against Fortis, justifying the forensic audit are only tentative and prima facie. The court passed the order



after hearing submissions made by Senior Advocate Abhishek Manu Singhvi, appearing for Fortis and Senior Advocate Mukul Rohatgi, who appeared for Daiichi Sankyo.

Senior advocate Singhvi submitted before the court that his client was never made party or an arbitrator in the case but is being treated as a judgment debtor.

"I have given a list of parties. Nowhere this company is a party, your lordship is treating me like a judgment debtor. This Singh brothers exited in 2018... the world's largest medical group IHH, Malaysian company entered with ₹4000 crores," Singhvi told the bench.

The petition challenged the August 31 order delivered by the Delhi High Court in the case titled 'Daiichi Sankyo

Company, Limited vs. Malvinder Mohan Singh And Ors'. The Delhi High Court appointed a forensic auditor to examine the transactions of former Fortis promoters in connivance with Fortis Healthcare. It has said the forensic audit aims to identify and reconstruct the entire chain of events, enabling the court to identify the persons and companies involved in the dissipation of shares.

The high court appointed S Ramanand Aiyar and Co as the forensic auditor to conduct the audit and complete the exercise within six months. In its 213-page judgment, the Delhi High Court allowed the applications of Daiichi seeking the appointment of a forensic auditor to unearth the transactions between Fortis FHL

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court on Friday adjourned for the day hearing in the Indian Secular Front's (ISF) challenge to the poll panel's decision to reassign the 'envelope' symbol to the Ritabrata Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress faction, both of which are contesting the October 6 Nandigram bypoll.

Noting that some of the counsels of the parties involved in the matter were busy in other courts, Justice Krishna Rao adjourned the hearing of the petition.

"I am very fed up with the authorities of this state now... Once the election (process) starts, every play is started," Justice Rao told the Election Commission's counsel Anamika Pandey on Thursday.

She had informed the court that the Indian Secular Front (ISF) was a registered but not a recognised political party, thus entitled to a free symbol. The poll panel



has allotted the 'envelope' symbol, earlier used by the ISF, to the Democratic Trinamool Congress and gave the Naushad Siddiqui-led party the 'almirah' symbol.

The ISF has challenged the EC's decision. Noting that the Election Commission has 183 free election symbols at its disposal, the court on Thursday sought to know the poll panel's reason for giving the 'envelope' symbol to a party which was contesting the same bypoll as the ISF.

The court said the symbol should have been kept reserved. "The authority should act fairly," Justice Rao had observed.

On Thursday, it adjourned

November 19, 2024 order of the civil judge directing the Mughal-era mosque's survey which took place the same day. A second survey carried out on November 24, 2024, the committee claimed, was illegal as the civil court never ordered it.

On August 22 last year, the apex court had agreed to hear the plea of the mosque committee against the high court order.

"In the meantime, the parties are directed to maintain status quo, as on today," the top court had said in its order.

A suit was filed before the civil judge senior division, Sambhal, contending that the mosque was built after demolishing a temple at Sambhal.

Calcutta HC adjourns ISF plea over poll symbol to another party

the hearing to Friday on a prayer by the EC's counsel for taking instructions on why a notification was not issued for allotment of symbols for the bypolls.

"Your authority is pinching people and creating legal proceedings; is this the way of the authority to work?" Justice Rao had asked the EC's lawyer. "Every time, for one reason or another, you are compelling people to come to court."

The EC's counsel had stated that the choice was upon the petitioners, who contest elections, to choose a symbol. The petitioner's lawyer disputed the claim, saying it was the poll panel which allots the symbol.

When the court asked why the EC allotted the 'envelope' symbol to another political party when the ISF fought the West Bengal assembly polls with that symbol earlier this year, the poll panel's counsel argued that the party won only one seat in that election, as a result of which the 'envelope' symbol became free again.

HC rejects ED plea to add charges in JKCA scam case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ Srinagar

The Jammu and Kashmir High Court on Friday rejected a petition filed by the Enforcement Directorate seeking addition of charges related to receipt and concealment of stolen property in a case linked to the alleged Jammu and Kashmir Cricket Association fund scam.

Justice Sanjay Parihar, however, set aside a trial court's finding that the Enforcement Directorate (ED) lacked 'locus standi' to move such an application, but held that the substantive prayer for invoking sections 411 (dishonestly receiving stolen property) and 424 (dishonest or fraudulent removal or concealment of property) of the Ranbir Penal Code (RPC) lacked merit based on the

material currently available.

The anti-money laundering probe agency had challenged an order dated March 22 passed by the chief judicial magistrate (CBI cases), which dismissed its application seeking the incorporation of additional charges under sections 411 and 424 of the RPC into the primary case being prosecuted by the CBI.

The ED contended that although the CBI filed the primary chargesheet under sections 120-B (criminal conspiracy), 406 (criminal breach of trust) and 409 (criminal breach of trust by a public servant) of the RPC, the material gathered during the probe disclosed sufficient grounds to frame charges for receiving and concealing stolen property as well.

Refusing to add the charges at this stage, the court



observed that the accusations emerging from the CBI chargesheet were essentially founded upon alleged criminal misappropriation and criminal breach of trust itself," the 29-page order said.

"The material presently available does not disclose a distinct receipt or retention of stolen property by the respondents in the capacity

contemplated by that provision. Their alleged acts form part of the principal transaction of conspiracy, misappropriation and criminal breach of trust itself," the 29-page order said.

The high court said that mere movement of funds through different accounts in furtherance of the alleged conspiracy cannot justify

addition of a charge under Section 411 of the RPC.

However, the court clarified that setting aside the trial court's order regarding the ED's lack of locus standi means the agency was within its rights to bring omissions to the court's notice and also that the rejection of the plea would not prevent the trial court from exercising its powers under Section 216 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC) to alter or add charges if fresh evidence emerges during the course of the trial.

"Should any material emerge during the course of trial which prima facie discloses commission of an offence under sections 411 or 424 of the RPC, or any other penal provision, it shall remain open to the trial court to exercise its power of alter-

ation or addition of charge, strictly in accordance with law," the order said.

The ED case is based on an FIR filed by the CBI, which booked former Jammu and Kashmir Cricket Association (JKCA) office-bearers, including general secretary Mohammed Saleem Khan and treasurer Ahsan Ahmad Mirza. The CBI later filed a chargesheet in 2018 against former chief minister Farooq Abdullah, Khan, Mirza, as well as former JKCA treasurer Mir Manzoor Gazanfer Ali and former accountants Bashir Ahmad Misgar and Gulzar Ahmad Beigh for the "misappropriation of JKCA funds amounting to Rs 43.69 crore" from grants given by the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) to promote the sport in the erstwhile state between 2002-11.

Delhi HC directs Meta to remove morphed photo of woman with PM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The Delhi High Court on Friday directed Meta platforms to immediately remove objectionable content of a woman's morphed picture posted on social media with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and ordered police to provide complete protection to the victim.

Justice Girish Kathpalia observed that this is an "extraordinary position" in which the matter is not of one woman but also of the country's prime minister. "If the Delhi Police is not sensitive about it, the court will ensure it becomes sensitive," he further noted.

The high court also issued notice to Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Saurav Das, Abhijit Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Ratna Singh on a plea by the woman alleging that they circulated her morphed and explicit picture with the prime minister.



The court, which listed the matter for further hearing on October 14, directed the police to give complete police protection to the woman who submitted that she was receiving threats to her life.

The woman's plea accused the CJP leaders of morphing and circulating her deepfake vulgar pictures with Prime Minister Modi.

The plea sought to take down certain fabricated and deepfake pictures purportedly showing the woman's morphed face in vulgar

images alongside the prime minister.

Her lawyer said that an FIR has already been registered in this regard. However, he contended that no concrete steps were taken to apprehend those responsible or to secure the immediate take-down or blocking of the viral deepfake links.

"During recent protests held by the Cockroach Janta Party at Jantar Mantar, New Delhi, respondents No. 2 to 5 (CJP leaders) along with their active accomplices-unauthorisedly harvested

the personal photograph of the petitioner and utilised Artificial Intelligence (AI) face-swapping tools to morph her face onto a highly vulgar, compromising image alongside the Prime Minister of India," the plea said.

At the outset, Justice Kathpalia said the issue relating to the takedown of the objectionable content has to go to the civil court. However, he added that looking at the sensitivity involved, the victim woman should not be made to run from one place to another and the entire prayers will be dealt with here itself.

"It is not just her face. Of course she is a victim."

"The other face should have also been blurred (in record). In such matters, I would not have entertained it because you have alternative remedies available but it is not just a matter of the lady but also about the prime minister of the country," the judge said.

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BUSINESS11

Five-day staff, seven-day banking: Modernising India’s banks

SRINATH SRIDHARAN
MADHAV NAIR

A bank employee should have a sustainable working life. A customer should be able to access banking services when needed. These two expectations should not be treated as competing interests.

India’s banking industry should now consider a five-day working week for its employees, alongside a clear commitment to keeping essential banking services available throughout the week. This is more than a question of an additional holiday. It is an opportunity to modernise the way banks organise their people, branches and technology around customer needs.

The underlying principle remains relevant: continuous service and individual employee schedules can be designed separately.

The objective should be to build a banking system that is available when customers need it, without making six-day working the default expectation for every employee.

Customer centricity must remain central to this redesign. A five-day working week should not mean that customers lose meaningful access to banking services on weekends. Banks could assess which activities require continuous availability, which can be delivered digitally and which need physical assistance. Weekend branch access, where necessary, could be organised through rotating arrangements or other locally appropriate models, taking account of customer profiles, cash dependence and financial inclusion requirements.

A rural customer, senior citizen, small trader or MSME may have different needs from a digitally confident urban customer. A modernisation programme should recognise these differences rather than assume that technology has removed the need for branches. The measure of success must be better customer service and access, not simply fewer branch working days.

The workforce dimension deserves equal attention. Banking employees increasingly handle responsibilities involving credit assessment, compliance, cybersecurity, fraud prevention, customer relationships and technology-led transformation. These are demanding

functions requiring professional judgement and sustained attention.

Work-life balance is therefore relevant to the long-term effectiveness of banking institutions. A more predictable working pattern can support employee wellbeing, talent retention and the attractiveness of banking careers. Banks compete with technology companies, fintechs and other professional services organisations for skilled professionals, including younger employees who place value on career growth, workplace culture and sustainable working arrangements.

A five-day week must nevertheless be implemented responsibly. Compressing existing workloads into five days could undermine the intended benefit. Banks would need to examine staffing, process efficiency, workload distribution and performance expectations. The aim should be a genuinely sustainable working model, not longer working hours concealed within a shorter calendar.

Operational resilience is equally important. Payment processing, cybersecurity, fraud monitoring, treasury functions and technology support require appropriate coverage beyond regular branch hours. Banks should organise these responsibilities through suitable shifts, specialist teams, on-call arrangements and escalation protocols. Not every employee needs to work every day, but every critical function must have clear accountability and adequate protection.

India’s financial ecosystem already provides relevant precedents. Many other financial

sector institutions operate on a five-day working week, while the Reserve Bank of India follows a five-day working schedule. Commercial banks have distinct customer-facing and systemic responsibilities, so their transition would require appropriate arrangements. However, these institutional examples support the case for examining whether a five-day workforce model can be designed without compromising service continuity.

The issue also has a global dimension. India’s banking sector is increasingly integrated with international financial markets, cross-border payments, treasury operations and global talent networks. International banking practices offer useful reference points, although India must adapt any model to its own regulatory framework, customer requirements and financial inclusion priorities.

The transition should therefore be supported by a practical policy framework. Banks and relevant authorities could identify essential services requiring all-days availability, establish expectations for physical customer access and monitor service quality during implementation. Customer complaints, transaction failures, cash access and the experience of vulnerable customer groups should inform the evaluation.

India’s banking industry has repeatedly adapted to major changes, from core banking and ATMs to mobile banking, UPI, digital lending and account aggregators. The organisation of banking work should evolve alongside this transformation.

Five-day banking should not be viewed merely as an employee concession. It should be considered as part of a broader effort to improve workforce sustainability, operational efficiency and customer service. The success of the change should be judged by whether customers retain reliable access, banks maintain resilience and employees gain a working life that can be sustained. A successful transition can advance the government’s customer-centric vision by ensuring continued access to banking, through physical branches or digital channels. Coordination among stakeholders can enable phased reform, safeguard service continuity, strengthen productivity and support a sustainable workforce.

India can build a financial system that remains available throughout the week while enabling its banking workforce to work within a meaningful five-day framework.

The authors are corporate advisor & senior banking leader

Signature Global buys 194-acre Gurugram land

Realty firm Signature Global has acquired a total of 194 acres of land through direct purchase and a collaboration in Gurugram to develop an integrated ultra-luxury housing project with revenue potential of ₹6,000 crore. In a regulatory filing on Friday, the company said it has “acquired and collaborated for a land parcel admeasuring approximately 194.22 acres situated at Farrukhnagar, District Gurugram, Haryana”.

Signature Global has outright purchased 25 acres of land and collaborated with a landowner for 169.22 acres. The company did not disclose the land cost, but sources said the 25-acre land has been purchased for Rs 150 crore. Signature Global informed the stock exchanges that it will develop an exclusive ultra-luxury farmhouse villa destination project on this 194-acre plot. It will develop 6.77 million square feet area in this upcoming project, with an estimated revenue of ₹5,500-6,000 crore.

Pradeep Aggarwal, Founder and Chairman of Signature Global (India) Ltd, said, “Farrukhnagar has been on our radar for some time. Its proximity to the Dwarka Expressway and KMP Expressway, combined with the scale of open land available here, creates an opportunity to approach luxury living very differently.”

He said the company would not build conventional residential development on this land. (PTI)

₹5,210 crore invested under bulk drugs PLI till June: Govt

A total investment of ₹5,210.74 crore has been made under the Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme for bulk drugs as of June 2026 with 39 projects for manufacturing 28 active pharmaceutical ingredients/key starting materials (APIs/KSMs) being commissioned, according to an official statement on Friday. The government had in 2020 approved the PLI Scheme for bulk drugs, with a total financial outlay of ₹6,940 crore.

The government has made wide-ranging efforts to increase investment in the pharmaceutical sector for enhancing manufacturing capabilities, to prevent disruption in supply of critical APIs used to make critical drugs and promote medical device industry under the PLI scheme, the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilisers -- Department of Pharmaceuticals, said in the statement.

The scheme has strengthened domestic manufacturing, reduced import dependence and encouraged technology adoption that has helped to build globally competitive manufacturing capabilities in pharma and the MedTech sectors, it said.

As of June 2026, PLI scheme beneficiaries achieved sales of ₹3,792.49 crore, including exports of ₹560.16 crore, while generating employment opportunities for 5,127 people, the ministry said in the statement.

Five greenfield projects have commissioned manufacturing facilities under the scheme, demonstrating the growing scale and diversity of domestic production, covering critical ingredients for antibiotics, cardiovascular medicines and paracetamol.

Lyftus Pharma Pvt Ltd, a subsidiary of Aurobindo Pharma Ltd, has established a large-scale Penicillin G manufacturing facility at Kakinada SEZ in Andhra Pradesh. The project with an investment of ₹2,270.05 crore, has installed capacity of 15,000 MT per annum.

Kinvan Pvt Ltd, a DPB Group company, has established a 400 MT per annum fermentation-based manufacturing facility for Clavulanic Acid (Potassium Clavulanate) at Nalagarh, Himachal Pradesh.

The project with an investment of ₹504.68 crore, has generated 465 direct jobs and recorded cumulative production of ₹413 crore, the statement noted, adding that this is the country’s first fermentation-based manufacturing facility for Potassium Clavulanate.

Andhra Organics Ltd (AOL) – a wholly owned subsidiary of Virchow Laboratories Ltd – has commissioned manufacturing facilities for Sulfadiazine, Telmisartan and Olmesartan at Pydibhimavaram in Srikakulam district of Andhra Pradesh.

The projects involve a combined investment of ₹151.47 crore and have generated 221 direct employments. Meghmani LLP has set up a 13,500 MT per annum manufacturing facility for para amino phenol at Dahej, Gujarat, with an investment of Rs 60.46 crore. (PTI)

Sensex rallies 315 points as investors turn to value stocks

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Benchmark stock indices Sensex and Nifty rebounded on Friday after value buying in blue-chip banking, oil & gas, and auto shares following recent sharp losses.

The 30-share BSE Sensex climbed 315.20 points, or 0.43 per cent, to settle at 73,895.74 with 19 of its constituents ending higher and 11 down. During the day, it hit a high of 73,968.05 and a low of 73,477.77, gyrating 490.28 points. The index had slid to an over three-month low in the previous session.

The 50-share NSE Nifty was up 77.40 points, or 0.34 per cent, to end at 23,140.50. As

many as 34 Nifty stocks advanced, 15 closed lower and one remained unchanged.

Among the Sensex firms, Axis Bank rose the most, climbing by 2.82 per cent. Mahindra & Mahindra jumped 2.24 per cent, Asian Paints 1.93 per cent, Bajaj Finance 1.21 per cent, HCL Tech 1.17 per cent and Titan 1.01 per cent.

Trent was the biggest loser, dropping by 1.41 per cent. Infosys, Kotak Mahindra Bank, ICICI Bank and Tata Steel were also among the laggards. Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, declined 1.10 per cent to \$105.4 per barrel.

“Selective bargain hunting after the recent pullback

helped the market retain a positive bias, though gains remained confined to a narrow trading range. The ability of benchmark indices to sustain above the psychologically important 23,000 level reflects domestic resilience and support from strong domestic liquidity,” Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Limited, said. Ajit Mishra, SVP – Research, Religare Broking, said, “Markets witnessed a volatile session on Friday and ended with modest gains, recovering partially from the sharp sell-off seen in the previous session.”

The recovery remained measured as investors continued to monitor elevated

global yields, crude oil prices and persistent foreign selling, Mishra added.

In Asian markets, Nikkei 225 index ended in positive territory, while Hong Kong’s Hang Seng index settled lower. Markets in China and South Korea were closed due to a holiday. Markets in Europe were trading higher. US markets ended mostly lower on Thursday. Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth ₹5,027.36 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

On Thursday, the Sensex tanked 1,247.71 points, or 1.67 per cent, to settle at 73,580.54. The Nifty dropped 383.70 points, or 1.64 per cent, to end at 23,063.10.

Gold ends 4-session fall, rises ₹200

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Gold snapped a four-session losing streak, with prices rising modestly by ₹200 to ₹1,52,600 per 10 grams in the national capital on Friday, as retreating crude oil rates and the US dollar offered investors some breathing space after a volatile week.

The yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity had closed at ₹1,52,400 per 10 grams in the preceding session.

Silver prices, however, remained unchanged at ₹237 lakh per kilogram, inclusive of all taxes, according to local traders. Gold prices recovered after four consecutive sessions of losses as investors resorted to bargain buying at

lower levels, traders said. However, the precious metal ended the week ₹4,000, or 2.5 per cent, lower, while silver lost ₹10,000, or 4 per cent.

“Gold prices saw a recovery on Friday as some key challenges for precious metals diminished, with crude oil rates and the US dollar retreating from recent highs,” said Saumil Gandhi, Senior Analyst - Commodities at HDFC

Securities. Despite the recovery, gold is still on track for a weekly decline due to a significant rise in the dollar earlier in the week, Gandhi added.

The rebound was equally visible in overseas markets, where spot gold gained \$27.73, or nearly 1 per cent, to USD 4,301.40 per ounce, while silver rose 1.4 per cent to \$64.72 an ounce.

“Spot gold edged higher on Friday, moving back above \$4,300 an ounce, while silver climbed to near \$65, recovering from two sessions of declines. A softer US dollar and stabilisation in bond markets after a sharp rise in yields supported the rebound,” Kaynart Chainwala, AVP, Commodity Research, Kotak Securities, said.

SEBI bars Omaxe, five others over public shareholding norms

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Market regulator SEBI has barred realty firm Omaxe and five others from accessing the securities market for up to one year and imposed a fine totalling ₹1.92 crore for allegedly creating an artificial public shareholding structure to meet minimum public shareholding requirements.

Omaxe has been restrained from accessing the securities market for three months, while promoters – Rohtas Goel, Jai Bhagwan Goel – group companies – Dream Home Developers Pvt Ltd and Guild Builders Pvt Ltd – have been barred for one year.

Sunil Goel, former Joint Managing Director of Omaxe, has also been prohibited from the securities market for one year, the order noted.

In its order passed on Thursday, SEBI said Omaxe failed to achieve the prescribed 25 per cent minimum public shareholding (MPS) through independent public shareholders, as certain entities had acquired the company’s shares using funds originating from Omaxe and its group entities.

SEBI noted that “minimum public shareholding requirements were artificially met through funding of certain entities to acquire shares of the company and such enti-

ties were thereafter disclosed as public shareholders”.

The regulator said that funds originating from Omaxe and group entities were routed through multiple entities and used to acquire its shares in the names of entities shown as public shareholders.

Omaxe and its group entities routed ₹46.50 crore through DVM Realtors Pvt Ltd (DRPL), Garv Buildtech Pvt Ltd, and Jeet Builders Pvt Ltd (JBPL) to ultimately fund the acquisition of its own shares during the Offer For Sale (OFS) windows on June 3, 2013, and October 29, 2013, the regulator noted.

“These transactions cannot, therefore, be viewed as isolated fund transfers or independent share acquisitions. “The scheme and artifice lay in creating the appearance of independent public shareholding through entities whose acquisition of Omaxe shares had been financed through funds originating

from Omaxe/group entities and thereafter using such holdings for representing regulatory compliance,” SEBI said in its 91-page order.

The regulator said the arrangement created the appearance of independent public shareholding, while the underlying fund trail showed otherwise.

After the June 3, 2013, offer for sale (OFS), exclusion of the funded holdings would have reduced Omaxe’s public shareholding from 16.21 per cent to around 14.57 per cent, the order said.

Similarly, after the October 29, 2013, OFS, public shareholding would have been around 19.04 per cent instead of the reported 20.97 per cent. Even after a subsequent bonus issue, excluding the funded holdings and the consequential bonus entitlement would have reduced the reported public shareholding from 25.01 per cent to around 22.71 per cent, SEBI said.

Centre to borrow ₹7.86 lakh crore in October-March

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Union Government will raise ₹7.86 lakh crore from securities in the second half of this fiscal year, reducing the total borrowing for the current financial year by a whopping ₹1,20,494 crore despite global headwinds.

The reduction in total borrowing indicates the government’s commitment to fiscal prudence.

A senior finance ministry official said the reduction is mainly due to switching G-secs maturing in 2026-27 of

₹1,14,286 crore, a conscious debt-management strategy of the Government of India.

“During 2026-27, the Government of India is expected to have market borrowing of ₹15,99,506 crore through dated securities, as compared to Budget

Estimates of ₹17,20,000 crore for the ongoing financial year,” the Finance Ministry said in a statement.

“The Government of India, in consultation with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), has decided to borrow Rs 7,86,000 crore in the second

half (H2) of FY 2026-27. This includes Sovereign Green Bonds (SGRBs) issuance of ₹15,000 crore,” it said.

During the first half ending this month, the government would mobilise ₹8,13,506 crore from bonds, slightly lower than the target of ₹8.2 lakh crore, to fund the revenue gap. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman in the Budget presented on February 1 had proposed to borrow ₹17.2 lakh crore to fund its fiscal deficit projected at 4.3 per cent of the GDP. In absolute terms, the fiscal deficit is pegged at

₹16.9 lakh crore for 2026-27.

“To finance the fiscal deficit, the net market borrowings from dated securities are estimated at Rs 11.7 lakh crore. The balance financing is expected to come from small savings and other sources. The gross market borrowings are estimated at ₹17.2 lakh crore,” she had said while delivering the Budget 2026-27.

The statement further said that the gross market borrowing of ₹7,86,000 crore in the second half of FY27 would be completed through 23 weekly auctions.

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Ref:-Demand notice u/s 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of the financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.											
Sr. No	NAME OF THE BORROWER & CO-BORROWER/LOAN FILE NO./BRANCH NAME	ADDRESS OF THE MORTGAGED PROPERTY	NPA Classification Date	DATE OF ISSUE DEMAND NOTICE	OUTSTANDING DUES (As per Demand Notice) (AMOUNT IN Rs.)	Sr. No	NAME OF THE BORROWER & CO-BORROWER/LOAN FILE NO./BRANCH NAME	ADDRESS OF THE MORTGAGED PROPERTY	NPA Classification Date	DATE OF ISSUE DEMAND NOTICE	OUTSTANDING DUES (As per Demand Notice) (AMOUNT IN Rs.)
1.	UP071060000168/ ASHISH A/ GREATER NOIDA BRANCH	UPPER GROUND FLOOR MIG FLAT NO.101, BUILD UP ON PLOT NO.48-49, SITUATED IN UNIONE RESIDENCY ,KHASRA NO.96, VILLAGE- AKBARPUR BEHAMPUR, TALUKA, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH 201001	11-08-2026	17-08-2026	Rs. 4,68,917	82	UP0610600001045/ Mrs. NIDHI SHARMA / MEERUT BRANCH	UPPERGROUND FLOOR FLAT NO. A-102ADITYA APARTMENT PLOT NO. 102 & 103 IN WARD NO. 6 KHASRA NO. 60 UNI-ONE RESIDENCY PHASE-II VILLAGE AKBARPUR BAHERAMPUR, PARGANA LONI TEHSIL & DISTT. GHAZIABAD	14-08-2026	25-08-2026	Rs. 14,11,244
2	DL075060000635/ SWATI HURA/ PITAMPURA BRANCH	ENTIRE THIRD FLOOR, WITH ROOF RIGHTS, PLOT NO. B-148, SAINIK NAGAR, UTTAM NAGAR, VILLAGE- MATIALA, NEW DELHI 110059	14-08-2026	02-09-2026	Rs. 12,55,008	83	UP0710600001120/ / Mr. NIHAL SINGH / MEERUT BRANCH.	Third Floor Flat No. T1-01(With Roof Rights) Plot No. D-3 & D-4 Colony Sai Upvan, Khasra No. 157b Village Yusufpurhaskhaberi Pargana & Tehsil Dadri Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar Pin Code-201002	16-07-2026	17-08-2026	Rs. 5,96,277
3	DL075060000652/ABHAY KISHORE PRASAD/ BHAWANA SINHA/ PITAMPURA BRANCH	BACK LEFT SIDE FLAT, FIRST FLOOR, WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, PLOT NO. C-102-B, KHASRA NO. 102-21 & 102-22, BLOCK-C, VISHWAS PARK, UTTAM NAGAR, VILLAGE-PALAM, NEW DELHI 110059	14-08-2026	02-09-2026	Rs. 6,71,04	84	UP0710600001537 / / Mr. VIKAS / MEERUT BRANCH.	Khasra No. 2564-Min, Ward No. 45, Village Karhaiya, Pargana Loni, Tehsil and District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh. Pin CODE - 201007	06-07-2026	11-08-2026	Rs. 9,34,584
4	UP0210610003889/ ANUP S / NOIDA BRANCH	KHASRA NO. 261,G R GARDEN,HOUSE FLOOR NO-GROUND, PLOT NO.72-73,, LAND MARK: HARSH VIHAR,VILLAGE: CHIPYANA BUZURG, LOCATION: NOIDA, UTTARPRADESH.PINCODE: 201301.	11-07-2026	02-09-2026	Rs. 27,26,280	85	UP0610600001831 / / Mr. BRAJESH KUMAR PATHAK / MEERUT BRANCH	Plot No. 49, Mansarower Park-II, Khasra No. 3072min Village Sheshpur, Bamheta, Pargana & Tehsil Dadri Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar Pin code -201002.	13-07-2026	11-08-2026	Rs. 17,35,753
5	UP0210610002941/ PREETY KUMAR/ NOIDA BRANCH	KHASRA NO. 842,PLOT NO.29 YADU APARTMENT,FLAT NO-SF-1,FLOOR NO. SECOND,PLOT NO. PA-AVANTIKA-II, VISHNU ENCLAVE, HARSAN, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH, PIN CODE: 201001	25-07-2026	02-09-2026	Rs. 8,07,000	86	UP0610600002052 / / Mr. VINET KUMAR / MEERUT BRANCH	Plot No. D-72A, Royal City, Khasra No. 450 Village Acheja, Pargana & Tehsil Dadri Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar Pin Code- 245101	13-07-2026	11-08-2026	Rs. 9,21,254
6	UP0210610003853/ AJIT ALAKH/ NOIDA BRANCH	KHNO-66 SUSTAIN WHITE,FLAT NO.23,FLOOR NO.1, SECOND, BLOCK-NEAR CANARA BANK, SADARPUR, DADRI,NOIDA, UTTAR PRADESH,201301.	11-08-2026	27-08-2026	Rs. 22,96,202	87	UP0610600002072 / / Mr. AMARDEEP LUVANA / MEERUT BRANCH	Plot No. 184 & 19A, Khasra No. 411A & 411B Village Sundpur alias Patiharpura, Pargana, Tehsil & Distt. Meerut Pin code - 250502	11-07-2026	27-08-2026	Rs. 8,06,683
7	UP0210610002411/ MANISH KUMAR/ NOIDA BRANCH	KHASRA NO 151B-152B SAJ UPVAN,FLAT NO. FLAT NO C1, FLOOR NO. GROUND,PLOT NO. A1 AND A2, YUSUPPUR, CHAKSHABERI, LAND MARK: GAUR AVENUE CITY 1,VILLAGE: CHAKSHABERI, GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH, PIN CODE: 201301	09-08-2026	25-08-2026	Rs. 6,68,339	88	DL0510110004227 / JAGDISH SINGH BISHT / GURGAON BRANCH	FLAT NO 403, 3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO-A-40, A BLOCK, KH NO 124, 1/25/1, MANSA RAM PARK NEAR METRO PILLAR NO 58, MATIALA, UTTAM NAGAR , DELHI - 110059	29-12-2025	19-01-2026	Rs. 389,113/-
8	UP0210610002581/ POONAM TIWARI/ NOIDA BRANCH	KHASRANO 1148, FLAT NO.2,FLOOR NO.UGF,PLOT NO. C-32,STREET NAME: HINDON VIHAR,SECTOR SECTOR 49,LAND MARK: MANDIR,VILLAGE: BAROLA GAUTAM BUDDHANAGAR UTTAR PRADESH 201301	14-08-2026	27-08-2026	Rs. 9,48,743	89	DL0510610003564/SACHI N KUMAR/GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA 6110, KHUSHI RAM PARK, WITH ROOF RIGHTS, Floor No: 2ND FLOOR,Plot No: RZ 28 Sector Ward No: A BLOCK, MATIALA, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, 110059	14-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 12,19,658
9	UP0510810001817 / GIRISH KUMAR FATNESHWAR JHA THROUGH HIS LEGAL HEIR	FLAT NO F-1 FIRST FLOOR, BUILD UP ON PLOT NO C-10, OUT OF KHASRA NO 156-B CANTON KNOWN AS SAI UPVAN SITUATED IN THE REVENUE STATE OF VILLAGE - YUSUPPUR CHAKSHABERI PARGANA & TEHSIL DADRI, DISTRICT GAUTAM BUDHA NAGAR , UTTAR PRADESH- 201009	29-07-2024	24-09-2026	Rs. 729,483/-	90	UP0510610003851/ MITHILESH PRABHAKAR PIGURGAON BRANCH	PLOT NO 931, ENT THIRD FLOOR, SEC 3F, VAISHALI, GHAZIABAD, 201010.	11-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 9,59,884
10	UP0210610003407/ BHARAT BHUSHAN JOSHI/ NOIDA BRANCH	Third Floor Flat No. I & J, "Royal Tower-II", Plot No. 65, 66, 67 & 68, Ward No. 6, Khasra No. 80 Situated at "Uni-One Residency Phase-II" Village Akbarpur Baherpur, Pargana Loni Tehsil & Distt. Ghaziabad , UTTAR PRADESH, PIN CODE: 201001	03-07-2026	31-08-2026	Rs. 17,84,654	91	DL0510610004988/BHAR AT BHUSHAN / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO-39/6, BACK SIDE WITH ROOF RIGHT, Property bearing No: 51A, Floor No: 3RD, VIKAS NAGAR EXTN., part -II, Street No: 04, HASTAL, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, 110059	14-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 9,05,373
11	UP0620600001413/ MAYA DUBEY/ GHAZIABAD BRANCH	FLAT NO. SF-3, SECOND FLOOR, PLOT NO. P-14 & 15, PLOT NO. P-14 & 15, KHASRANO. 1473, BLOCK P, BALAJI ENCLAVE, RAISPUR, GHAZIABAD.	16-07-2026	27-08-2026	Rs. 10,82,736	92	DL0510610004232/ ANUJ KUMAR GOEL/ GURGAON BRANCH	12/15, Left Side, Floor No: 1st, Plot No: 8A, SHIV VIHAR, Matiala, Delhi, 110059	11-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 12,90,785
12	UP0620600001004/ MAHESH KUMAR/ GHAZIABAD BRANCH	FLAT NO. SF 2, SECOND FLOOR, PLOT NO.-5, OUT OF KHASRA NO. 1359, IS THE RESIDENTIAL COLONY "AKSHAY ENCLAVE", IN THE VILLAGE RAYEESPUR, PARGANA DASSA, TEHSIL & DISTRICT GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201002	11-07-2026	27-08-2026	Rs. 14,08,322	93	DL0510610005537/ PURSHOTTAM P/ ANAND SINGH / GUAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO-59/25, BACK RIGHT SIDE WITH ROOF RIGHTS, PLOT-76/76A, Floor No: THIRD , MOHAN GARDEN, HASTSAL, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, 110059	14-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 17,62,684
13	UP0620600001835/ AJAY KUMAR/ LAKHMIRI DEVI/ GHAZIABAD BRANCH	PLOT NO. 216 & 217, KHASRA NO. 233-K, VILLAGE - CHITHAIRA PARGANA & TEHSIL- DADRI, DISTT. GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR PIN CODE-201314	09-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 6,30,875	94	DL0510610004796/ KUSUM / GURGAON BRANCH	POCKET -10, ENTIRE SECOND FLOOR, WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, Plot No: 127, SEC-21, ROHINI, ROHINI, DELHI 110086.	14-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 12,13,386
14	UP0620600000964/ SHAMEEM SAFI/ GHAZIABAD BRANCH	FLAT NO. D-4, THIRD FLOOR, KHASRA NO. 639, GSG APARTMENT, VILLAGE SALARPUR KHADER, GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH PIN CODE-201304	23-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 8,92,046	95	DL0510610003911 / GAURAV KUMAR/ SANDEEP KUMAR/ DHARAJI/ GURGAON	KHASRA NO 29/16, Plot No: 01, VIKAS NAGAR EXTN GALI PART III, Hastal, UTTAM NAGAR, Delhi, Pin Code: 110059	14-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 16,76,340
15	UP0620600002302/ BALRAJ / POONAM /GHAZIABAD BRANCH	HOUSE ON H NO. 90 ADMEASURING AREA 50 SQ. YD. FALLING UNDER KHASRA NO. 99 SITUATED AT "SAI DHAM RAJ CITY" IN VILLAGE ILAICHIPUR PARGANA LONI TEHSIL & DISTT. GHAZIABAD (U.P.) 201102	06-07-2026	24-08-2026	Rs. 10,16,395	96	DL0510610006115 / KAILASH KUMAR SHARMA/ MANJU SHARMA / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO 38/7, FLAT 003, UPPER GROUND FLOOR, Plot No: 22, VIKAS NAGAR, BLOCK B, Sector Ward No: 124, HASTSAL, Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059	12-07-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 12,69,901
16	UP0620600002621/ PRADEEP KUMAR/ ANJINI DEVI/ GHAZIABAD BRANCH	H NO-10, Area Measuring 52 Sq Yds, Part of katal No 783, Khasra No-982, Situated at village- Chapraula Dadri Gautam Budh Nagar UP- 203207	13-07-2026	27-08-2026	Rs. 11,19,698	97	DL0510610003272 / DILSHAD AHAMAD / VINITA / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO 2/21 1/25/2, ENTIRE 3RD FLOOR, With roof rights H NO-24-B Floor No: 2nd, MANSARAM PARK, BLK A, MATIALA, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, 110059	14-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 12,36,340
17	UP0620600000119/ SANTOSH KUMAR THAKUR / RADHA THAKUR, / GHAZIABAD BRANCH	FLAT NO. S-2, R.H.S. PLOT NO. 3/994 ON SECOND FLOOR WITH ROOF RIGHT SITUATED AT SECTOR-3 VASUNDHARA DISTT. GHAZIABAD (U.P.)	11-07-2026	31-08-2026	Rs. 30,70,821	98	DL0510610004721/ ATUL A / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO 67/22, ENTIRE FIRST FLOOR, WZ-4, Floor No: 1ST, PROP NO 4, OM VIHAR PHASE-3 Street No: 14, WARD-127, HASTSAL, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, 110059	19-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 18,05,321
18	UP06206000003323/ VINAY GUPTA, PALLAVI/ GHAZIABAD BRANCH	HOUSE NO-20, KHASRA NO. 256, ASHIYANA GARDEN, VILLAGE CHIPYANA BUJURG, PARGANA DASSA & TEHSIL - DADRI, DISTT. - GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR, PIN CODE-201000	11-08-2026	02-09-2026	Rs. 49,68,046	99	DL0510610003543 / SUMAN / SURESH CHANDER / GURGAON BRANCH	PLOT 91, GROUND FLOOR, SECTOR 22, BUDH VIHAR ROAD, Rohini, Delhi, 110085	14-08-2026		

Iran suggests deal to reopen Hormuz in 7 days

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Dubai

Iran has offered to reopen the Strait of Hormuz and resume talks on its nuclear programme in seven days if the United States lifts its naval blockade, waives sanctions on Iranian oil sales and observes a ceasefire that would include Lebanon.

Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi detailed the proposal in a private gathering on Thursday on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly in New York, according to one attendee.

Trita Parsi, executive vice president of the Quincy Institute think tank, who attended, said Araghchi suggested that a speedy agreement would help US

President Donald Trump ahead of November's midterm elections.

There was no immediate comment from Iran's UN mission or other Iranian officials. The proposal strongly resembles the so-called Memorandum of Understanding reached in June, but with an accelerated timetable. The agreement, which had called for a 60-day interim period, quickly collapsed as Iran resumed attacks on shipping in the strait.

Trump has said he is in no rush to reach a deal, even as high oil prices fuel inflation and exacerbate cost of living concerns. On the Iranian side, there are questions as to whether the hard-liners who dominate the security forces



A woman chants slogan as she holds an Iranian flag while motorcyclists ride during a State-organised motorcycle parade called Janfada meaning Sacrifice for Iran in Tehran, Iran

will accept compromises championed by relative moderates, like President Masoud Pezeshkian.

"If Trump calculates this arrangement is worthwhile and can bring political benefit before the midterms and reduce gas prices, perhaps we'll see flexibility not seen in previous weeks," Parsi said. But he noted "deep suspicion," especially around the prospect of Iran merely buying time to get out more of its oil and ease its economic pain. In the latest sign of diplomatic movement, Pezeshkian hosted the prime minister of Qatar early Friday. Qatar has served as a key mediator, including during hours of indirect Iranian-US talks at

the UN this week. It was not clear how long Pezeshkian and Araghchi would stay in the US after Pezeshkian addressed the annual UN gathering of world leaders.

US Secretary said that "if there's an opportunity to exchange ideas and messages, we will."

Pakistan has vowed to deepen bilateral cooperation with Dhaka and Tehran, as Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif met his Bangladesh counterpart Tarique Rahman and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly. Sharif posted on X, on Friday, saying he had a "warm and most cordial" exchange with Rahman.

FRESH RAINS POSE NEW CHALLENGE TO NEPAL FLOOD RECOVERY



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Kathmandu

Heavy rainfall across large parts of Nepal has posed a fresh challenge to recovery efforts in areas devastated by the August 26 Bhotekoshi floods, with authorities warning of renewed risks of landslides, floods and debris flows.

Nepal's Department of Hydrology and Meteorology has forecast heavy to very heavy rainfall in several parts of the country from Friday through Sunday, with extremely heavy rain possible in parts of Gandaki and Lumbini provinces.

Flash floods originating near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26 devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal. The Bhotekoshi River, which flows south from the Himalayan border region, carried the floodwaters downstream, sweeping away homes, vehicles, roads and bridges and damaging hydropower projects. The catastrophe killed more than 1,450 people, while around 5,600 still remain missing. The current rainfall is not a recurrence of the August 26 floods, but authorities and weather experts have warned of a new set of hazards, including landslides, flooding, debris flows and further disruption to roads and other infrastructure.

The risk is particularly significant in areas where roads, riverbanks and other infrastructure have already been damaged by the August disaster.

Bangladesh PM Rahman calls for UN action and support for Rohingya crisis

YOSHITA SINGH ■ United Nations

Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman has highlighted at the UN General Assembly his country's sheltering of over 1.2 million forcibly displaced Rohingya from Myanmar for more than nine years, and urged the international community to sustain humanitarian assistance and work towards their safe return.

"This has placed immense pressure on our resources, environment, security and local communities," Rahman said in his address to the 81st session of the UN General Assembly on Thursday. "As a densely pop-



ulated country, Bangladesh believes that the source and origin of the Rohingya crisis lie in Myanmar. (PTI)

Balen Shah puts India and China at centre of first UNGA address

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

Nepal Prime Minister Balendra Shah placed India and China at the centre of his first address to the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA), proposing a trilateral mechanism to strengthen climate resilience across the Himalayan region.

Addressing the 81st UN General Assembly, Shah called for the creation of a Himalayan Climate Resilience Mechanism by Nepal, India and China. He proposed cooperation on satellite data sharing, early-warning systems, monitoring of dangerous glacial lakes and disaster preparedness. "The Hindu Kush Himalaya is home to nearly two billion people," Shah said, highlighting the region's importance to water, agriculture, ecosystems and livelihoods.

Shah's proposal came after devastating floods and related disasters in the Himalayan region. He stressed that the impact of such disasters does not stop at national borders. "Climate change does not recognise borders. Glaciers and floods do not travel with stamps and passports," Shah said.

The Nepali prime minister said the recent disaster had affected areas on both sides of the Nepal-China border before floodwaters moved downstream towards India. He argued that the scale and cross-border nature of such disas-



Nepal's Prime Minister Balendra Shah addresses the 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly at UN headquarters

ters made greater regional coordination necessary. Shah also thanked India and China for their assistance following the disaster. The emphasis on both neighbours is significant for Nepal, which has historically sought to maintain close relations with India while expanding its engagement with China. The country sits between the two Asian powers and has repeatedly attempted to preserve strategic room for cooperation with both.

India remains an important partner for Nepal in trade, connectivity, energy and cross-border movement, while China's

economic engagement with Nepal has expanded over the past decade.

Shah's UN address focused primarily on climate change, disaster resilience and Nepal's broader foreign-policy priorities rather than presenting the proposed mechanism as a formal geopolitical arrangement.

The initiative nevertheless places India and China together in a proposed framework at a time when Nepal faces increasing climate-related risks in the Himalayan region.

Shah said Nepal's own contribution to global greenhouse-gas emissions is extremely small compared.

The prime minister also urged greater international cooperation on disaster preparedness, arguing that early warnings, scientific information and emergency response systems need to operate across borders.

For Kathmandu, the proposed mechanism would provide a framework for cooperation with both of its powerful neighbours on an issue that directly affects all three countries.

Whether the Himalayan Climate Resilience Mechanism develops into a functioning regional initiative will depend on the response from India, China and other countries in the region. Shah's first UNGA address has, however, placed trilateral climate cooperation firmly among Nepal's international priorities.

Xi wraps US visit, sees brighter prospects for US-China

SAGAR KULKARNI ■ Washington

China's President Xi Jinping on Friday wrapped up his three-day visit to the US, asserting that his talks with President Donald Trump had added "new substance" to the China-US relationship and hoped for "more brighter prospects".

Trump and Xi continued their discussions over tea at the White House on Friday morning, where the US leader said China and the US had achieved "tremendous strides" during the visit that would make American farmers "very happy".

Xi said he looked forward to meeting Trump on two more occasions this year — at the APEC Summit in China and the G20 Summit in the US. "I do welcome Mr President and the First Lady to visit China," Xi said in the meeting in the Red Room in the White House.

The US First Lady Melania Trump and China's first lady Peng Liyuan shared a sofa underneath a Hudson River School painting, with Xi and Trump sitting in their own chairs. Tea and small plates of treats were on the coffee table between them.

"The president and I are like two people charting the course for the great ship of China-US relations. When



President Donald Trump arrives with China's President Xi Jinping and first lady Melania Trump and Peng Liyuan during a State Dinner for China's President Xi Jinping in the East Room of the White House

the president visited China in May, we agreed on the vision of building a constructive China-US relationship of strategic stability," Xi said.

"This time, we've agreed to add a new substance to it. The relationship will be a constructive one of strategic stability on the basis of respect, fairness, and reciprocity," the Chinese leader said in brief remarks to the media. "So, from this one can see that the prospects for this relationship will get more brighter," Xi said.

Trump and Xi visited the National Archives, where the Declaration of Independence, the Constitution and the Bill of

agreement with the Chinese on a number of these things," Greer said on CNBC's "Squawk Box," referring to goods including US agricultural products and medical devices and Chinese consumer goods considered non-sensitive.

Greer said the Trump administration plans to release "a lot more details" Monday. The US president, perhaps, had these developments in mind when he said American farmers will be "very happy" over Xi's visit.

"I think our farmers are going to be very happy. A lot of very positive things happened. But America's very happy about this visit, and I'm sure China is very happy also. Great things for both countries, and it's been just very, very productive," Trump said. Xi arrived here on Wednesday evening for a three-day visit that began with a rare planeside welcome by Trump. The two leaders met over two hours at the White House on Thursday and were together again at the state dinner hosted by Trump in Xi's honour. A Chinese readout on the meetings said that the economic and trade teams of the two sides reached a new joint arrangement, which is good news for both the industries and people of

the two countries and even the world economy.

"Cooperation is a two-way street. To keep the economic and trade ties stable, the list of cooperation needs to be lengthened, and the list of issues shortened," a Chinese foreign ministry statement said.

President Xi pointed out that both China and the US have strong AI capabilities.

"They may have competition, but they may cooperate even more. The right thing to do is to draw on each other's strengths, not guard against each other," the statement said. The Chinese leader said AI must be kept under human control and pitched for the continuation of dialogue on its risks and benefits and joint prevention of misuse and abuse.

"A people-centred approach should be upheld, and AI should be developed for the positive and for good, so that AI will serve the progress of humanity," the statement said.

The New York Times reported that the visit has so far been heavy on pageantry and produced little in terms of policy announcements. (PTI)

I, **Anita Devi W/o Mukesh Kumar R/o Vill- Jarwa, Distt Mahendragarh, Haryana**, hereby inform the general public regarding my property ID No. 7GVF3BE5, Adarsh Colony, Mahendragarh, Haryana-123029 that my Sale Deed No. 689 (dated 23/06/2010), the approval letter, and the map issued by the MC (Map No. 1(15), dated 07/05/2012) are in a laminated condition.

Sr. No	NAME OF THE BORROWER & CO-BORROWER/LOAN FILE NO./BRANCH NAME	ADDRESS OF THE MORTGAGED PROPERTY	NPA Classification Date	DATE OF ISSUE DEMAND NOTICE	OUTSTANDING DUES (As per Demand Notice) (AMOUNT IN Rs.)
129	UP0510610003283 / AMAR YADAV / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO-156A,LIG,FLAT No: TF-3,Third Floor,Plot No:E-4,SAI UPVAN, Village: YUSUFPUR CHAKSABERI, Location: Dadri, Taluka: DADRI, State: Uttar Pradesh Pin Code: 203207	14-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 7,58,693
130	UP0510610002651 / BAISHAKHI BANERJEE / SADHAN THAKAR / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRANO 154B, FLAT NO,UFG 3,Floor No: UGF Plot No: C-29 & 30, SAI UPVAN, Village: YUSUFPUR CHAKSAHBERI, Taluka: DADRI, State: Uttar Pradesh Pin Code: 201309	11-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 5,59,963
131	UP0510610003951 / TAPAN BARMAN / SHIREEN / GURGAON BRANCH	PLOT NO R38, ENTIRE THIRD FLOOR, VASUNDHARA, SEC 01, VASUNDHARA, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh,201001	14-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 19,78,895
132	UP0510610004907 / SUDHIR KUMAR MISHRA / KHUSHABU MISHRA / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRANO-774M, PALM VILLAGE,FLAT No: FF-7,Floor No: 1ST, BISRAKH JALALPUR, GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR, Uttar Pradesh, 203207	16-07-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 7,36,596
133	UP0510610004642 / SHAHLA KHAN / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO-135, OXY HOME,FLAT No: 501,Floor No: 3RD,Plot No: 48 49 50, VAYU SENA ENCLAVE, SEC 2A, SHAHBERI, Dadri, Uttar Pradesh, 203207	14-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 12,24,924
134	DL0510110001310 / MOOL CHAND AGGARWAL / GEETA AGGARWAL /GURGAON BRANCH	PROPERTY NO L-273, KHASRA NO 515, VILLAGE CHOWKRI MUBARAKBAD, SHASTRINAGAR, DELHI-110052	29-05-2026	09-09-2026	Rs. 2,47,256
135	UP0510610002543 / KUNDAN SINGH NEGI SINCE DECEASED REPRESENTED THROUGH HIS LEGAL HEIR VIJAYA NEGI /VIJAYA NEGI /GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO 35 DREAM HOMES, FLAT NO 404, FLOOR NO: FOURTH, PLOT NO 122, VRINDAVAN GARDEN, SHAHBERI DADRI, GAUTAMBUDHANAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH -201301	29-07-2026	09-09-2026	Rs. 3,42,885
136	UP0510610002810 / NIDHI PRIYA / GURGAON BRANCH	PLOT NO D-001, FLAT NO S-6, SECOND FLOOR, DLF DILSHAD EXTENSION -II, BLOCK-D, BRAHMAPUR BHOPURA, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH - 201001	30-06-2026	17-07-2026	Rs. 22,95,420
137	UP0510610004892 / AJIM HUSSAIN / SHABANA PARVEEN / GURGAON BRANCH	FLAT NO UG-03, UPPER GROUND FLOOR FRONT MIDDLE PORTION, APNAGHAR, PLOT NO 45, 46, 47, 48, 49 & 50 OUT OF KHASRA NO 162, WELCOME CITY, VILLAGE SHAHBERI, TEHSIL -DADRI, GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH-201318	31-03-2026	14-07-2026	Rs. 6,67,992
138	UP0510610005549 / JAGDISH SINGH / USHA DEVI / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO 1587, 1589, RADHA GARDEN ,UGF-3 UPPER GROUND FLOOR, PLOT NO 95 96, RAIPUR PARGANA DASNA, GOVINDPURAM, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH 201013	29-11-2025	14-07-2026	Rs. 9,37,682
139	DL0510610004925 / MANISH SOLANKI / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO-1227/358,1214/931/365 1201/366, PROPERTY No: 1/6172, ENTIRE FIRST FLOOR,Plot No: OLD NO-1305-C,EAST ROHTASH NAGAR, Street No: 03,SIKIDARPUR, SHAHDARA, Delhi, 110032	30-06-2026	17-07-2026	Rs. 17,67,186
140	UP0510610002078 / GAJENDRA SINGH / MANJU RAJ / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO 157A, SHREE SAI RESIDENCY, FLAT NO- UGF-01, UPPER GROUND FLOOR Plot No: 77 76, SHAHBERI, DADRI, GAUTAM BUDHANAGAR, Uttar Pradesh, 201301	15-07-2026	17-07-2026	Rs. 14,68,365
141	DL0511510009153 / LOVISH / SAKSHI KAKKAR / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRANO 25/1/1, WITH ROOF RIGHTS, Floor No: 3,Plot No: 57, Dabri extension, Dabri, Delhi, 110045	03-07-2026	17-07-2026	Rs. 12,33,354
142	UP0510610005075 / SHASHI KANT /AMRITA KUMARI / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO-S, LIC FLAT, FLAT NO UG-1 Floor No: UGF Plot No: 99, SAI GARDEN, SHAHBERI, Dadri, Gautam Budha Nagar Uttar Pradesh, 203207	10-07-2026	17-07-2026	Rs. 8,79,915
143	DL0510110008565 / MANISH BHATT / SONIA BHATT / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO 205/206, WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, PVT FLAT NO 004, UPPER GROUND FLOOR BACK,Plot No: 9-10-11-12/1, BHAGWATI GARDEN EXTEN, BLOCK B, NAWADA, UTTAM NAGAR, Delhi, 110059	11-07-2026	17-07-2026	Rs. 29,23,961
144	DL0110610004354 / SANTOSH KUMAR TIWARI / DELHI BRANCH	Third Floor (i.e. H No TF-02), with Roof Rights, land area measuring 62.5 Sq. Yds. i.e. 52.25 Sq. Mtrs., out of Property KNOWN AS Plot No.6, consisting of Two Bed Rooms with One Double Bed, One Drawing Room, One Complete Kitchen with cabinete, Two Toilet-Cum-Bathroom, including common Staircase, Passage and Shaft,(without electricity, water & sewer connection), out of House No.6 Area measuring 125 Sq. Yds.), Part of Khasra No.419/1 situated within Extended Abadi/Loldora of Village Burari, Colony known as Laxmi Vihar, Delhi-110084,	30-05-2026	17-06-2026	Rs. 6,81,169/-
145	UP0510610001434 / SHAMSHER SINGH / GURGAON BRANCH	Flat No-S-2, Second Floor, Block-M1, Bhagat Enclave, Monalisa Residency Khasra No-266, Village-Bishmoli, G.T Road, Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301	13-09-2026	21-09-2026	Rs. 536,056/-
146	DL0510610006723 / PUJA KUMARI / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO-10/22, MANSA RAM PARK, UGF BACK SIDE, U.G.F. BACK SIDE, Plot: C-19 NORTH SIDE, Street Name No: BLOCK-C, MATIALA/UTTAM NAGAR, DELHI-110059	08-09-2026	21-09-2026	Rs. 1,864,532/-
147	UP05106100007841 / RAM BARAN MAURYA / GURGAON BRANCH	Khasra No 1056 M Up, P R Enclave, Flat No. TF-01, Floor No: 3rd Floor,Plot No: 15, Mehrauli, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201002	11-07-2026	21-09-2026	Rs. 1,768,209/-
148	HR0510610007810 / VKAS KHAPRA / DIVYSH KHAPRA / GURGAON BRANCH	Khasra No 16-17, Flat No 300, 3rd Floor, Plot No: 199-B, Mianwali, Hidayatpur Chawani, Gurgaon, Haryana- 122001	08-09-2026	22-09-2026	Rs. 2,456,501/-
149	UP0510610003415 / SAURABH SHARMA / GURGAON BRANCH	Block D, Flat No UGF 2,Upper Ground Floor Plot No: D-001, Dilshad Extension II, Bhaimpur- Bhopura, Pargana Loni , Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh-201001	13-09-2026	21-09-2026	Rs. 1,043,292/-
150	HR0510110005496 / AJIT KUMAR / GURGAON BRANCH	B-151, TYPE CHANCELLER, 15TH FLOOR REGENCY PARK-1 APARTMENT , DLF CITY PHASE-4 , NEAR RICHMOND PARK, CHAKKARPUR VILLAGE GURGAON -122002	29-12-2025	19-01-2026	Rs. 2,896,449/-

1. In term of our sanction letter, you all have been sanctioned short term loan for construction/purchased of residential project on the above referred respective properties. The respective repayment wherein is secured by creating eligible mortgage in favour of us. The said respective loans have been sanctioned vide express covenant on your part to repay the said short term loan promptly as per the terms and conditions incorporated in the separate loan Agreement executed by you in favour of GIC Housing Finance Ltd. You have availed and utilised the said financial assistance, however, the repayment in the said short term loan's account have been irregular and your account is have been classified as non performing assets in accordance with the directions / guidelines relating to assets classification issued by National Housing Bank. We upleasn times called upon you all and informed you about said outstanding dues, however there is no reply and or compliance on your part. Thus you are commercially insolvents.

2. Therefore GIC Housing Finance hereby call upon you all under this service u/s 13(2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002, to discharge their liabilities to GIC HF Ltd. In full as stated in aforesaid column no 4, within sixty days from the date of publication of this notice together with further interest and penal interest at contractual rate on balance principal outstanding till payment and/or realisation, failing which we shall be free exercise all or any of the rights under section 13(4) of the said act, which please note.

3. You are also put on notice that in terms of sub-section 13 of the said Act, you safe not transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise the aforesaid secured assets without obtaining written consent from GIC HFL Ltd., failing which you will be liable for an offence punishable under section 29 of the said Act. please take further note hereof.

4. This notice is without prejudice to the right of GIC HFL to initiate such other actions or legal proceeding as it deems necessary under any other applicable provision of law. The undersigned is duly authorised officer of GIC HFL to issue this notice and exercise powers under sub section (2) of section 13 of aforesaid Act.

Place : Noida, Pitampura, Ghaziabad, Delhi, Meerut, Gurgaon
Dated : 26.09.2026

Yours Truly, For GIC Housing Finance Ltd.
sd/- Authorised Officer

NORTHERN RAILWAY							
E-TENDER NOTICE No. TSD-GZB-03-2026-27							
No. TSD-GZB-03-2026-27					Date 25.09.2026		
On behalf of the President of India, Chief Engineer/TSP, Northern Railway, Headquarters office, Baroda House, New Delhi-110001 invites the following tender through E-Procurement system:							
S. Tender N.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Cost of tender document	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Estimated Tender value (in Rs.)	Date & Time of opening of tender	Period of completion
1	TSD-GZB-03-2026-27	Random testing of Track Fittings at Northern Railway, Track Supply Depot, Ghaziabad	NIL	20,000/-	9,98,114.80/-	28.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.	12 months
2	TSD-GZB-03-2026-27	Hiring of machinery for loading of Rails, Fishplates & other material from various locations over Northern Railway including shifting of Rails and Fabricated Glued joint and other allied works to facilitate Fabrication of insulated Glued Joints at Glued Joint workshop, in Track Depot Ghaziabad for a period of Two years.	NIL	28,000/-	13,97,995.36	28.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.	24 months
3	CSP-KSF_07-2026-27	Sawing & supplying of soft wood scantling of Mango or Eucalyptus or other locally available soft wood (size 50 mm x 50 mm, minimum 01 meter long) for a period of Two years to Concrete sleeper plant, N. Rly., Khalispur-Varanasi	NIL	18,200/-	9,10,700/-	28.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.	24 months
Note:- The complete information of above E-Procurement tender is available on website "www.irops.gov.in"						3354/26	
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE							

**BABA FARID UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES, FARIDKOT**

ADMISSION NOTICE
3RD ROUND MBBS/BDS ONLINE COUNSELLING UNDER NEET UG-2026
Fresh online applications, along with the registration fee of 5,000 + 18% GST (5,900/-) and 2,500 + 18% GST (2,950/-) for SC candidates, are invited through the University website from **NEET UG-2026 qualified** candidates for admission against the vacant seats of MBBS/BDS courses. The online registration shall remain open on **28.09.2026**.
Note:
1. Candidates who have already registered during Round 1 or Round 2, are not required to register afresh.
2. Candidates who did not join or resigned from the seat allotted to them in Round 2 shall be required to register afresh for the 3rd Round and deposit the prescribed security amount again, as applicable.
3. For the detailed counselling schedule, vacant seat matrix and further updates, candidates are advised to regularly visit the University website: **www.bfuhs.ac.in**

sd/- Registrar

3108/12/2026-27/15572 Dated CHD :- 25/09/2026

‘India’s social support system marker of self-sufficiency’

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
■ New Delhi

Prominent journalist, auditor and author S Gurumurthy, Chairman of the Vivekananda International Foundation (VIF), argued that India's ancient dietary and social traditions hold answers to some of the world's most pressing challenges, speaking at a panel discussion on "Ancient Indian Wisdom as a Guide for Viksit Bharat" held at the India International Centre here on Friday.

The event was organised under "Bharat Ki Soch Mantrana," a flagship discussion series, in media partnership with The Pioneer.

Making his central argument, Gurumurthy said India's predominantly vegetarian food culture has allowed the country to sustain the world's largest human population on a comparatively small landmass.

"If all Indians shift to the American way of eating, we will need six times the land we have today. But if the whole world shifted to the Indian way of eating, we would need only 40 per cent

of the land currently being farmed," he said, citing data from Our World in Data to argue that vegetarian diets deliver far greater caloric efficiency than meat-based ones. At the same time, meat production generates significantly higher carbon emissions.

Gurumurthy credited India's ancient physicians and scholars, including the authors of texts such as the Charaka Samhita, with arriving at sophisticated nutritional and medical conclusions through systematic observation, centuries before the advent of modern laboratory science.

He said this knowledge was transmitted across generations not only through formal institutions, but through oral traditions, proverbs, and structured teacher-student relay systems such as the Gurukul, embedding scientific understanding directly into everyday cultural habits.

He also contrasted India's family-based social support systems with the Western welfare model, citing a National Bureau of Economic Research study warning



S Gurumurthy, Chairman, VIF, and prominent journalist, auditor and author, speaks at Bharat Ki Soch Mantrana, a flagship discussion series, on the topic Ancient Indian Wisdom as a Guide for Viksit Bharat, in media partnership with The Pioneer

of a mounting deficit in America's social security system by the 2030s.

Gurumurthy said Indian households, where extended families routinely live and care for one another without Government intervention, represent a form of social security that predates and, in his view, outperforms

state-run welfare systems, citing India's homeownership rate of around 85 per cent as one marker of this self-sufficiency.

Turning to more abstract territory, Gurumurthy invoked the Nasadiya Sukta from the Rig Veda and drew parallels between ancient descriptions of primordial

sound and creation and modern cosmological research into the acoustic signatures of the early universe, arguing that Vedic recitation traditions had preserved complex knowledge with mathematical precision across three millennia through rigorously structured oral transmission.

The panel also featured R K Pachnanda, Director of Bharat Ki Soch, and Anil Rajput, Secretary of the Cuisine India Society, who joined Gurumurthy to discuss how India's traditional knowledge systems could inform the country's path toward becoming a developed nation by 2047.

BRICS Theatre Festival to highlight diverse traditions



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Ministry of Culture, Government of India, will organise the BRICS Theatre Festival 2026 from October 12 to 14 in New Delhi under India's BRICS Presidency 2026. The three-day festival, themed "Shared Stories, Shared Futures", will bring together over 100 theatre practitioners, scholars, students and cultural representatives from nine BRICS Member and Partner Countries.

Briefing the media on the festival, Shri Vivek Aggarwal, Secretary, Ministry of Culture, highlighted its significance as an important cultural engagement under India's BRICS Presidency and its role in advancing people-to-people connections through theatre.

The festival builds on the Bhopal Declaration adopted at the BRICS Culture Ministers' Meeting in August 2026, which emphasised greater cultural cooperation, people-to-people exchanges and stronger networks among artists and cultural practitioners. India had also proposed a voluntary Artist Registry to facilitate such exchanges.

The significance of the festival has also been recognised in the BRICS Leaders' Declaration, which welcomed the Bhopal Declaration and noted initiatives aimed at strengthening cultural cooperation, cultur-

al exchanges and people-to-people ties.

The festival will feature participation from India, Thailand, Indonesia, Russia, Vietnam, Iran, South Africa, Kazakhstan and Ethiopia. India will showcase two theatre productions, while participating countries will present productions reflecting their diverse languages, theatrical traditions and contemporary creative expressions. Two theatre groups will represent Russia.

The festival will be inaugurated at the National School of Drama on October 12. Performances will be staged at prominent theatre venues in New Delhi, including the National School of Drama and its Abhimanch Auditorium and Sammukh Auditorium, as well as Kamani Auditorium, LTG Auditorium, and Meghdoot Theatre.

The festival will showcase classical, contemporary and experimental forms of theatre. Interactive workshops and discussions involving directors, artists, and production teams will provide opportunities to exchange ideas on artistic vision, performance traditions, acting methodologies, stagecraft, and technical design.

The National School of Drama, an autonomous institution under the Ministry of Culture, will serve as the nodal agency for organising the festival.

India, France review proposed EPR tech deployment in domestic market

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Senior officials of India and France on Friday reviewed the ongoing engagement on the proposed deployment of EPR technology in the domestic market, an official statement said.

The meeting was attended by officials from the Ministry of Power, the Ministry of External Affairs, Central Electricity Authority (CEA), NTPC Ltd, and NPCIL on the Indian side, and officials of EDF and the Embassy of France in India on the French side, the statement said.

Discussions centred on the deployment of EPR technology, India's regulatory reforms for the nuclear sector, cooperation on pumped hydro storage projects, and the way forward for a robust, mutually beneficial part-

nership, Ministry of Power said.

The two sides also discussed cooperation on pumped hydro storage projects, building on the proposed NTPC-EDF joint venture in this area.

Secretary (Power) briefed the French side on the progress made in finalising India's regulatory framework for the nuclear power sector, including the Draft SHANTI (Sustainable Harnessing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India) Rules and Regulations, placed by the Department of Atomic Energy in the public domain for stakeholder consultation.

The rules provide for a streamlined, time-bound licensing framework and enable participation of private and foreign partners in India's nuclear power programme.



Delhi identifies land for next-gen tech industries, minister Sirsa holds talks with industry leaders

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi's Industries Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa held a dialogue with leading industry and real estate stakeholders on Friday to attract next-generation tech industries to the capital, revealing that the Government has identified approximately 1,148 acres of greenfield industrial opportunities across Kanjhawala, Ranikhera and Baprola.

The interaction, titled "Attracting Next-Gen Tech Industries to Delhi," was attended by Dr S S Yadav, ACS (Industries), GNCTD, Saumya Saurabh, Special Commissioner, Industries, GNCTD, Nazuk Kumar, Managing Director, DSIDC, along with senior officials and representatives from NASSCOM and leading real estate stakeholders.

"The Delhi Government is open to ideas, partnerships and global best practices. We want industry to be a



partner in shaping Delhi's next-generation industrial ecosystem. Our approach will be based on consultation, transparency, ease of doing business and sustainable growth," Sirsa said.

Sirsa said Delhi must prepare for industries of the future by creating an ecosystem promoting clean, non-polluting, technology-intensive and knowledge-based industries, aiming to leverage the city's inherent strengths, including a highly skilled talent pool, proximity to the international airport, extensive Metro connectivity and a

strong services ecosystem, to attract next-generation technology industries and quality employment.

He said the New Industrial Policy 2026-2036, currently under preparation, will provide a renewed framework for industrial growth, drawing on best practices from other states and industrial destinations while leveraging Delhi's unique strengths. The policy will focus on attracting industries with high economic value but low environmental footprint, promoting investment, innovation, employ-

ment generation and ease of doing business.

Of the identified 1,148 acres, around 920 acres are located at Kanjhawala Industrial Area, around 147 acres at Ranikhera Industrial Area and around 81 acres at Baprola Industrial Area. Ranikhera Industrial Area is strategically located along UER-II, providing connectivity to major parts of the capital and surrounding region.

The Government is also exploring redevelopment of the 8-acre Jhandewalan Flatted Factory Complex into modern industrial and commercial spaces for emerging businesses.

"Our objective is not simply to bring more industries to Delhi. Our objective is to bring the right industries, industries that are clean, technology-driven, innovation-oriented and capable of creating high-quality employment. Delhi should become a destination for the industries of tomorrow," Sirsa said.

Central Warehousing Corporation posts 30.23% jump in net profit in FY26 on highest-ever turnover

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

State-run Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC) has posted a 30.23 per cent rise in its net profit to ₹694.94 crore for the 2025-26 fiscal, aided by the highest-ever turnover, Managing Director Santosh Sinha said on Friday.

The net profit rose from ₹533.67 crore in the previous fiscal. CWC, a public sector enterprise under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution, declared a total dividend of ₹208.48 crore for the 2025-26 fiscal, an official statement said.



"CWC reported its best-ever financial performance in FY 2025-26, achieving its highest-ever turnover of ₹3,636.24 crore," Sinha said at CWC's 64th annual general meeting held here. Total turnover rose 31 per cent to ₹3,636.24 crore in the 2025-26 fiscal from ₹2776.88 crore in

the preceding financial year.

Sinha said the company's forward-looking strategies and landmark initiatives have strengthened CWC's operational capabilities and contributed to robust and record-breaking financial results. CWC Chairman Rabindra Kumar Agarwal Sinha com-

mended the Corporation for achieving unprecedented milestones and highlighted the key initiatives undertaken during the past year that contributed to a strong performance in 2025-26.

Established under the Warehousing Corporations Act, 1962, CWC's objective is to provide cost-effective, integrated warehousing and logistics services.

It has a network of 986 warehouses with a total storage capacity of 936 lakh square feet, operating 19 container freight stations and inland container depots, 18 bonded warehouses and 25 rail side warehouses.

ED raids firms accused of purchasing stolen gold

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bengaluru

The Enforcement Directorate conducted multi-state searches and seized ₹7.52 lakh in cash in a money laundering probe against a Bengaluru-based jewellery firm that it alleged was "habitually involved" in purchasing stolen gold.

"ED, Bengaluru conducted searches across 16 premises in Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad & Visakhapatnam under PMLA, 2002 targeting M/s Attica Gold Pvt Ltd, its directors & associates like P.S. Ayub over allegations of habitually purchasing stolen gold and amassing PoC, resulting in the seizure of ₹7.52 lakh in cash, foreign currency, gold & silver articles," said ED in a



statement on Friday.

The two day searches were carried out based on allegations that the company was habitually involved in purchase and acquisition of stolen gold articles.

It, its shareholders and directors, were thereby amassing proceeds of crime through closely associated persons, their family members and associates, the agency said.

The ED case under the Prevention of Money

Laundering Act (PMLA) stems from multiple police FIRs. The agency stated this information was "further bolstered by various verifiable information gathered by the Directorate regarding money laundering activities/processes conducted by the accused."

The agency said it searched the premises of the directors, ex-directors, shareholders, head office and branches of the company and some others.

PC Jeweller clears dues of all 14 consortium banks; now debt free

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

PC Jeweller Ltd on Friday said it has become debt free having cleared dues of all 14 consortium banks. The company had a total debt of around ₹3,000 crore. In September 2024, PC Jeweller had opted for OTS (one-time settlement) for its outstanding dues with a consortium of banks.

The terms and conditions of approved OTS included cash and equity components payable under the settlement, release of securities and mortgaged properties etc. In a regulatory filing, PC Jeweller informed that the company has "successfully discharged the remaining outstanding debt of the banks and has achieved its financial objective of a debt-free status".



With the latest repayment on Friday, the company said it has discharged the outstanding debt of all the 14 consortium banks under the terms of Settlement Agreement dated September 30, 2024.

It has made repayments ahead of scheduled due dates. "The accomplishment of a debt-free status will materially strengthen the company's balance sheet and financial position," PC Jeweller said.

In August, the company

reported a 37 per cent increase in its consolidated net profit to ₹221.88 crore for the quarter ended June on better revenue.

Its net profit was at ₹161.93 crore in the year-ago period. Total income rose to ₹879.27 crore in the first quarter of this fiscal from ₹807.88 crore in the corresponding period of the preceding year. PC Jeweller is one of the leading jewellery firms in the country. It has around 50 physical stores across 12 states.

Govt appoint Dinesh Pant, Girija Subramanian as members of IRDAI



IRDAI member Dinesh Pant



IRDAI member Girija Subramanian

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Government has appointed LIC Managing Director Dinesh Pant and former Chairman-cum-Managing Director (CMD) of New India Assurance, Girija

Subramanian, as members of insurance regulator IRDAI. According to officials, they have been appointed to fill vacancies in the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI). Following the appoint-

ment, Pant has taken voluntary retirement on September 24, 2026.

Pant has been relieved from the services of the Life Insurance Corporation on account of his voluntary retirement and has ceased to be the Managing Director

with effect from September 24, 2026, after close of the day, LIC said in a regulatory filing on Friday.

Girija Subramanian retired as CMD of the biggest public sector general insurer, New India Assurance Company, in July this year.

BRIEFLY

Jurgen Klopp all smiles after Germany debut



Germany began a new era under Jurgen Klopp, Erling Haaland scored two goals for Norway, and Cristiano Ronaldo was still playing for Portugal in the Nations League.

Klopp was all smiles in Amsterdam despite Cody Gakpo's late equaliser for the Netherlands to draw 1-1 with Germany. Ruben van Bommel produced a brilliant cross that Gakpo met with a flying volley in the second minute of stoppage time. "Wow!" Klopp said of the goal. He wore the same Germany cap with the words "One of 83 million," referring to the country's population, that he wore for his squad announcement.

He said at the time he wanted to "reclaim the flag" that had been co-opted by the far right. (AP)



Golf: Americans take 3-2 lead in Presidents Cup



Best of friends in golf, winless as partners in team play, Scottie Scheffler and Sam Burns looked like that dubious drought might continue Thursday in the Presidents Cup.

Min Woo Lee and Sungjae Im had the advantage on four straight holes along the back nine and finally converted for a 1-up lead. And then the Americans took over at just the right time. Burns hit an 8-iron to 2 feet on the 14th. Scheffler closed out the International side with a superb bunker shot on the 18th to secure par for a 1-up victory. The lead fourballs match was the swing match as the Americans took a 3-2 lead. "We certainly haven't had the results that we've hoped for," Burns said. "I feel like at times in the past we've played pretty well and just gotten beat. So it probably just was a little bit of a sigh of relief to finally get a point and just kind of let that out." (AP)

Dilip Tirkey files police complaint against HI officials

SAUMOJYOTI S CHOUDHURY
■ New Delhi

The internal bickering within Hockey India has taken a dramatic turn with federation president and former India captain Dilip Tirkey lodging a complaint with Delhi Police against some HI officials, accusing them of "criminal breach of trust, theft, endangerment of life and wrongful abandonment". The complaint filed by Tirkey also seeks for immediate recovery of his assets and documents. The office of DCP, South Delhi confirmed the receipt of the complaint but also stated that no FIR has been lodged as yet.

Tirkey's complaint names Cdr RK Srivastava, the former Executive Director of HI who was removed by Tirkey following the saffron jersey fiasco during the recent FIH World Cup, HI Finance Manager Subodh Kumar, HI Director Bhushan Kumar and driver of the vehicle Harminder Singh. Repeated calls to Tirkey on the development went unanswered.

According to well-placed sources, Tirkey was on an official visit to the national capital on September 22 and as per protocol, HI provided him an official vehicle during his stay.

The source said the vehicle was abruptly recalled by the federation



without returning Tirkey's personal belongings, including a bag containing his essential medicines, which were lying inside.

The former India defender made repeated calls to HI officials for the vehicle to be sent back with his things. It is being alleged that HI officials did not respond to his calls.

Tirkey is currently locked in a turf war with HI secretary general Bhola Nath Singh over administrative decisions and meeting protocols.

Asian Games: Shot-putter Manpreet Kaur wins bronze

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Nagoya

India's Manpreet Kaur clinched the bronze medal in women's shot put competition of the Asian Games with an effort of 17.17m here on Friday.

The gold and silver in this event were claimed by China through Song Jiayuan (19.40m) and Zhang Linru (18.14m).

The 36-year-old Manpreet's last major international performance prior to the Games was a bronze at the 2023 Asian Championships.

Her personal best is 18.06m that came in 2022.

She had finished fifth at the 2023 Asian Games and was fourth at last month's Commonwealth Games in Glasgow with an effort of 17.49m.

Earlier this year, Manpreet won the National Inter-State Championships

with 17.75m, surpassing the Asian Games qualification standard of 16.25m.

Manpreet was a part of the Indian athletics contingent that was training in University of Tsukuba near Tokyo before the Asian Games.



The dispute escalated following a controversial jersey colour change for the Indian team just before the World Cup in the Netherlands and Belgium, which president Tirkey claims, was done without his consent.

An emergent Executive Board meeting was scheduled for September 18 to address these internal conflicts, discuss the restructuring of the Hockey India League (HIL), and finalise election dates but Tirkey said it did not have his sanction and was therefore illegal.

The meeting went ahead nonetheless and plans for the HIL, including formation of a separate joint venture company with franchise equity and a new Governing Council to oversee its administration, were discussed.

The meeting also deliberated on the show-cause notice issued by Tirkey to Srivastava and hosting of the upcoming Asian Champions Trophy in Mohali and Jalandhar.

When contacted, Bhola Nath denied being aware of the complaint filed by Tirkey as he is in Nagoya for the Asian Games.

"I am really not aware about such a thing. I am in Japan to inspire our sides so that they directly qualify for the LA Olympics by winning gold at the Asian Games," Bhola Nath told PTI from Nagoya. (PTI)

Last-minute switch yields gold for Kamaljeet, Suruchi



AJAI MASAND ■ Nagoya

A last-minute change to India's shooting line-up turned into a golden call as Kamaljeet, drafted just 48 hours before the deadline after Kedarling Uchaganve's slump in form, partnered Suruchi Inder Singh to win the 10m air pistol mixed team gold and end the country's six-day wait for a top-podium finish in shooting at the Asian Games here on Friday.

The unexpected pairing delivered a Games and Asian record 484.6 to comfortably beat South Korea, giving India its first gold at the shooting range after a string of disappointing performances had steadily increased the pres-

sure on the contingent.

The switch came just before the deadline for changes to the Indian line-up, with the National Rifle Association of India (NRAI) deciding that Kedarling's fading form was enough to break up his pairing with Suruchi and bring in Kamaljeet.

Kedarling, from the Army Marksmanship Unit, had earned his place in the 30-member Asian Games squad through the domestic trials and a strong showing at the National Championships. He was also part of the national squad for the year. But his form dipped after selection, forcing the selectors into a late rethink. (PTI)

Diya-Manush overcome personal loss to secure rare Asiad medal

BHARAT SHARMA ■ New Delhi

As a world number eight pair, Diya Chitale and Manush Shah did have a shot at a coveted Asian Games medal but their recent slump in form did not inspire a lot of confidence heading into the continental event. What added to that massive challenge was the untimely death of Diya's personal coach Peter Engel in Germany soon after she arrived in Nagoya for the Asian Games..

Engel, also a former India coach, took Diya under her wings in 2015 and took her game to the next level while coaching her in Germany.

Engel worked smoothly alongside Diya's coach in Mumbai, Sachin Shetty, engineering the rise of an attacking player with plain rubber on both sides, a rarity in a pimple dominated ecosystem in women's table tennis in India.

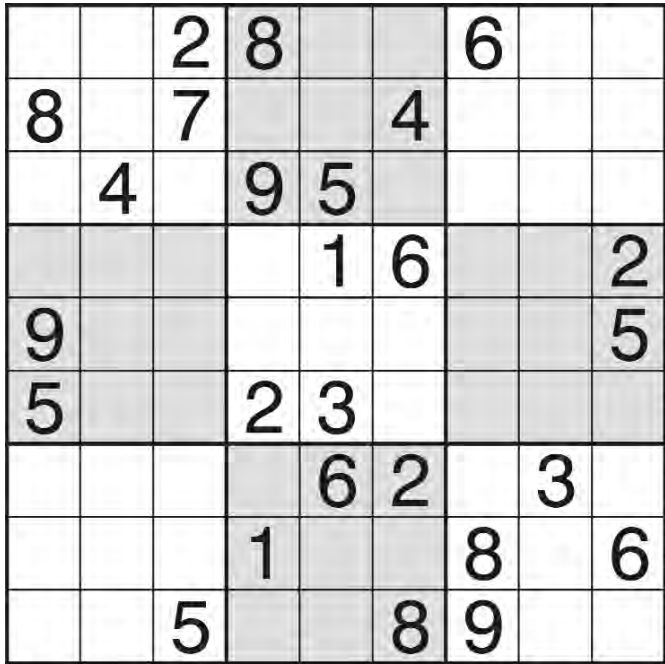


Diya's father Parag Chitale says a famous medal assured by the Indian mixed double duo is a fitting tribute to Engel, who was a very likable personality in the table tennis world. "We could not tell her about Peter's death, it happened 10 days ago. She only found out from the team after reaching Japan. She was very close to him. I am very proud that she and Manush got this medal assured, considering the loss of

Peter and their recent form," said Parag, a teacher by profession. While Manush and Diya bagged two WTT titles in the first half of year, their form dipped drastically June onwards.

With the presence of China, Japan and South Korea, winning an Asian Games medal is as tough as it gets but India's hopes too have risen with an odd medal to two in the last two editions. (PTI)

DAILY SUDOKU



DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9x9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3x3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.

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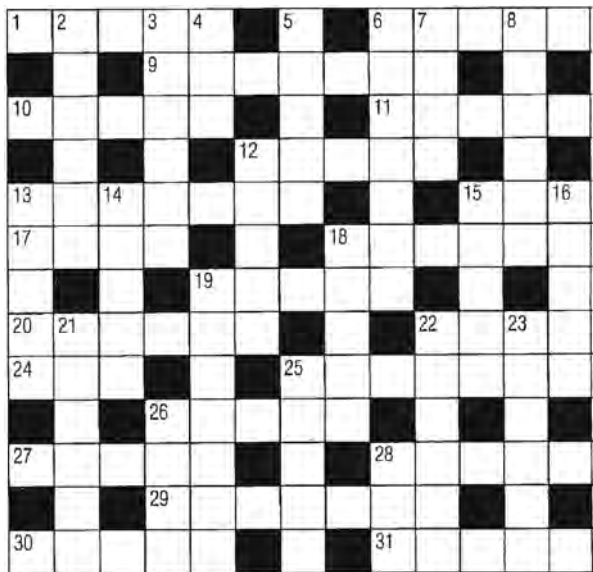


SOLUTION (25.9.26)

3	2	6	1	4	9	7	5	8
1	9	4	8	5	7	6	3	2
5	8	7	2	6	3	4	9	1
4	5	3	6	7	8	2	1	9
6	1	9	3	2	5	8	7	4
8	7	2	4	9	1	5	6	3
2	3	5	9	8	6	1	4	7
7	4	1	5	3	2	9	8	6
9	6	8	7	1	4	3	2	5

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DOUBLE CROSSWORD
SATURDAY | SEPTEMBER 26, 2026



ACROSS

- Large area with zero cane production (5)
- Timber of popular choice (5)
- Change into men, say (7)
- Shoot out of sight (5)
- The chap, who has it (5)
- Part of Manila rebuilt Italian style (5)
- Ascetic showing skill in bridge (7)
- One field of pleasure (3)
- Please accept this present (4)
- They enable ascent, thus getting one among the stars (6)
- Walter, the dreamer with a handy look? (5)

DOWN

- Is able to copy something tasteful (6)
- Of current significance, it's usually abbreviated (6)
- Born and raised in the English tradition (3)
- It can spoil satin (5)
- Allegiance, not exactly to royalty (7)
- Shortly admits ignorance of authorship (4)
- Not a destroyer, though it may do damage! (6)
- Wonderful, cool-headed wise men (5)
- Removal workers? (5)
- As committed in the heat of the

- Arrange for a novice, I see, to play (6)
- A parent you can take a rise out of? (4)
- The tawny parts are this colour (3)
- Seen to yearn to be with Edward (7)
- Made to go like the wind! (5)
- Marie's line in medical treatment (5)
- To a blockhead, a shower is a kind of storm! (5)
- Transport by royal coach! (7)
- Though new as can be, weakens (5)
- Fading, needs dyeing, we hear (5)

moment? (5)

- The solicitor's part is legal, of course (5)
- Appealed in the manner of a portion of kedgerie (5)
- It covers your beer (5)
- Fellows fighting to produce flour? (7)
- Tease the Americans in Sicily (6)
- Due to drink, make a blunder to be bashful about (6)
- An area wrong to ignore (6)
- A country lover (5)
- It can hurt a bit, the rope's end! (4)
- The place for warm socks (3)

SOLUTION (25.9.26)

- ACROSS

9, Ill-gotten
10, Blow over
12, High (n)
13, Layout
14, Inertia
15, Running in
17, Assailant
18, Off-i/c-er
20, Rattle
21, Spar

24, Part-i-SA-n
26, Lea-the-ry
28, Ideal(i)
29, Thirty
31, For-ward
34, Monstrous
36, By oneself
38, Cut-lass
39, Roasts
40, Stir
41, Con-tinu-e
42, Solitaire

DOWN

1, Hit-erto
2, F-lagon
3, Stranger
4, Unborn
5, Abstract
6, Tonic soifa
7, Cot-er-l-e
8, Berth-a
11, Captu-re
16, Incite
19, Flame
20, Run

22, Pa-R-ma
23, Charge
25, School song
26, Lay
27, Tit-mice
30, Reserved
31, Frostily
32, De-form-ed
33, Stra-t-ts
35, Not-i-on
36, Brass-Y
37, Enta-IL

India suffer double setback in fencing

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Nagoya

India suffered a double setback in the fencing events at the Asian Games on Friday, with both the men's foil and women's epee teams knocked out in the round of 16.

The men's foil team suffered a 27-45 defeat to Hong Kong, while the women's epee side went down 29-45 to Uzbekistan.

The Indian trio of Aditya, Hemash Singh Sanasam and Sachin fell behind early and could not close the gap as Hong Kong opened up an 18-point gap by the end of the seventh relay to seal it in their favour at the Aichi Sky Expo Hall F.

However, the Indian women's team of Taniksha Khatri, Yashkeerat Kaur Hayer and Mitva Jesangbhai Chaudhari stayed within striking distance at 14-17 after relay

four but they struggled to keep pace as Uzbekistan pulled away from the fifth relay to seal the win.

In the men's event, the score after the first relay was 2-5, with Sachin scoring two touches against Choi Chun Yin Ryan's five.

Sanasam added three touches in the second relay, but Hong Kong extended its lead to

10-5 through Ho Shing Him Harris.

Aditya then produced India's strongest early effort, scoring six touches in the third relay, but Cheung Ka Long added five for Hong Kong, leaving India 11-15 behind.

Sachin added one touch in the fourth relay, while Ho scored five as Hong Kong moved 20-12 ahead.



Satwik-Chirag combo makes shock exit

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Nagoya

Defending men's doubles champions Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty suffered a shock opening-round exit but the mixed pair of Tanisha Crasto and Dhruv Kapila advanced to the quarterfinals with back-to-back wins in the Asian Games badminton competition here on Friday.

The former world No.1 and two-time world championship bronze medallists, Satwik and Chirag won the opening game but were eventually stunned by Thailand's Pakkapon Teeraratsakul and Peeratchai Sukphun 12-21, 21-19, 21-14 in a one-hour-eight-minute contest.

The unfancied Thai pair fought back to take the second game 21-19 before completing the upset with a 21-14 win in the decider.

Tanisha and Dhruv, on the other hand, began their campaign with a comfortable 21-8, 21-7 win over Maldives' Nibal Ahmed and Aminath Nabeeha Abdul Razzaq in 21 minutes.

They followed it up with a one-hour long hard-fought 22-20, 21-19, 24-22 victory over Malaysia's Shevon Jemie Lai and Soon Huat Goh to enter the quarterfinals.

They will face China's Yan Zhe Feng and Dongping Huang in the last eight.



Earlier, Unnati Hooda also advanced to the second round after defeating North Korea's Mi Song Yu 21-9, 21-10 in 30 minutes.

India's shuttlers had endured mixed results in the team events.

The women's team, led by PV Sindhu, failed to win a medal, while the men's

team settled for bronze after being unable to better the silver they won at the previous edition.

Later in the day, Hariharan Amsakarunan and MR Arjun are also in action against Indonesia's world No. 2 pair Fajar Alfian and Shohibul Fikri in men's doubles.

We need to work on the mental part: Satwik

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Nagoya

Indian men's doubles badminton ace Satwiksairaj Rankireddy feels he and his partner Chirag Shetty gave away the tie in the second game after taking the lead as he emphasises on the need to work on the mental aspect following the defending champions' shock opening round exit from the Asian Games, here on Friday. The World Ranked fifth were eliminated by Thailand's Pakkapon Teeraratsakul and Peeratchai Sukphun.

"Quite patchy. I think first game we played really good. We know these situations will happen. It will get tense because it will be tricky because we are being playing continuously in the team event, and we are here last night till 12 o'clock, and right away we are playing one of the good matches. So it's not going to

be easy, but we prepared," a disappointed Satwik said. Asked what part of the game they need to work upon, he said: "It's the mental part. Whenever we are mentally free, I think no one can beat us. But when we are stuck anywhere, we give opponents a chance to beat us."

"So it's a process for us. We keep learning, learning, learning. It happens, but we'll go back and prepare on the mental (aspect)."

He said there was as such no pressure of being the title holders here and the need to of the hour is to figure out what went wrong.

"There was no pressure for us. It's every day, the same matches, same players. But it's how you mentally prepare for the tournament. If you play (BWF) 750, Super 1000, the same players are playing, but it's just how you prepare before coming into the games.

Tough Asian Games singles draw for India; doubles best bet

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Nagoya

India have been handed a challenging draw in the Asian Games men's singles tennis competition, with seventh seed Sumit Nagal facing a particularly demanding route to the medal rounds, while 11th seed Dhakshineswar Suresh too has a tricky path in his half featuring Chinese third seed Wu Yibing.

Nagal seeded seventh, has received a first-round bye and will open his campaign against South Korea's Hong Seongchan, who is now ranked way below the Indian but is a tough nut to crack.

Both Nagal and Hong were part of the recent India-Korea Davis Cup tie. India is returning to the competitive tennis after serving in Korean Army and is a very formidable rival.

A win would put the Indian in the third round against either Tajikistan's Somon Amonov or ninth seed Sergey Fomin of Uzbekistan. The road gets considerably tougher thereafter, with third seed Wu Yibing and eighth seed Hayato Matsuoka of Japan among the seeded players in Nagal's quarter of the draw. Wu, ranked 113, is the highest-ranked player in that section.

For Nagal, for a likely presence in the potential medal, he will need to get past Hong Seongchan in the second round, Amonov or Fomin in the third, followed by a potential quarterfinal



terfinal against Wu or Matsuoka.

Nagal will need to reach the semifinals to assure himself of a medal, making the route especially demanding given the quality of players placed in his section.

Dhakshineswar Suresh, seeded 11th, has a similarly difficult route to last-four. He too has a first-round bye and will face Indonesia's Muhammad Trismuwantara in the second round.

If he gets past Trismuwantara he will meet either Tajikistan's Anvar Rakhmatov or sixth seed Chun-Hsin Tseng of Chinese Taipei in the third round.

Indians rule kabaddi



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Nagoya

The Indian men's and women's kabaddi teams stayed on course for a successful defence of their gold medals as they logged facile wins to enter the finals of their respective events at the Asian Games here on Friday.

The women marched into the summit clash with a 48-24 triumph over Nepal before the men joined them with a 66-28 victory against Thailand in the last-four stage here.

The comprehensive wins also kept the two defending champion teams' unbeaten run in the ongoing edition intact. In the women's match, India established a sizeable 31-17 lead in the first half, including four all-out and

four bonus points. Nepal could never challenge India enough and managed to gather only seven more points in the second half.

The men's match followed a similar script as the Indians went up 37-18 in the first half and maintained the supremacy in the next half as well.

The gulf in talent and experience between the two teams was evident from the 15 bonus points that the Indians clinched as against 5 by Thailand during the match.

The two teams will be up against the winners of the Iran-Chinese Taipei clash in both the draws.

Women's kabaddi became an Asian Games sport for the first time in 2010 and India have dominated every edition so far.

Boxer Sachin one win away from medal, Preeti bows out

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Nishio (Japan)

India's Sachin Siwach moved to the men's 60kg quarterfinals with a scrappy 4-1 win over Jordan's Mohammad Adnan Abu Jajeh at the Asian Games here on Friday.

However, it was the end of the road for last edition's bronze medallist Preeti Pawar. The Commonwealth Games gold medallist, who received a first round bye, went down 0-5 in an unanimous verdict to North Korea's Paris Olympics medallist and reigning Asian Games champion Pang Chol M in the women's 54kg round of 16.

Sachin, who received a first-round bye, started aggressively, landing a series of combinations, but the bout soon turned into a tactical affair, with both boxers relying on counter-attacks. The Indian's cleaner work earned him the round on three cards.

The second round followed a similar pattern, with the two boxers cancelling



out each other's attacks and waiting for openings.

Jajeh, needing to make up ground, began pressing forward and attacking, giving Sachin opportunities to counter with sharp left-right combinations. The Commonwealth Games gold medallist again pocketed the round 4-1.

Desperate to turn the bout around, Jajeh came out all guns blazing in the

final round, throwing punches in numbers, while Sachin stood his ground and traded blows.

But the Indian appeared to tire out in the closing stages, allowing Jajeh to land a few clean punches. Sachin, however, had done enough to secure the split-decision win.



India finish fourth in dressage team event

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Tokyo

India finished fourth in the dressage team event of equestrian at the Asian Games here on Friday, missing out on a podium finish with a total score of 201.971 points.

China won the gold medal with 208.148 points, followed by South Korea with 205.265 for silver and Japan with 204.117 for bronze.

Gaurav Pundir scored 65.794 riding Milli, a 2016-born bay Westfalen horse sired by Millennium, with his score serving as the team's drop score as only the best



three results counted. Hriday Vipul Chheda scored 67.353 on Dono Di Maggio, a 2007-born bay Oldenburg sired by DiMaggio. Shruti Vora produced India's best score of 68.059 on Magnanimous, a 2012-born Oldenburg sired

by Millennium. Jai Sud scored 66.559 on Goofy La Perle, a 2011-born bay KWPN sired by Belissimo NRW.

The four scores combined to give India 201.971 points, leaving the team just outside the medal positions.

In-form Indian men look to confirm semifinal berth

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Kakamigahara (Japan)

In-form defending champions India will look to continue their unbeaten run and seal a semifinal berth when they take on hosts Japan in a men's hockey Pool A match at the Asian Games here on Saturday.

The Indians, who had a disappointing FIH World Cup campaign recently by finishing a lowly eighth, looked to have found their mojo at the right time by registering three wins from as many games and are



atop the pool with nine points ahead of Japan. India had earlier thrashed Indonesia 13-1, Sri Lanka 16-1 and South Korea 8-2 in their opening three pool matches.

India will take on Bangladesh in their final pool match against Bangladesh on September 28, which they are expected to win handsomely. Japan are also unbeaten with three wins from as many games but have an inferior goal difference, setting up Saturday's clash as a top-of-the-pool decider, with the winner assured of finishing first.

Dilpreet Singh has been in red hot form, scoring as many as nine goals to lead the goal-scorers chart, while fellow forward Abhishek too has shown his mettle with six field strikes.

Dragflycker Jugraj Singh has five goals — three from penalty corners and two from strokes.

The Indian forward line looks to be in impeccable form with Sukhjeet (4 goals) and Shilanan Lakra (3), Rajinder Singh (2) and veteran Mandeep Singh (2) also contributing to the team's cause. Skipper Harmanpreet Singh also shone bright with four penalty corner conversions from three games but there is a lot to be desired from set pieces as they wasted quite a few chances in the opening three games.

Disappointing day for India in canoeing



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Nagoya

India continued their disappointing run in canoeing at the Asian Games here on Friday, with their paddlers failing to make the podium and falling short of their medal-winning performance at the Hangzhou edition.

The men's kayak four qualified for the Final A but finished seventh, while the men's kayak double settled for third in Final B and the women's canoe double failed to qualify for the final.

India will sign off from the canoeing competition at the Miyoshi Lake here with two more events on Saturday, but both will offer "limited medal opportunities".

India had won a bronze in the men's canoe double 1000m at the Hangzhou Asian Games, with Arjun Singh and Sunil Singh finishing third.

However, that event has been scrapped from the programme for the current Asian Games, which proved to be a big setback for India. National canoe coach Shanti Swaroop told PTI.

Joshna-Senthilkumar, Anahat, Abhay lead Indian squash's medal surge

PHILEM DIPAK SINGH ■ Nagoya

Indian squash players assured themselves of three medals as Joshna Chinappa and Velavan Senthilkumar entered the mixed doubles semifinals, while Anahat Singh and Abhay Singh advanced to the last four in singles at the Asian Games here on Friday.

Joshna, playing in a record seventh Asian Games, and Senthilkumar began the winning spree with an 11-3, 11-5 victory over the Philippines' David Pelino and Jemyca Aribado in the mixed doubles quarterfinals. India's first ever junior world champion and medal favourite Anahat breezed past compatriot Tanvi Khanna 11-2, 11-5, 11-3 in the women's singles quarterfinals to stay on course for a coveted Olympic berth.



Anahat will next face world Number 6 Satomi Watanabe, a bronze medalist from Hangzhou. Abhay, meanwhile, dispatched local favourite Ryonosuke Tsukue 11-4, 11-3, 11-6 to set up a semifinal clash with Pakistan's Irfan Muhammad, who got the better of Veer Chotrani.

Chotrani squandered a one-game lead to go down 11-

6, 8-11, 3-11, 3-11 to the Pakistani in 41 minutes.

The men's and women's singles gold winners will directly qualify for 2028 Los Angeles Olympics where squash is set to make its debut.

Joshna's sixth Asian Games medal: Joshna and Senthilkumar took less than half an hour to register a dominant win in the quarterfinal. They will take on Hong Kong's Yo Ka Lee and Ming Hong Tang in the semifinals on Saturday.

It is the sixth Asian Games medal for 40-year-old Joshna.



She already has a haul of two silver and three bronze medals at the continental event.

She won a singles bronze in 2018 edition, a team silver each in 2014 and 2018, and team bronze each in 2010 and 2022.

Joshna, who is competing at the Asian Games since Busan 2002, surpassed the earlier record of another Indian squash great Saurav Ghosal who retired last year after making six appearances at the continental multi-sport event.

Joshna and Senthilkumar com-

pletely dominated the quarterfinal at the Nagoya Kinjo Futo Arena Court Number 6 with their power and clinical display.

Joshna and her 28-year-old team-mate Senthilkumar, both from Tamil Nadu, complemented each other to take the first game in nine minutes with the Philippines pair coming short in all departments of the game.

The Indians were 3-0 up quiet early and they made it 9-2 in no time. The Filipinos took a point after that but Joshna and Senthilkumar were in a hurry, as they took the next two points and take the first game 11-3. The second game was a little bit tougher for the Indians as Pelino and Aribado tried a comeback after the Indians took a 3-0 lead.

It was 4-2 midway in the second game, but that was the smallest gap the Philippines pair could muster.

Thereafter, Joshna and Senthilkumar stepped to another gear, moving to 7-2 and then 8-4, before winning the second game 11-5 in 10 minutes to seal the match. (PTI)